Destiny Fulfilled

The Life & Times

OF HIS EXCELLENCY

DR. CHINWOKE CLEMENT MBADINUJU (ODERA)

EXECUTIVE GOVERNOR OF ANAMBRA STATE (1999 - 2003)

Aged 77 Years

Destiny Fulfilled

1 Cor 4:1-5 KJV

1. Let a man so account of us, as of the ministers of Christ, and stewards of the mysteries of God.

2 Moreover it is required in stewards, that a man be found faithful.

3 But with me it is a very small thing that I should be judged of you, or of man's judgment: yea, I judge not mine own self.

4 For I know nothing by myself; yet am I not hereby justified: but He that judgeth me is the Lord.

5 Therefore judge nothing before the time, until the Lord come, who both will bring to light the hidden things of darkness, and will make manifest the counsels of the hearts: and then shall every man have praise of God.

HIS EXCELLENCY

DR CHINWOKE CLEMENT MBADINUJU

EXECUTIVE GOVERNOR OF ANAMBRA STATE (1999 - 2003)

Aged 77 Years

Destiny Fulfilled

1 Cor 4:1-5 KJV

TABLE OF CONTENTS

1. State Burial Announcment by The Anambra State Government

2. Life and Times

3. List of Published Books

4. Words on Marble
- Dateline 1995
- Dateline 2016

5. Photo Gallery
- Early Years
- Career and Politics
- Later Years

6. Tributes & Condolence Letters

With Complements from

CHINWOKE MBADINUJU FOUNDATION

CMBADINUJUFOUNDATION.ORG

Media Release

FUNERAL ARRANGEMENT FOR HIS EXCELLENCY, DR CHINWOKE MBADINUJU, FORMER GOVERNOR, ANAMBRA STATE

Dr. Chinwoke Mbadinuju, the Governor of Anambra State from May 29, 1999 to May 29, 2003, passed away on April 11, 2023 and will be given a State Burial.

Born on June 14, 1945, he was elected on the platform of Peoples' Democratic Party (PDP) and was sworn in as Anambra State Governor at the return of civil rule on May 29, 1999. He deserves commendation for tackling the many teething challenges of security and infrastructure of the then young State in his one and only term as Governor.

To give him a befitting funeral as the former Governor of Anambra State, his family and the State Government have agreed on the following arrangement of final passage:

November 22: The Anambra State Government (ANSG) will receive the body at the Government House Courtyard by 3pm for Lying-in-State.

November 23: ANSG will hold a Commendation Service and Thanksgiving Ceremony at the International Convention Centre, Awka by 11am. His former political associates, colleagues and friends will have the opportunity to pay their last respects to him in the State Capital where he once held sway as the Governor of Anambra State.

- His Family will later, on the same day, hold the Wake, Praise/Worship and Tribute Sessions in his honour at Uli, his home town, Ihiala LGA.

November 24: ANSG and the Family will hold an Interdenominational Burial Service at his Uli Country Home by 10am, and interment will follow immediately. The reception and refreshments for guests will subsequently commence.

November 25: Condolence visits continue as organized by his Family.

November 26: Outing services and condolence visits will be undertaken as planned by his Family.

Governor Chinwoke Mbadinuju served Anambra State to the best of his ability. While we bid him farewell, it is only fitting to re-echo his slogan: **"It Shall Be Well With Anambra State!"**

May his Soul rest in Peace.

Signed
PROF. SOLO CHUKWULOBELU
Secretary to State Government
October 16, 2023

LIFE & TIMES

DESTINY FULFILLED:
THE LIFE & TIMES OF HIS EXCELLENCY,
DR CHINWOKE CLEMENT MBADINUJU (ODERA 1 OF ULI)

BIRTH

Dr Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju, better known as Odera, was born as a simple village boy in Umuaku, Ndikpo Uli on the 14th of June 1945 into the family of late Benjamin and Agnes Mbadinuju. Chinwoke was born without airs, with no silver spoon and no material bequeaths. His father was a tailor and lay reader in the Anglican church while his mother was a house wife. However, the family laid the foundation for a solid Christian upbringing for young Chinwoke and his siblings by a firm inculcation of discipline, regimented by daily expositions of the Bible and Christian principles.

EDUCATION

By 1957, Chinwoke had his completed primary school education at Mgbidi Primary School but as financial constraints put secondary school education beyond his parent's reach, he opted for a Teacher Training Course at the Bishop Lasbrey College, Irete - Owerri. He was later employed as a teacher in the school because of his overall brilliance and academic excellence. At the age of 21 in 1966, he had obtained his G.C.E. O' Level and A' Level papers and was consequently offered admission into the University of Ibadan and the State University of New York (SUNY) at New Paltz, USA. He chose the latter because it came with a scholarship.

Between 1966 and 1975, by the age of 30 years, Chinwoke had graduated with a Bachelor of Arts Degree cum laude from the State University of New York, a Master's Degree in Government (International Affairs) from Ohio University, Athens, Ohio and earned his Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D) in International Law and Relations from the prestigious ivy league Cornell University, Ithaca, New York.

Dr Chinwoke had a stint as an Administrative Intern in alma mater State University of NewYork in New Paltz and as a Teaching assistant in the Government Department of other alma mater Ohio State University.

He was appointed an Assistant Professor at State University of New York in Cortland, New York; a visiting Professor at Upper College of State University of New York at Utica/Rome, New York; and finally, as an Associate Professor and Chairman of the Black and African Studies Department, State University of New York at Cortland, USA.

In the summer of 1975, he flew across the Atlantic to the University of Southampton, England for a Bachelors Degree (LL.B Honours) in Law and afterwards berthed at the Nigerian Law School, Victoria Island Lagos, where he obtained the Barrister of Law Degree in 1979.

Within 13 years (from 1966 to 1979), Young Dr Chinwoke had distinguished himself academically in the USA and UK and was now a Solicitor and Advocate of the Supreme Court of Nigeria. Apart from the Nigerian Law School Lagos, he did not attend any Nigerian University and was not involved in the Nigeria-Biafra War.

MARRIAGE & CHILDREN

It is not difficult to understand that Dr Chinwoke's Christian inclination began from home. As a young man with attractive persona, who had done well for himself in a

liberal American society, he still deferred to God to give him the right woman for a wife.

God kept His promise. Just as Abraham told his servant to go back to his people and find a wife for his son, God also led Dr Chinwoke back home to his people in, Ndiezike Ihiala LGA, to the family of renown Headmaster, Sylvanus Okezie, where he found the bone of his bones and the rib of his ribs in pretty Miss Chiebonam Nnebuogo Okezie, fondly called Nnenne, and wedded her at Ithaca, New York in 1971. She remained his wife for 52 years.

The couple begat six children. Their first child/daughter Dr Adamma, a Medical Doctor in the Charlotte NC, USA; Chetachi Chinwoke 2, a UK trained Lawyer; Nnabuike, a Business and Real Estate Consultant; Uchechukwu, a Nurse Practitioner in Houston Texas, USA. Their third daughter, Chinonye, went to be with the Lord in her first year in 1986.

Their last child Chimaobi works in the Medical Sports industry in the US. Their children have birthed a total of 9 grandchildren with the last grandchild, a beautiful baby girl, arriving in November 2023.

EARLY CAREER AND FIRST POLITICAL JOURNEY

Dr Chinwoke extended his expansive field of knowledge into journalism, when he became a lecturer in the Daily Times Training School; an International Affairs Correspondent of Times International (a magazine by Daily Times); and later the Editor.

In 1980, the Government of old Anambra State invited him to serve as General Manager of the State-owned Star Printing and Publishing Company Limited. The then Governor of Anambra State, Chief Jim Nwobodo later appointed him Director, Research and Planning in the office of the Governor. His star was still on the rise when in 1982, the former President of the Federal Republic of Nigeria, Alhaji Shehu Shagari, appointed him, Special Assistant (Political) attached to the office of the Vice President, Dr. Alex Ekwueme.

In recognition of his achievements and service to his community, the then Igwe of Uli, His Royal Highness, the late Igwe Gregory Agbasiere in 1983 conferred on Dr Chinwoke the traditional title of ODERA, meaning "what God has written is written"

In the same 1983, Odera lost his immediate younger brother and confidant Kenneth, an elder in Grace of God Mission, who had spent years preaching and attempting to convince him to move closer to Christ to no avail. The suddenness of the loss made Odera begin to reexamine the level of his spirituality. It was at a crusade programme initiated by his late brother's church that Dr Chinwoke was weaned of his traditional moderate Anglican church persuasion to the born-again variant. According to him "*At the crusade ground, I heard for the first time, a reinvention of my traditional understanding of Christianity. I was exposed to the real knowledge of the Word of God. There I repented and surrendered to Christ".*

LAWYER, EVANGELIST AND AUTHOR

After the 2nd Republic collapsed as a result of the Military Coup d'état of 1983, Dr Chinwoke spent the next 16 years of his life as an active Christian Evangelist, Practicing Lawyer and Arbitrator, Legal Adviser to Churches and Christian organizations, Community Leader and Author of several Christian and Political Literature.

His Law practice at Onitsha was a fusion of Law and Christianity. He joined the Full Gospel Business Men's Fellowship International (FGBMFI), shortly becoming the President of it's Onitsha chapter and expanding the

FGBMFI Onitsha chapters to 12 within a short space of time. He eventually rose to become the National Legal Adviser and member of the National Executive of the Fellowship in Nigeria.

His interactions with like-minded Christian lawyers in other parts of the country gave birth to the Christian Lawyers Fellowship of Nigeria (CLASFON), of which he became the National President. At this period also, he was actively engaged in house-to-house evangelism, which he used in calling many to repentance, in the Onitsha area and environs. In the company of other Christian believers, he went about visiting people in various distress, in keeping with Bible injunctions. Out of his zeal for evangelism he began to plant billboards with the inscriptions, "JESUS IS COMING SOON" "REPENT AND BE BORN AGAIN" on the highways from Onitsha to Benin, Onitsha to Owerri and Onitsha to Enugu.

Between 1986 and 1999, Dr Chinwoke had published books encompassing his two passions of Christianity and Political Philosophy including: "False Men and True Christians (1986); Living by Every Word of God (1986); Israel & Event Marking The End of The World (1987); Law and Religion in Nigeria (1987); God's Kind of Leader (1988); Continuing Steadfastly in the Apostles Doctrine & Fellowship (1990); The Voice of One Crying (1990); Beyond Pentecostal Ministry (1992); the Visitation of God (1993) and Spiritual Worship (1996). He was to write many more books on his 2 passions in his later years.

GOD'S KIND OF LEADER

In 1988, at the advent of the 3rd Republic and as the National President of CLASFON, Dr Chinwoke presented his thoughts on Politics and Christianity, firstly as a term paper which eventually metamorphosed into the book for publication: "God's Kind of Leader: A Righteous and Responsible Man" In this seminal book, He explored the concepts of righteous and responsible Leadership subsumed in Christian beliefs and Godly direction as it relates to the kind of leadership Nigeria required in a democratic dispensation; emphasizing that that such kind of leadership

was the only panacea to development and prosperity in Nigeria. He attempted to reconcile his Christianity with the need to provide purposeful leadership for the benefit of Nigerians, critically analyzing the lingering premonition among Christians that Politics in Nigeria generally, was far too dirty a pre-occupation, which would contaminate even the most upright. Although he recognized the limitations of such righteous and responsible Christian in seeking for elective office in Nigeria, as the electoral process seemed to clash fundamentally with his Christian beliefs, Dr Mbadinuju nevertheless refused to foreclose the possibility in his book. He even went ahead to enumerate conditions for the success of such leadership, if it ever became a reality.

SECOND POLITICAL JOURNEY

Dr Mbadinuju did not participate in the 3rd Republic, but 10 years after writing his seminal books on Christian leadership, at the advent of the 4th Republic, He sought elective position as the Governor of Anambra State, firstly under the defunct United Nigeria Congress Party (UNCP) then the People's Democratic Party (PDP) which he joined as a foundation member.

Under the most extraordinary circumstances, Dr Chinwoke was chosen as his party's gubernatorial candidate and having traversed the State with his message of hope: "**It Shall be well with Anambra State",** Odera won the Anambra State gubernatorial elections of 1998 in a landslide, with the grace of his God, his outstanding CV, his effective political message and campaign machinery and significantly, his political sponsors.

GOVERNOR OF ANAMBRA STATE

Dr Chinwoke Mbadinuju, is perhaps best remembered as a one-time and one-term Governor of Anambra State. He served as Governor of the State from 1999 to 2003. What many did not know was that he was also a practicing born-again Christian, determined to adopt a leadership style which reflected his Christian beliefs to the exclusion of his personal preferences. As the new Governor of Anambra State, Mbadinuju finally had the opportunity to walk his talk as he espoused in his previous Christian and Political Literature.

The problems confronting the new administration of Governor Mbadinuju were hydra-headed. The 9 year old State he inherited from the military was suffering from several overwhelming ills ranging from extreme paupacy of funds to effectively run

the Government and effect significant development; nonexistent Government presence in the State Capital Awka as Government house and Secretariat were run in portacabins and the Governors lodge was a makeshift structure; Infrastructural decay all over the state; total insecurity as armed robbers, urchins, kidnappers, ritualists, rapists, assassins, arsonists and all manner of dregs of society reigned supreme; the fratricidal war raging between Aguleri, Umuleri and Umuoba Anam communities; the high rate of school drop outs in preference for trading, to the high level of political indiscipline occasioned by politicians, government contractors and the emerging "godfathers" of the time, amongst many others.

Governor Mbadinuju was however not perturbed by these individuals or the problematic circumstances confronting his new government. He was determined to salvage Anambra state and make good governance impact every citizen of the state. On May 29th, 1999, at the inauguration of his government, Odera made 3 solemn promises:

- **To put God first in all State Government's endeavors;**
- **To build a befitting State Capital; and**
- **To leave Anambra State better than he met it.**

The Mbadinuju administration was determined to run an **all-inclusive Government** in Anambra State, nurturing and giving political opportunities many individuals who have risen to become the State's current Political and Economic Leaders.

He instituted a regime of leading the entire State's Political apparatus in prayers every Monday morning. Market Traders, Civil Servants, Artisans and students joined the **Monday morning prayers** with relish. Governor Mbadinuju spent many Monday mornings in Onitsha main market with members of his cabinet, preaching and praying with the market leaders, traders and artisans. He later published Two Volumes of Books documenting his teachings, prayers and interactions with the people during such weekly Monday prayers.

With the meagre funds due to the State at the time, Governor Mbadinuju's administration made it its top priority to pay workers promptly every month end and was the first to pay **Christmas bonus to workers** in the South East at the time. With the residual funds after salary payment, his Government initiated the innovative policy, the **Joint Action on Development (JAD)**, where the funding of infrastructural development in the State became a joint venture between the State and Local Governments, jointly funding capital projects and palliative works in their respective domains. This led to an unprecedented level of infrastructural development in the state during the period.

Under this developmental mindset, the Mbadinuju Government began to change the narrative of the State Capital, Awka with the following **Legacy projects, amongst others**:

- The temporary Government House which was burnt down at the exit of the Military, was rebuilt in the first 100 days of the Mbadinuju administration and remains the State's seat of Power till this day.
- The Awka "Three Arms Zone" comprising of the 8 Lane Boulevard, Ekwueme Square/Cenotaph, The State Judiciary and House of Assembly Complexes were completed.
- The New Nnamdi Azikiwe Government House was aggressively funded
- Women Development Centre (now Dora Akunyili Centre),
- The Commissioners Quarters,
- The Legislators Quarters,
- SPEB and other Institutional Buildings,
- The Anambra Broadcasting Service (ABS) Radio & Television Complex,
- The Olympic Size Stadium in Awka
- Ngozika, Abuja and Iyiagu and many Estates in the State Capital where developed. Udoka Estate was expanded extensively

In Abuja, The State Government built a befitting Liaison Office & Governor's Lodge. Under the JAD policy, the major towns of Onitsha, Nnewi, Ekwulobia had new roads constructed and old ones renovated. Each of the 179 communities in the state then had a feel of government presence. Industries sprang up because the environment had become highly enabled.

Perhaps, motivated to checkmate the trend of male school dropouts in preference for trading, and in recognition of the opportunities afforded to him by the Scholarship to the State University of New York early in his life, Governor Mbadinuju

established the **State owned University**, **Anambra State University of Science and Technology**, now known as Chukwuemeka Odimegwu Odimegwu Ojukwu University, with initial campuses at Uli and Igbariam, with successive administrations expanding the campuses to other towns in the State.

The Aguleri, Umuleri/Umuoba Anam war that had raged for many years and had defied years of multiple interventions and peace talks, was decisively resolved by the Odera Administration, and the peace has remained till date. Aguleri Town eventually produced one of Mbadinuju's successors as Governor and Umueri Town now hosts The Chinua Achebe International Cargo Airport, a testament to the pervading peace that Governor Mbadinuju established in the area.

Ironically, the return of peace to Aguleri/Umuleri/Umuoba Anam gave intriguing momentum to the activities of criminals in the state. All the unretired guns from the Aguleri/Umuleri - Umuoba Anam war found usefulness in the crime ravaged state. The state boiled the more and the daredevilry of criminals reached an all-time high. When criminals began shooting at moving vehicles, killing all occupants, Governor Mbadinuju understood that the DESPERATE SITUATION had called for a DESPERATE SOLUTION, and he swung into action to confront the insecurity menace headlong.

The creation of the **Anambra Vigilante Service (AVS)** by the Anambra State House of Assembly was the Governor's quick and emphatic response to the audacity of the armed robbers and other criminals in the state. It was reasoned that the AVS in each community would draw membership from within the community, because members of a community are close-knit and knew each other well. It was easier therefore, to identify bad eggs in their respective communities as well as new faces. It was also reasoned that a collaboration between security agencies and the AVS, who knew their communities better would lead to quicker identification and apprehension of criminals.

The AVS was the brainchild of Odera's deep understanding of the advantages of the theory of Mutually Agreed Deterrence (MAD), that when superior force matches and overcomes an existing force of evil, evil will surrender for peace to reign. The AVS made mincemeat of the best strategies and onslaught of the criminals. The combined terror of associated criminals in the state was matched and overcome by the superior force of the AVS and the criminals no longer able to condone the heat, surrendered to the AVS and beat a quick retreat away from the state. The situation that

defied previous attempts by past administrations succumbed to Odera's uncommon strategy of deterrence.

Security was restored in the state and businesses began to boom again. It is still well remembered that during Christmas seasons throughout Odera's tenure, there was usually a mass return of Anambra indigenes from all over the world. Social life went swinging and life returned to normal in the State. The Federal Government which sent assessors to all the states was happy with what Anambra State had become under Odera and awarded his Government **first position - a Gold cup - for Security.**

Odera started the making of Anambra State as **an oil producing state** by establishing the first oil and gas company in Anambra State and facilitating the acquisition of Oil blocks. **Orient Refinery and Oil Services Ltd (Orient Petroleum),** the pride of Anambra State**,** was conceived, established and facilitated during Governor Mbadinuju's' administration.

While as Governor, Dr Mbadinuju made efforts to positively influence National discourse., He was one of the early proponents of the single term Presidency of 5 or 6 years, rotated among the six geographical zones, to improve the sense of belonging among every region of the country. He was the first to advocate for the professionalization of Politicians with Institutions established in that regard, to ensure national standards were maintained among politicians and to eliminate indiscipline and unscrupulousness among potential and prospective leaders.

It is not an easy task to chronicle Governor Mbadinuju's larger than life achievements in Anambra State, especially in the first two years of his administration. The fundamental import to note is that Odera's tenure marked the genesis of **the shift in government focus from being an instrument for the enrichment of a few individuals to one that is geared towards developmental activities**. One wishing to know the scope and extent of the Mbadinuju Administration's revolution in Anambra State should endeavor to read his memoirs, "How I Governed Anambra State - Stewardship and Accountability." and "Journey Into The Past: The Ordeal of a State Governor"

THE GOVERNOR MUST DIE

Perhaps the greatest catalyst to Odera's second political journey was the activities and impact of some of his Political Sponsors and certain elite individuals in the State at the time. Indeed, the circumstances of the advent of the 4th Republic in Nigeria saw the emergence of a new generation of brash and wealthy young men, created by the military regime in the twilight of their departure who awarded all manner of contracts and made upfront payments, for their purposes. The beneficiaries of these contracts, many of which were not executed, were the new billionaires in town. For 9 years after creation, Anambra State lay desolate.

Perhaps, these new "godfathers" adopted Dr Mbadinuju due to his outstanding qualifications and articulated Gubernatorial Manifesto. Perhaps, he was adopted for his humble Christian personality but charismatic disposition. But these Political contractors and billionaires had hoped that Mbadinuju's new administration would continue from where they stopped with the military. Their major ambition was to have a controlling authority over the new governor and therefore, the treasury and continue to milk it, as in the days of the soldiers.

Dr Chinwoke Mbadinuju, on the other hand, who came from a diametrically opposed background and mindset, had a different agenda. As an Associate Professor of Political Science and a practicing born again Christian, he wanted to actualize God's purpose for Anambra State by re-inventing the Government of the State away from its locust past to one that will be an instrument for the development of the State. He visualized the office of the Governor as a bigger platform to expand the work he was doing with his Law office in Onitsha, which was to lessen human suffering and to set Anambra State on a developmental trajectory.

The Mbadinuju Government's insistence on due process in the award and execution of contracts was at variance with the godfathers expectations of collecting full upfront payments for unexecuted contracts. The Administration's masterstroke of creating the State Tenders Board with its own Permanent Secretary mandated to award, monitor and evaluate state contracts to completion, was an affront on their established lifestyles and ways of doing things. These influential individuals felt disappointed that the governor stopped the bazaar they had enjoyed with successive military administrations in the state and was aggressively developing the state infrastructure and Legacy projects, to their exclusion.

These influential individuals considered it a cardinal sin for the Governor to choose to release local government monthly allocations to the respective Local Government Councils as a first line charge rather than the strange

system where the allocations were shared between them and the military administrators. Though Governor Mbadinuju consulted widely as a consummate politician before appointing Government officials, his efforts fell short of the expectations of the godfathers, who wanted to continue the tradition of drawing up the list of political appointees in the state to the exclusion of the Governor who just made announcements. They therefore swooped on the young Administration with a firm resolve to de-market the Governor and his administration.

The godfathers' Forum included members who were well paid and well-funded to make the State ungovernable. Using their influences to block sources of funding for Anambra State projects from the banks they controlled, they also began to incite workers against the administration utilizing the then national leadership of the Nigeria Labour Congress. Though much **heretic propaganda** was spewed against the State Government, their efforts were not diminishing Odera's popularity and were not likely to negatively impact his second term ambition. Dr Mbadinuju, in deference to his Christian background and outlook, chose to exercise **tremendous restraint** against the avalanche of false allegations and propaganda heaped on his administration. Rather that utilize the enormous Political powers at his disposal against these individuals, he chose to ignore their antics and rather focused on his developmental efforts, believing that his good works will speak for him when the time came. The opposition's schemes demanded something more emphatic, more audacious and more compelling.

The murder of the Nigerian Bar Association (NBA) Onitsha branch Chairman and his pregnant wife turned out to be a classic case of the opposition's desperation to stop an innocent man from continuing his good works for the people. In order to truncate Governor Mbadinuju's ambition for a second term, the murders were gruesomely committed, trumped up and woven around his neck. Even before Police commenced investigation, the opposition had pointed accusing fingers at the Governor. It did not matter to them that he was in faraway Texas, USA, attending that year's World Igbo Congress. With clean conscience and ready to prove his innocence, Odera cut short his engagement in the US, returned home, discarded his immunity as Governor and submitted himself to full Police investigation. He was investigated and found not complicit, yet the opposition maintained that he must remain guilty until proven innocent.

In the end, Dr Mbadinuju's efforts at creatively revolutionizing governance in Anambra State with limited funds, was not enough to secure him another term as Governor of the State under his political Party the PDP, as his developmental efforts were overshadowed and undermined by the diabolical mechanisms of his opponents and opposition who had distracted his Government for its 4 years of existence and had the ears of the Presidency and National leadership of the party at the time.

The PDP primary elections in Anambra State were held three times and Governor Mbadinuju won three times, but it did not convince the PDP that Odera was not only popular but was indeed on ground and in control of the state's party structures. He was summarily suspended from the Party for no justifiable reason and in deference to his opposition, the PDP went into the 2003 elections in Anambra State without its incumbent Governor. Odera still contested the gubernatorial elections of 2003 under the platform of Alliance for Democracy (AD) led by his colleague, the then Governor of Lagos State and the current President of Nigeria, Senator Bola Ahmed Tinubu. Governor Mbadinuju lost the 2003 elections and ended his second political journey.

POST GOVERNMENT ORDEALS

After his tenure as Governor of the State, Dr Mbadinuju's opponents didn't let him be, as they were determined not only to truncate his further political career but also ensure that he was killed and confirmed dead. The fact that they irreversibly lost political control of Anambra State within 3 years of their unfortunate schemes against Governor Mbadinuju, first to the Action Congress of Nigeria (ACN) and from 2006 till date, to the All Progressive Grand Alliance (APGA), seemed to incense and convince them that Odera was the cause of their problems. But Dr Mbadinuju was determined to clear his name of all the atrocities heaped on him and his government. He submitted himself to the Nigerian authorities controlled by his opponents, was heavily investigated for alleged financial misappropriations and was briefly and unjustly incarcerated without trial in Abuja and Onitsha prisons - for **conspiracy to commit murder with "persons unknown".** In his opponents' quest to eliminate him, the **Onitsha prisons was burnt down** a day after he secured his bail and left the traumatic prisons without his opponent's knowledge. The then Federal Government refused to set up a panel of enquiry to investigate the incident.

As evil does not last forever, the falsehood against the former Governor and the determined plot to kill him obeyed the law of nature and expired at its own time. It expired when the Courts discharged him and then Anambra State Attorney General and Commissioner for Justice, announced that nothing in the Police Reports warranted putting the former Governor on trial for any offence. In other words, Governor Chinwoke Mbadinuju was wrongly arrested, charged and sent to prison for what he knew nothing about.

LATER LIFE

Dr Mbadinuju spent his post Governorship days reconnecting intimately with his family and friends and writing more Christian and Political literature. He was present at his children's weddings in the UK, Bahamas and Abuja and built close relationships with his grandchildren, who always looked forward to visiting him at his Abuja residence.

Between 1999 to 2015, he had published an additional 12 books, including his memoirs

while in Government. He wrote a total of 22 books in his lifetime.

The Chinwoke Mbadinuju Foundation (CMF) was set up in 2012 which Dr Mbadinuju used to continue his intellectual evangelism, initiated free distribution of his literary works and consolidated his community support programmes.

Dr Mbadinuju joined the All Peoples Congress, APC in 2015 at the prompting of his friend, the past President Mohammadu Buhari, who in 2012 was the Chairman of the book launch of his memoirs on how he governed Anambra State. Unfortunately, Mbadinuju after a minor domestic accident in 2019, became infirmed and retired from active politics soon after.

DEATH

Dr Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju (Odera) passed unto the great beyond on the 11th day of April, 2023 at the age of 77 years, having distinguished himself as an exceptional Scholar, seasoned Academic, Lecturer, Associate Professor and Chairman of a Department in an American University, Legal Practitioner, Journalist and Editor-in-Chief, Presidential Assistant, Church Administrator, Community Leader, State Governor, Author, Family Patriarch and Elder Statesman. Despite all these achievements, Odera considered himself first and foremost an **Evangelist/Preacher** of his God's word for this day and age.

At the time of his passing, most of Mbadinuju's political opponents during his Administration never got the opportunity to become the Governor of Anambra State after several failed attempts and their brief stints in the office were erased from the State's history by the Courts. Most of the major opposition actors have become politically irrelevant without achieving any recognizable political feat in the State. The PDP that brought Dr Mbadinuju to power but unjustly undermined him and his Administration and rejected him in deference to the Anambra godfathers, eventually lost political power and relevance in his State Anambra and in Nigeria. APGA continues to govern Anambra State credibly without distractions from the Federal Government unlike the case in Odera's time as Governor.

His alternate party APC, though not yet popular in Anambra State, remains the ruling party in Nigeria till date, with Governor Mbadinuju's colleague and benefactor, the former Governor of Lagos State, Senator Bola Ahmed Tinubu being the newly elected President of Nigeria, against all odds. Significantly too, virtually all Odera's true supporters and adherents, who stood by him through thick and thin while in Government and afterwards, eventually rose through the political ranks and remain politically and economically relevant in Nigeria till date.

Anambra State's income profile has been greatly enhanced and is now a benefactor of derivation as an oil producing state because of Dr Mbadinuju's intervention via Orient Petroleum over 20 years ago.

Odera's legacy projects like the Anambra State University (Chukwuemeka Odumegwu Ojukwu University) continues to blossom and grow from strength to strength, churning out outstanding graduates making marks in their chosen careers.

The Anambra Vigilant Service (AVS) has evolved to the Anambra Vigilante Group (AVG) for more effectiveness and its template has been adopted by several states in Nigeria as a community security initiative. As a result of the Post-Mbadinuju Government political intrigues between 2003 and 2006, Anambra State now holds its Gubernatorial Elections separately from other states in the country, giving its citizens exclusive time to assess the motives and manifestoes of prospective gubernatorial candidates.

SPORTS, AWARDS AND HONOURS

In his lifetime, Odera received numerous awards and honours including being the Recipient of the prestigious Humanities and Social Sciences (HSS) Fellowship for Doctorate Studies from the Ivy League Cornell University, USA. He was the assistant organist at St Stephens Church Igbobi Lagos during his stint at the Nigerian Law School between 1978/9. He was an all-American selected Soccer (Football) player in the Conference Team of New York Universities. He was selected as a player for the US Soccer Team in the International Sports Exchange Program in Spain, Portugal, France, Belgium and England in the spring of 1969. He was also an excellent Lawn Tennis player. He was honoured twice by the Nigerian Union of Journalist (NUJ) for his development strides in Anambra State during his tenure. CLASFON of which he was a one-time President also recognized his contributions to humanity as the Anambra State Governor.

EPILOGUE

From his later writings, Odera rationalized his life's experiences as clear evidence of the fulfilment of scriptures in this day and age, an example and inspiration for others who will come after him: For he gave his life and destiny to his God at an early age, committed to following his God's guidance and teachings and reflecting same in his relationship with his family and fellow men, and his God elevated him from very humble beginnings to great heights in life, granting him authority and immunity over all principalities and powers, using same to showcase Gods kind of Political Leadership as he had espoused, but allowing him pass through intense travails and tribulations to reinforce his trust and belief in his God, learn obedience, remain humble and be grounded.

Dr Mbadinuju recognized that his administration was wrongly regarded as the worst in the annals of Anambra State, just to deny him his accolades and dues. But he remained positive and rationalized that leading a State like Anambra was better viewed, **not as a competition but a relay race**, where one Governor continued from wherever the other stopped, as different Governors of the State encountered varying circumstances of Governance. Odera remained convinced that his 4-year administration as Governor laid the foundation stone of the current successes of successive administrations in Anambra State and continues to positively impact humanity through his legacy projects.

Until his passing, Odera continued to thank his God for giving him the opportunity to excel in life, for using him as a tool to inspire and positively impact the lives of his people at a time when all hope seemed lost in Governance. He continued to solicit for forgiveness from all whom he felt he wronged and continued to pray for the forgiveness of all who those who wronged him.

He is survived by his loving wife Nnenne, 5 living children, numerous grandchildren, sisters, sons and daughters in law, brothers and sisters in law, nephews and nieces.

Dr Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju, that simple village boy, was graciously accorded a State Burial in his village Ndikpo Uli by the Governor of Anambra State, Professor Charles Chukwuma Soludo, CFR.

May His Excellency Odera's great soul rest in perfect peace, Amen. A righteous and responsible man loved by his great God.

LIST OF PUBLISHED BOOKS

False Men & True Christians, 1986

Living By Every Word Of God, 1986

Israel & Event Marking The End Of The World, 1987

Law And Religion In Nigeria, 1987

God's Kind Of Leader, 1988

Continuing Steadfastly In The Apostles' Doctrine & Fellowship, 1990

The Voice Of One Crying, 1990

Beyond Pentecostal Ministry, 1992

Visitation Of God, 1993

Spiritual Worship, 1996

Spiritual Foundation for Good Governance (Vols 1 & 2), 2002

The Present Truth, 2008

The Agenda For Church Reforms, 2009

The Restored Church, 2010

The Restored Church: A Wake-up Call, 2010

The Restored Church: Book Summary/Review, 2010

Pastor Adeboye On "Three Persons Of God", 2011

Mbadinuju: How I Governed Anambra State, 2012

How I Governed Anambra State: Book Summary, 2013

Who Then Is This Jesus, 2014

Who Then Is This Jesus: Book Summary, 2014

Journey Into The Past: Ordeal Of A State Governor, 2015

WORDS ON MARBLE

DATELINE 1995:

Interview with Chief (Dr) C.C. Mbadinuju (Odera) by Goldlink Awards Production

IHIALA LGA WHO IS WHO

"A man who is self-reliant, positive, optimistic, and undertakes his work with the assurance of success magnetizes his condition. He draws to himself the creative powers of the universe". Anon

THE ENCOUNTER WITH DR C.C. Mbadinuju was very overwhelming. He is a curious character, a reporter's dilemma. We had gone with the knowing arrogance of all pressmen hunting their quarry for the kill, but we were defeated. It was like that of the cockroach that went to lick a little bit of read palm oil and got itself swallowed by oil, like touching a sleeping tiger by the tail.

Dr C. C. Mbadinuju is a real genius of his time, with a mind as fertile as a virgin forest. He had answers for every question presented to him, answers that are so different from the general trend. Interviewing him leaves you with a clear-cut impression that lack of education is a crime against development. Yet having the education without versatility is another crime as monumental as not having it at all.

But our defeat did not end with the encounter alone. We waded through spiritual matters without realizing that he is quite an authority in the field, with many books written and published in that direction. It was as deep as the Pacific Ocean.

Our personality was born into a poor background where he could not afford a secondary education although his parents tried for him. Like Luther, the church he went to in his youthful days was actually in a sad state spiritually, and had been getting worse by the day. And like Luther, he is attacking the indolence and state of inertia of the minds of the present-day Christian through his books.

We can therefore say with certainty that the success story of Dr. C. C. Mbadinuju is a tribute to industry of mind. For a man who had little or no opportunity at birth, to now rise to the present position of eminence leaves one with no other objective excerpt industry of mind, a preserving spirit and a trust in his God. Of course, he attributed his secret of success to absolute reliance on God. He has a deep conviction in the concept of destiny, nay, that whatever a man shall be has to been written in the beginning. The very reason the people of Uli gave him the traditional title of Odera 1 of Uli.

So, for those who hunger daily to be important and as learned as our personality, the road is clear. The secret has been revealed in His resume presented below in tabular form, which will buttress everything and point the touch of understanding through the many steps he trudged to become what he is today, inspite of all the difficulties of life. He is a teacher a lawyer, a political scientist, a social commentator, author and publisher, and a religious commentator. Jesus Christ said it.

"Whoever will come after me, must be ready to carry his own cross"

Thus, if you want to be like Dr. C.C. Mbadinuju the you must be ready to suffer the flesh, you

must be willing to endure the numerous pains of his life. He was born in 1945 at Uli to the Mbadinuju family of Ndikpo Umuaku, Uli. He began his primary school at Uli around 1951.

In 1957, when he got out of primary school, he was unable to proceed, like others, into the college. It was due to financial problem. There was none, and his immediate society was basically subsistent farmers. However, there was this inner, most unwillingness in his parent and well-wishers not to waste the intellectual potential in the young lad, whereby he was advised to go straight for the teacher's education programme.

This decision took him through Bishop Lasbery College, Irete, Owerri between the 1959 to 1962 for the teacher's certificate. His hunger for knowledge saw him obtaining his G.C.E, O' Level and A' Level paper between 1964 and 1966. Thereafter he got admission into the University of Ibadan, by the knew it was a pipe dream because of financial constraints. What he did instead was to write an application for further studies to the United States of America. Fortunately, he was offered a place at the State University of New York on scholarship. Nobody has ever done this before, but his courage and faith made it possible. The Holy Book said it:

"If thou canst believe, all things are possible to him that believeth" (Mark 9:23)

Yes, he believed, he relied on God completely and his life changed.

Nevertheless, he found it hard to transport himself to America. The fare was not much, but at the time in question, it was a mission impossible to put together such kind of money. It was not until Late Chief S.B.C. Ohuoha (one of his mentors) who was a Headmaster, came into the scene, did he find salvation. God works in mysterious ways; most often he uses people to perform miracles.

Chief Ohuoha immediately arranged for our personality to get loan from the mission. Late Chief Agbasoga from Oguta was the man in charge of the school system then and he quickly granted the loan. This was of course repaid within the first few months abroad after he had finished a summer job.

Be that as it may, on the getting to America, Dr. C.C. Mbadinuju realized that only the sky was his limit. America has great prospects for those who are willing to work hard enough. Dr. C.C. Mbadinuju was very willing, even eager to work, He was like the thirsty man in the desert through who suddenly discovered an Oasis. Within a period of two and half years sojourn in New York, he was already through with his Bachelor of Arts in Political Science at the State University of New York, New Paltz. That was in June 1969. A year later, he was a proud of master's degree in Government (International Affairs) at Ohio University, Athens, Ohio State, working at the same time in the University as a teaching Assistant in the Government Department. From 1971- to 1974, he was an Assistant Professor, State University of New York at Cortland, New York; a visiting Professor at Upper College of the State University of New York, Utica/Rome, New York; and at the same time, he studied for his Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) in International Law and Relation, Cornell University, Ithaca, New York.

Ordinarily, one should be satisfied with this achievement but our personality was not. From 1975 to 1977, he took a study leave to

study law at the University of Southampton, England. When he got back to the country in 1977, he later got into the Nigerian Law School finishing in 1979 while working at the same time in the Daily Times as Editor of Time International and as the General Manager, Star Printing and Publishing Company Ltd., Enugu between 1979 and 1980.

Reflecting on his achievement so far in life, Dr. C. C. Mbadinuju, in a humble voice, saw a visible hand of God in all his undertakings. And he was most sincere. No one, form his type of background, could really have attained such a height in life, if God was not with him. A glimpse at his Curriculum Vitae here will buttress this claim better.

He went through the Bishop Lasbrey College, Irete, Owerri for Secondary education; State University of New York at New Paltz, USA; Ohio University, Athens, Ohio USA; Cornell University, Ithaca, New York, USA; University of Southampton, England, Nigeria Law School Victoria Island Lagos. For these academic journeys, he has the following results to show for it; 6 O' Level papers; 3 A' Level papers; B.A (Cum Laude) in political science: M.A in Government; Ph.D. in Government (International Law and Relations); LL. B and BL.

Dr. Mbadinuju has held series of academic and non- academic appointment as a teacher; Administrative Intern; Assistant Professor; Visiting Professor; Faculty Research Associate; Associate Professor; International Affairs Correspondent; Editor, Times International; General Manger, Star Printing and Publishing C. Ltd; Director of Planning and Research; Special Assistant to the President of Nigeria in the 2nd Republic and a Legal Practitioner.

And for this intelligence and perseverance of mind, he garnered a lot of academic honors. He has equally published various articles in different journals: "The Ideological Framework of Africa Opposition of South Africa's Apartheid Policy; Elective Politics and the Hope of Blacks Americans' and others.

He has a lot of books in his name, such as False Men and True Christian (1986); Living by Every Word of God (1986); Israel in the Policy of Nations (1987); God's kind of Leader (1988); Law and Religion in Nigeria (1987); The Voice (1990); Perfection (1992) and the Visitation of God (1993).

He is also credited with numerous articles published in various newspapers, more than 30 of such articles. We can therefore describe him as exceptional among the most prolific writers in Nigeria. He is a member of various professional and non-professional organizations in and outside Nigeria.

Based on the above complex nature of our personality the staff of Gold link Awards who visited his Law Chambers along Oguta Road in Onitsha, could not help firing few questions at him, convinced that his opinions will provide the much need answers on the various issues affecting us in Ihiala L.G.A. and in the country.

The first questions we raised before him centered on the relevance of the Law profession in the scheme of things in the present Nigeria. Until we met him, we were convinced that the legal profession had been dragged to the mud and soiled extensively and that in the interim. It had outlived its usefulness, considering the fact

that most lawyers, were now content to be only "charge" and "bail lawyers", the younger members being so inexperienced due to the high cost of legal books, and the evident contempt with which most leaders manipulate the legal practitioners in Nigeria. We were equally convinced that much harm had already been done on the legal profession because of the selfish and greedy personalized interest of the Bench.

It was like touching a live wire, Dr C.C. Mbadinuju came up with reasons upon reasons at defending the legal practice and the lawyers in Nigeria, emphasizing each point like a teacher who was in charge of a couple of dullards, and who, now and then questioned himself as to why he was taking this trouble at all. Democracy, he explained, is a very patient process which applied to governance. It calls for continuous learning processes. The military which has ruled the country more years than the civilian since independence has its own version of democracy. Some feel that the military, with its autocratic system and process should not be seen or heard to operate democracy. But in fairness to the military, through a process of trials and error, they have so far, managed to hold the nation together, not because they are democratic, but of inspite of it. The fact that every military regime since 1966 had always appointed a civilian Attorney General goes to show the indispensability of Lawyers in our national socio-political life, Dr. Mbadinuju said. Although democratic privileges are said to be observed by the military, freedom has however been curtailed in military tradition. Still people are walking freely in Nigeria largely owning to the untiring efforts of the lawyers to check and speak out against government excesses.

Talking on the rulership crisis in Uli Dr. C.C. Mbadinuju made us believe that man's greatest problem is his ego, otherwise a lot of unpleasantness in our lives would be avoided. For instance, as the legal adviser to Uli Progressive Union, a misunderstanding on who should be the next Igwe of Uli demanded intervention. He had called the different camps together, about seven times in his house, for settlement, at which time he explained to them that whoever should unilaterally install himself the Igwe of Uli will be stopped by Court injunction which would mark the beginning of many troubles ahead.

Unfortunately, at the end of the day, his peace overtures did not sail through.

However, before the final peace overtures, one camp installed themselves as Igwe of Uli and the other camp came to him with a request that he represents them in court. But he declined to take the brief, he rather initiated meetings in his house to find out of court solutions.

The constitution which he personally approved stipulated that the next Igwe ruled from Ihite quarters, but the man who installed himself as the Igwe came from Umuaku, with the explanation that traditionally, Umuaku is vested with the rights and privileges to producing the Igwe of Uli perpetually. This was wrong because the constitution was written in the first place to check the tendency among individuals in the future who might try to lean on traditional for the satisfaction of personal ambitions.

The world is indeed like a mystery book, with a lot of complexities. You'll be pushed to wonder why some people are seen to be better

off than others. Invariably, you will begin to doubt the impartially of our Creator, seeing as that the law of "Sowing and Reaping" is contradicted. However, the concept of reincarnation seems to hold a better explanation to this riddle of life.

Understandably Dr. C. C. Mbadinuju, perhaps by virtue of his strong views, believes in Gods pr-ordination in all things. The fingers, he pointed out are all useful yet they are not equal in size. God is not partial. Everything is for a purpose.

Dr. C. C. Mbadinuju believes strongly that if everybody should perform his /her function, the world will be better place to live. He classified mankind into two groups: "Those created in the image of God and others who came after the multiplicity of conception". This later group will perish. Examples of men who were created in God image, he disclosed are: Adam and Eve; Abraham, Isaac and Jacob, Joseph (the Patriarchs). Jacob was created in God's image while Esau was not. Even in the womb, God told the mother:

"Esau, I hate, Jacob I love"

He gave another example with the disciples of Jesus Christ. One of them, the betrayer, Judas was not created in the image of Good. Rahab, though a harlot, was saved because she was created in Gods image. He quoted:

"It is not by your good works that you can be saved". Again, not everyone who says to me "Lord, Lord', shall enter the kingdom of Heaven (Matt 7:21)"

In his own words.

"Unless you are created on the 6th day, you cannot be in the image of God. Only God can tell people whether they are created on the 6th day through His messengers in every generation".

Of course, Dr. C. C. Mbadinuju believes that he was created on the 6th day". And by the law of "Like Attracting Like", it should have been expected that he would bring into life children who are equally created on the 6th day'. But Dr Mbadinuju disagreed, saying unless his children obey him, then they are cannot possibly be in his group.

A Christian, Dr. Mbadinuju is married to Nnebuogo Mbadinuju (nee; Okezie from Ihiala) and they have six children. Both of them lived in the United States where the wife studied and received the degree of B.A. in Sociology. She is now a senior Administration/Personnel Officer in the N.N.P.C Depot of Emene, Enugu.

He would wish to see Ihiala Local Government Area rise to stature we shall all be proud of. In other words, he wants a place of progress, of equal opportunities, less crime, inhabited by the people who are interested in development; with enough of qualified personnel and manpower in various human's endeavor.

He wants a local government area that can produce the next governor of the state, and eventually the President of Nigeria. A local government area with viable political frame, not given issue of narrow interest like religious bigotry. A local government area that guarantees all her indigenes equal opportunities politically, irrespective of religious association. A local government area where the young ones

are interested in positions of authority, young people who will take up leadership responsibilities with the help and advice of the elders. To this end, he subscribed to a system of joint/or the co-operative endeavors with the sole aim of developing the local government area;

"Ihiala L.G.A is obviously neglected in terms of government appointments, contract awards, because as a group, we cannot exert any meaningful pressure. Government understands the language of pressure group", he said.

Dr. C.C. Mbadinuju is a music lover and a footballer enthusiast.

DATELINE 2016:

MY GOVERNMENT DID ITS BEST UNDER VERY CHALLENGING CIRCUMSTANCES

Dr. Chinwoke C. Mbadinuju (Odera), The former Governor of Anambra State

Paul Nwosu

Dr Chinwoke Mbadinuju was the Governor of Anambra State from May 29, 1999 to May 29, 2003. He was elected on the platform of Peoples' Democratic Party (PDP).

As the first Governor of Anambra State upon the return of civil rule in 1999, he had to confront many teething challenges especially security which he decided to tackle by setting up the controversial Vigilante Boys.

In 2016 as part of the activities marking the 25th anniversary of Anambra State, Paul Nwosu had an insightful interview with Dr Mbadinuju, including all the other past governors of the new Anambra State. In the interview Odera bared his mind on all the pivotal issues he had to confront. We bring you excerpts of that interview in fond memory of the man whose prayer and wish is that, "It shall be well with Anambra State".
Please read.

What were your priorities and vision at the time you became governor of Anambra State?

During the Governorship campaigns of 1998, my Odera Campaign Organisation ensured that we toured all the wards and local governments in Anambra State to appreciate their peculiar issues and to guide us in developing strategies to solve their problems when we won the elections.

The level of political apathy among Nigerians was high. Remember, this was a time that no-one believed that democracy would survive given the history of truncated civil rule that Nigerians had witnessed in the past.

The challenges facing Anambra State during that period seemed pretty enormous and peculiar in nature. We should remember that right from the creation of the current Anambra State in 1991, it had always been at a disadvantage when compared to its fellow newly created states. While the new state retained the old name of the state first created in 1976, all the major state institutions and infrastructures were located in the "new" Enugu State.

Personally, I was convinced of my pedigree to contest for the position of Anambra State Governor and tackle the state's problems head on. In the 60s and 70s, I was fortunate to have studied widely in the US on scholarships where I obtained my Bachelors, Masters degrees and a Ph.D in Government from Cornell University and also rose to become an Associate Professor in the State University of New York by 1975. I obtained an LLB degree in Law from the University of Southampton, UK in 1977, completing my Law degree with honours in just 2 years. In my pupillage years as a young lawyer in 1979/80, I served under the legendary FRA Williams.

Dr Dele Cole engaged me together with the late Stanley Macebuh, Tony Momoh and co to make Daily Times the number one newspaper in Nigeria at the time. I served as the Editor in Chief of Times International, their international news magazine. I was then invited by Governor Jim Nwobodo to help resuscitate the ailing state owned Star Printing and Publishing Company under Cyprian Ekwensi. From Anambra State, I was

appointed to serve in President Shagari's Government attached to the Vice President, Dr Alex Ekwueme as a Personal Assistant.

At the end of the second republic, I relocated to Onitsha and set up a Law Office and later became the first National President of the Christian Lawyers Fellowship of Nigeria (CLASFON) and later the first National Legal Adviser of Full Gospel Business Men's Fellowship International (FGBMFI).

My Christian upbringing, academic and work exposure over the decades preceding 1999 opened my eyes to extent of life deficits being experienced by our people in Anambra State in terms of security, living standards and infrastructural development. I became committed to counting in public service whenever the opportunity arose to utilize my experiences to make life better for as many of my people as I could.

With the myraid of problems in the state as at 1998, I focused on God because the state needed divine intervention in every facet of life at that time. We actively campaigned and invited Anambrarians to vote for a God fearing Government that will focus on developing our new State's infrastructures, especially in state capital Awka, focus on the people's welfare and secure the people's lives and property.

In the end, Anambra believed in us and our policies and I was elected as Governor under PDP with a landslide victory over my nearest opponent in APP.

What were your challenges and constraint at the time and how did you surmount them?

In 1999, my new Government inherited a state lacking in both physical infrastructure and security. As I mentioned earlier, we had a 7 year old state with a "Big" name but hardly any significant Government presence in terms of infrastructure and development. The new state capital Awka, wore the look of a glorified local government headquarters. There were acute housing shortages in the state capital which meant that civil servants had to travel every day from Enugu and Ebonyi States to come to work in Anambra with the resultant lateness to work, low productivity and low morale among workers. At the time, Anambra had no Government House and Government business was undertaken in shabby containers littered all over the place. The State Assembly building had to be rebuilt and State Judiciary Complex was totally inadequate and unbefitting.

We were committed to moving the new state forward but our primary challenge was the acute lack of funds at the time. When I hear of the billions that my current colleague Governors receive these days as allocation, I marvel because we were in serious financial wilderness during my days as Governor. The state government received under N800m a month as our total monthly allocation, due to source deductions for several contentious projects awarded by previous administrations.

The developmental and infrastructural grants given to Anambra as a new state had been frittered away by past contractors and on our assumption in office, these same people constituted themselves as godfathers and friends of the powers in Abuja demanding payments for unidentifiable projects executed! The new minimum wage initiated by the Federal Government meant that the state had a monthly wage bill of N582m a month, leaving the Government with little over N200 million a month to solve the rest of the state's pressing problems.

But it was the issue of security that posed the greatest challenge. The pervading insecurity of life and property was so great that it threatened to kill off all social, business prospects and investment opportunities in the state. Aguleri, Umuleri and Umuoba Anam were particularly no-go areas due to the incessant communal clashes that led to destruction of lives and properties. There was a serious need for peace in the state.

To surmount these daunting challenges, we felt that there had to be a total re-engineering of our people's psyche and beliefs. I started my administration by leading the state to God, presiding over the popular weekly Monday morning prayers with civil servants, traders and everybody. I recall today, that in those days, prayers endued me with inner strength and spiritual wisdom, not to adopt an eye for an eye approach, in order to ensure the sanctity of peace in the state.

Throughout my tenure as Governor, I continued to promote peace and reconciliation with God and man. Through prayer, there was a gradual re-awakening and the people began to believe in God and in their Government. Hope returned as the state prayed and at the same time we devised a new slogan based on faith that "IT SHALL BE WELL WITH ANAMBRA STATE".

One of the challenges you had was from your political godfathers who stifled governance. What is now your view on political godfatherism in Nigerian politics having been a victim yourself?

Political mentorship, sponsorship or godfatherism as many would want to describe the phenomenon, has come to stay in Nigerian politics and is a good thing as long as both parties share common political objectives to the benefit of the state. My colleague, Tinubu succeeded in installing his successors as Governors of Lagos State because he and his political godsons continue to share the same vision and ideology of Lagos State as the hub of cosmopolitan Nigeria, with all the benefits the title entails.

However, where the godson is confronted with a situation where his political mentor or sponsor has conflicting objectives concerning the way forward for the state, then serious problems develop. This was the unfortunate situation in which we found ourselves at the inception of my administration. Many influential contractors who worked with the previous regimes were not happy with our decision to enhance transparency and accountability by liberalizing the contract bidding and award processes for state contracts to all competent parties rather than a selected privileged few. These individuals, due to their influence and connections with the federal government in Abuja constituted themselves into godfathers and stakeholders with the sole purpose of making the Government work according to the frivolous whims or suffer maximum political inconvenience.

It is quite amazing to recall that long after the opposition went into their different trenches, determined to fight my government to a stand-still, I was still suing for peace. I reached out to elders, statesmen and clergy pleading with them to intervene. I did not want to fight back because no theatre of war remains the same. I was elected to keep watch over the state and not to balkanize it. Therefore, I swallowed every pride and went for peace.

You used the 'Bakassi Boys' to fight crime but their method created more controversies

than solution. Do you regret using the 'Bakassi Boys'?

Recall that Anambra was ranked amongst the unsafest states in the country due to the constant threats which armed robbers and hooligans posed to lives and property in the state. The situation in Onitsha was particularly dire as thugs, ritualists, marauders, armed robbers and assassins effectively took over the city. Our people were being killed every day and even passengers in luxury buses were not spared. The level of criminal audacity was dumbfounding. The Government could not stand aside and watch as the whole state was wiped out of existence by these hoodlums and something drastic had to be done.

On assumption of office, we were committed to uprooting these evil doers and sanitizing the state. And we accomplished this objective through the establishment of the Anambra Vigilante Service Law to provide for the registration of Vigilante Groups in the various communities of the state and to make it an offence to obstruct any of the groups from carrying out their functions as shall be provided by law.

The "Vigilante Boys" (which our opponents called "Bakassi Boys") was an abnormal but ingenious creation which with inter-disciplinary training in political science and law I understood that their methods, though unorthodox, was constrained to adapt the outfit to meet the exigencies of the time. I believed that unorthodox times and events demand also unorthodox solutions.

As a political scientist, I understood the principles of Mutually Agreed Deterrence as a potential tool for balance of terror and also I knew that when terror is squared between the predator and the prey, peace results. For the state to become free of criminals, terror must be squared between the agents of state and the hoodlums. The situation in Anambra was beyond the ordinary and only extra-ordinary measures could sanitize it.

The evil "emperors" were out-numbered, out-classed, and completely overwhelmed. They were pursued and fished out from churches, temples, shrines, creeks and forests. "Vigilante Boys" turned them into gold fishes and there was no place safe enough to hide. The hunter became the hunted and when hunted down, they sang the names of their paymasters and "Vigilante Boys" went after them too.

Businessmen opened shops again. Fleeing indigenes returned. Churches re-started night vigils and everything just became fine again. Night life was no longer an anathema. Christmas celebrations became blissful again. Car snatching ceased. Rape and other crimes became things of the past. Anambra was back to civilization. As long as the Anambra Vigilante Service lasted, any one could forget a bag of money on a street of Onitsha and returned to find it intact.

But "Bakassi Boys" were banned because of their excesses.

Political opponents were envious of the success we recorded. So working together with their cronies in the Presidency, my opponents were becoming intimidated and overwhelmed by my soaring popularity, which convinced President Obasanjo to order me to disband the "Vigilante Boys".

In ordering the disbandment of the Anambra Vigilante Services (AVS), the president gave two hilarious but inexcusable reasons, which may be extended to expose the Presidency's degree of scorn and insensitivity towards the welfare of the people of Anambra State. First,

he told me that my political opponent was complaining that I am using the outfit to terrorize them. Secondly, that I was using the "Vigilante Boys" to revive Biafra.

These two Presidency reasons did not represent the truth in any way. They were like a bad name given to a dog to hang it. So many states at that time had their own vigilante services and none of them was disbanded on the recommendation of political opponents of the various State Governors. The accusation of Biafranism was entirely mischievous because the Anambra Vigilante Service restricted its operations to the state and majority of the criminals they were after were of Igbo Stock. How can one revive Biafra by hunting down criminals?

So I did not disband the AVS but amended their operations and collaborations with the Police and other security forces. The AVS continued to do service to Anambra people not minding the activities of 5th columnists, deriving their power from Abuja.

It took the unfortunate assassination of the NBA Chairman Igwe and his wife for the FG to deploy troops to the state and carry away all the "Vigilante Boys" and haul them all into detention, indefinitely at Abuja. Thanks to the timely intervention of Barrister Prince Nwafor-Orizu who came to the aide of the boys after every person's patience has been exhausted.

The assassination of Barrister Igwe and his wife perhaps represents the major downside to our successes in security during that trying period in our state's history. My personal ordeal has been well chronicled in various mediums. Knowing this to be criminal matter and despite my immunity as Governor of the state, I still waived the immunity and submitted myself to investigation and possible prosecution if anything was found against me. I was thoroughly investigated and the Police in their own report stated that I couldn't have killed anyone in Onitsha as I was in Houston USA at the time. The same report also said that till date, no one mentioned my name as a co-conspirator in that crime.

Nevertheless, I was still unjustly dragged to different courts on this matter. The Hon. Justice of High Court, Onitsha, in discharging and acquitting me, regretted my ordeal stating that it was a breach of my rights under the constitution to be treated in the manner in which I was being treated. The Federal Attorney-General and Minister of Justice finally wrote me a letter of final discharge based upon all the evidence or lack of it in the Police Report Files.

It is instructive to note that a Vanguard Editorial of July 2003 makes it explicit that the assassination plot against the Igwes was hatched by the same people who fanatically opposed my Government and who engineered the subsequent abduction of my successor, Dr Ngige and that the evil was hatched to finally discredit my administration and foreclose my chances of re-election as Governor of Anambra State, amongst other landmines and obstacles that were placed in my Governments path to progress. Be it as it may, I have forgiven them all because despite all inconveniences I went through, my ordeals cannot be worse than that our Lord Jesus Christ who was betrayed and crucified by his own people despite being blameless in all things.

My one consolation is that despite all the furors about the Vigilante Services, my successors have come to see wisdom in direct community policing and have continued to adopt the AVS model, which we established into law for the first time, although with

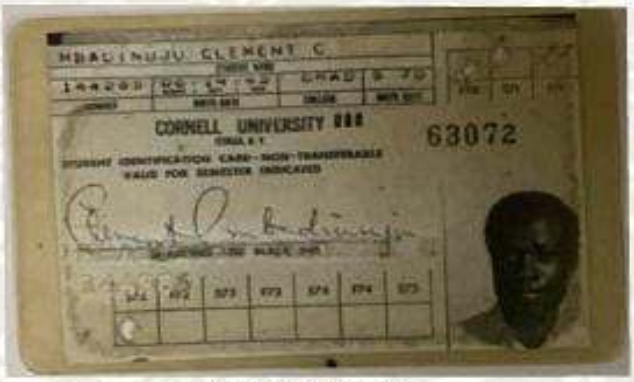
variations. Today, Anambra State continues to be rightly regarded as one of the safest and most conducive states in the country.

SIR PAUL NWOSU is currently the Hon. Commissioner for Information, Anambra State

PHOTO GALLERY

EARLY YEARS

MEMORABILIA FROM EARLY YEARS

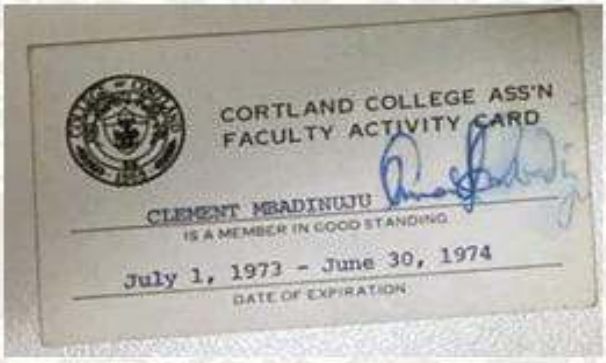


OHIO STATE UNIVERSITY ID CARD

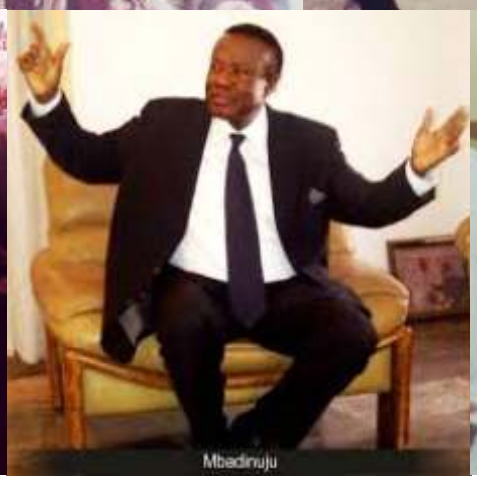
CORNELL UNIVERSITY ID CARD

SUNY ST CORTLAND STUDENT ID CARD

NY STATE DRIVER'S LICENSE



CAREER AND POLITICS



CAREER AND POLITICS

LATER YEARS

LATER YEARS

TRIBUTES & CONDOLENCE

MBADINUJU MAUSOLEUM, ULI IHIALA LGA
INSPECTION OF GRAVESIDE AND SIGNING OF CONDOLENCE REGISTER
24th and 25th NOVEMBER, 2023
Special Appreciation to:

1. **His Excellency, Prof Chukwuma Charles Soludo, CFR**
   Governor, Anambra State
2. **His Excellency, Senator (Dr) Chris Ngige, OON, CON**
   Former Governor, Anambra State
   Former Senator, Anambra Central Senatorial District
   Former Minister, Labour & Productivity
3. **His Excellency, Mr Peter Obi, CON**
   Former Governor, Anambra State
   Presidential Candidate, Labour Party
4. **Senator (Dr) Uche Lilian Ekwunife, CON**
   Former Senator, Anambra Central Senatorial District
   Director- General, South East Governors Forum
5. **Senator (Dr) Ifeanyi Patrick Ubah, CON**
   Senator, Anambra South Senatorial District
6. **Senator Victor Umeh OFR**
   Former National Chairman, APGA
   Senator, Anambra Central Senatorial District
7. **Rt Hon. Somtochukwu Udeze**
   Speaker, Anambra State House of Assembly
8. **Rt Hon. Paschal Agbodike**
   Representative, Ihiala Federal Constituency
9. **Hon. Chuma Nzeribe**
   Former Representative, Ihiala Federal Constituency
10. **Hon (Barr.) Jude Ngobili**
    Member, Anambra State House of Assembly (Ihiala 1)
11. **Hon (Engr) Anayo Orjiako**
    Chairman, Transition Committee. Ihiala LGA
12. **Ogbuehi Ifeanyi Orjiako**
    Representing Dr ABC Orjiako and the Orjiako Family
13. **Chief Alex Ejesieme, SAN**
14. **Chief Henry Okolie Aboh**

Losing a loved one is one of the most difficult things we can go through, so much more if it's a parent. No words can express what I am feeling right now and I'm sure only God can help me accept the fact that my dad is no more with us.

I don't even know where to begin but to start with saying I miss my dad. He was an incredible man who touched so many lives even before he became the Governor of Anambra State. Dad was honorable, he was kind, charismatic, handsome and knew it too! He was loving, giving and cared with a passion unlike anyone that I have ever seen.
My Dad was in every way the typical Nigerian parent, all my mom had to say when she saw us misbehaving was, “I'm going to tell your dad or your dad is on his way home” to have the behavior stop immediately. All Dad had to do was give you a look; we all know that look. No words were needed. He would give us a talk before we went to visit family friends; (as kids we were to be seen, not heard) no one was to ask for any special snacks or drinks other than what was provided. We were to sit quietly and not make a fuss. I was always perfect and well behaved while my younger brother Chet, always got into trouble.

How can I forget the 5.30 am morning bell for prayers!! Didn't matter what time you went to bed the night before, come 5.30 am better walk, crawl, roll into the living room for prayers. It was full on church service from singing songs of praise to worship to bible reading and then message which everyone had to contribute to so he made sure we were awake and had paid attention to the passage. My Dad was one of a kind and will be missed.

He was so brilliant, so well learned. He introduced us to classical music at such a young age. Believed strongly in education and ensured we were all educated. I used to love just sitting on his lap and listening to him talk. I must confess that the last time I saw him before he got sick, I definitely sat on his lap while we talked. That was always my place. My Mom called me his girlfriend and I definitely did not disagree with her. I loved my dad.

A girl's first love is and should be her father, and this was true for me. With my dad's love, I grew into a confident woman and I knew he loved me unconditionally. His love and admiration made me confident and allowed me to develop a sense of self that has served me well. His life lessons guided me through some of the toughest challenges of my life. I thank God I had such a dad.

And to my family, as Luke 1:37 says: 'For with God, nothing is impossible. 'If we as a family can put our trust in God, we can and will get through anything. While on this ride called life, you have to take the good and the bad, smile when you are sad, love those around you. Always forgive but never forget. Learn from your mistakes but never regret. People change. Things go wrong. Just remember, the ride goes on.

God has blessed us with family and friends to help us through this very difficult time, so please remember to cherish your own family and friends and Trust in God always.
Thank you for all your love, kindness and support at this time.
May God bless us all.

I miss you Daddy, I love you, Daddy. You are and forever will be my hero. God loved you and now you are home. I will see you again someday. Thank you Daddy!!

Dr. Ada Mbadinuju Okwara

The Secretary To The Government Of The Federation,
The Presidency,
Federal Republic Of Nigeria,
Shehu Shagari Complex, Abuja.
Website:www.osgf.gov.ng E-mail:Info@osgf.gov.ng

09-2911641

Reference:

6th November, 2023

Cheta Chinwoke Mbadinuju, Esq.
On behalf of Mbadinuju Family,
Odera House, Uli, Ihiala LGA,
Anambra State.

LETTER OF CONDOLENCE

I write to commiserate with the Mbadinuju family and the good people of Anambra State over the sudden death of your father, my colleague of class of 1999 Governors and the former Governor of Anambra State, **His Excellency, Dr. Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju (Odera)** at the age of 78 years.

2. Dr. Mbadinuju, as Anambra's first elected governor in 1999, was a very generous and kind-hearted man, whose lifetime was characterized by gentility and humility. He had monumental achievements and legacy projects among which is the establishment of the Anambra State University, Uli. The late Odera also signed a law that created Anambra Vigilante Services to curtail the activities of criminals in the state.

3. On behalf of my family, friends, political associates, I urge you to take solace in the fact that **Dr. Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju** lived a meaningful and impactful life. I pray that Almighty God will accept his soul and grant him eternal rest.

4. While we miss him here on earth, the Angels walk him home.

Sen. George Akume, ***fnim,*** **CON**
Secretary to the Government of the Federation

GOVERNMENT OF ANAMBRA STATE
NIGERIA

OFFICE OF THE DEPUTY GOVERNOR
P.M.B. 5047, AWKA

YOUR REF:

TEL: 048-550489

OUR REF:

FAX:

Barrister Cheta Mbadinuju, and
The Entire Mbadinuju Family
Odera Country Home
Uli, Ihiala L.G.A.

Condolence Message for His Excellency, Late Dr. Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju (Odera): Celebrating a life of service and achievements

I wish to commiserate with you and the entire Mbadinuju Family Uli, Ihiala L.G.A. on the passing on to glory of your beloved Father, His Excellency, Late Dr. Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju (Odera), the Executive Governor of Anambra State (1999- 2003).

During his tenure as the Executive Governor of Anambra State, he fostered the initiation of some development projects such as Anambra State Secretariat and prompt payment of workers' salaries while grappling with the tumultuous political punctuations of that era.

In his early years, his impeccable educational pedigree stood out in Mbadinuju's education at Mgbidi Central School, Oru, Imo State in 1955, Bishop Lasbery College, Irete, Imo State, from 1959 to 1962, State University New York, USA, from 1969 to 1970, and the prestigious Cornel University, new York, USA.

His Excellency, Late Dr. Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju would be fondly remembered for his meritorious service in various capacities as lecturer, Times training school Igannu, Lagos, and General Manager and Chief executive officer, Star Printing and Publishing Company, Enugu. He held political offices in the old Enugu State, and particularly at the National level as Special Assistant to His Excellency, the late Chief. Dr. Alex Ekwueme, Former Vice President of the Federal Republic of Nigeria between 1980 and 1983.

While being aptly captured by the renowned sage, William Shakespeare, death remains "a necessary end that will come when it will", it is our fervent prayer that the Almighty God will grant him eternal repose and bring comfort to you and your entire family.

Dr. OnyekaChukwu Ibezim
Deputy Governor, Anambra State.
Date: 6th November 2023.

OFFICE OF THE GOVERNOR

14 November, 2023

Cheta Chinwoke Mbadinuju, Esq.
Odera House, Uli
Ihiala L.G.A.
Anambra State

My dear Cheta,

ODERA: END OF A GLORIOUS ERA, A TRIBUTE.

Not many lead impactful life of service the way he did. Not many could swim such turbulent political water the way he did and still survive it to tell the story. And not many people could juggle such a number of professions and yet excelled in all of them. Like his name, God had written that he would be many things to many people, and all of them came to pass.

His Excellency, Associate Professor Clement Chinweoke Mbadinuju, was an accomplished academic. Barr Chinweoke Mbadinuju was a legal luminary. Gov Chinweoke Mbadinuju was an astute administrator and colourful politician. Yes, he was also a journalist rising to become an Editor. Who then can doubt that there is something in a name? God carved out his destiny (Odera), God was clement to him, and God gave him his fair share of intelligence, wealth, and fame (Chinweoke).

As one of the first set of governors in the current political dispensation, Mbadinuju did his best as the governor of Anambra state. The political turbulence of the time notwithstanding, he fought

a good fight. One lesson from his struggle was that one should never surrender, the circumstances notwithstanding.

Indeed, as a lawyer, he employed his legal minds and skills to wade through his challenges, and to his credit, he truly emerged victorious.

When I look at his six children today, I give God the glory for making him an exceptional father who took his responsibilities seriously. That was why I said that God has been fair to him.

Let me use this opportunity once again to console his immediate family and urge them to uphold the legacies of their father. He was truly a great man, and the family should be exceedingly proud of him.

As he joins the Saint Triumphant, after completing his earthly journey at 78, my prayer is for God to forgive him his sins, preserve his soul, and grant him eternal rest.

Sen. Hope Uzodimma CON
Governor.

OFFICE OF THE GOVERNOR

GHS/200/XII/26

31st August, 2023

Cheta Chinwoke Mbadinuju, Esq.
2 Otunba Kayode Oke Street
By TVC Communications
Off Udo Udoma Street
Asokoro, Abuja FCT

CONDOLENCE

RE: NOTICE OF THE PASSING OF HIS EXCELLENCY, DR. CHINWOKE MBAJINUJU (ODERA)

On behalf of my family, Government and good people of Enugu State, I earnestly commiserate with you and the entire family of His Excellency, late **Dr. Chinwoke Mbadinuju (Odera of Uli)** former Governor of Anambra State.

Your father contributed positively to the development of Anambra State during his reign as the Executive Governor of the State.

I am deeply sorry to hear about the passing of His Excellency, he will be remembered as a loving father, husband and for his exemplary service to the nation and humanity.

My deepest sympathy goes out to you at this difficult time. May happy memories of your departed father be a blessing and bring you comfort at this sad time.

My sincere condolences to you and the entire family. May his soul rest in peace. Amen.

Peter Mbah
Governor, Enugu State

GOD'S OWN STATE

GOVERNOR

ABIA STATE, NIGERIA
Government House, Umuahia, Abia State

September 09, 2023

CHETA CHINWOKE MBADINUJU, Esq.
Chinwoke Mbadinuju Foundation
Road 1, Udoka Housing Estate
Awka, Anambra State

Dear Mr. Mbadinuju,

TRANSITION OF HIS EXCELLENCY DR. CHINWOKE MBADINUJU (ODERA)

I received with great shock your letter dated 31st July 2023 notifying me of the demise of your father, His Excellency Dr. Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju (Odera of Uli) on April 11, 2023 at the age of 78.

Dr. Mbadinuju's demise is a monumental loss to the people of Anambra state where he served as Governor (May 29, 1999 to May 29, 2003) and the entire country at large. Words may not be enough to console you and your family at this trying moment, but I urge you to find comfort in the fact that His Excellency lived an illustrious life full of great legacies and has gone to rest in the bosom of the Lord.

Beyond every reasonable doubt, Odera was highly cerebral and had an unquenchable hunger for quality education. One would think that in his position as an Associate Professor of Politics and African Studies at the State University of New York, Dr. Mbadinuju would be a satisfied academic. But not so for his insatiable intellectual mind. He went on to pursue a law degree in England after bagging a doctorate from an Ivy League university. His Excellency will always be remembered for ending the bloody and unruly Aguleri-Umuleri boundary dispute that lasted for many years in Anambra state, and for establishing the Anambra State University, now Chukwuemeka Odumegwu Ojukwu University with campuses in Uli and Igbariam. Odera was a very successful athlete with award-winning records in field and track events in Nigeria and the US. The people of Anambra have lost a rare gem, a humble public servant, a consummate family man, an accomplished editor and journalist, and an elder statesman as a result of his demise.

On behalf of my family, friends, the government and the great people of Abia state, I commiserate with your family and the government of Anambra state on this irreplaceable loss. May God grant you the fortitude to bear this loss as you continue to live out his giant strides and legacies. I pray God grants his soul eternal rest.

DR. ALEX OTTI, OFR
Governor of Abia State

GOVERNMENT OF EBONYI STATE OF NIGERIA

OFFICE OF THE GOVERNOR

GOVERNMENT HOUSE, P.M.B. 0020, ABAKALIKI

GOV/EBS/OM/3.42/I/21 August 25, 2023

Cheta Chinwoke Mbadinuju, Esq.
Odera House Uli,
Ihiala Local Government Area,
Anambra State.

KINDLY ACCEPT MY HEARTFELT CONDOLENCE

It is with a huge sigh of sadness, that I received the news of the demise of your beloved father, **His Excellency, Dr. Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju (Odera of Uli)**, a former Governor of Anambra State (1999-2003), who bowed out from this world of mortals after a remarkable 77 years here on earth.

Life indeed, is laden with deep mysteries. At times, we are compelled by them to question our Creator as though He owes us answers. In the end, we resort to His promise of the resurrection morning - a creed which your beloved late father held firmly in his heart while on earth.

Late Dr. Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju was one of our leading lights in the South-East, and by extension, our Nation, Nigeria. His contributions to nation-building were phenomenal. Amongst all his strides, his signature in securing the lives and properties of the people in Anambra State through the introduction of the vigilante security system, is indelible. His corporal body may have died, but his legacies live on.

It is on those admirable legacies, that I charge you to build your values and surpass what he achieved. My prayer for you and your beloved family is that God Almighty will give you the needed strength to pull through at this trying time. May His love surround you now and forever, Amen.

So, on behalf of the Government and the finest people of Ebonyi State, I condole you, my dear brother, on the demise of your beloved father. May his soul rest in peace, Amen.

His Excellency
Rt. Hon. Francis Ogbonna Nwifuru, FNIOB, GGCEHF
Governor, Ebonyi State.

Olusegun Obasanjo

Agbe L'oba House, Quarry Road, Ibara
P.O. Box 2286, Abeokuta, Ogun State, Nigeria

September 12, 2023

Cheta Chinwoke Mbadinuju, Esq,
For the Mbadinuju Family,
2, Otunba Kayode Oke Street,
By TVC Communications,
Off Udo Udoma Street, Asokoro, Abuja.
E-mail: imadinuju@gmail.com; oderatributes@gmail.com

My dear Cheta,

CONDOLENCE MESSAGE

I received your letter of August 10, 2023 by which you shared with me the shocking news of the death of your beloved patriarch, Dr. Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju (Odera of Uli), at the age of 77. This, no doubt, is a very sad event and my thoughts are with the family who dearly loved him as well as with the people of Anambra State who he served with great devotion.

Dr. Mbadinuju is not a personality to be forgotten so soon. As the Governor of Anambra State between 1999 and 2003, his contribution to the socio-economic development of his State and Nigeria as a whole was quite remarkable. He was a great patriot who held the unity of our dear nation as a sacred trust to be jealously guarded and demonstrated that public service only had meaning if geared towards increasing the happiness and welfare of the masses of the people. I share with you this moment of grief and wish to convey to you and the entire family my personal condolence on the sad loss of this eminent and illustrious Nigerian.

I take this opportunity to extend my heartfelt condolence to you, the entire Mbadinuju family, the government and people of Anambra State on the demise of late Dr. Mbadinuju and pray that Almighty God will grant you all the succour as well as the fortitude to bear this irreparable loss. May his soul rest in perfect peace, Amen.

Yours sincerely,

OOObasanjo

OLUSEGUN OBASANJO

e-mail: obasanjonig@yahoo.com

Federal Republic Of Nigeria

Atiku Abubakar, GCON

Vice President (1999-2007)

Ref.

May 02, 2023

Cheta Mbadinuju, Esq
Chinwoke Mbadinuju Foundation
Road 1, Udoka Estate
Awka, Anambra State

Dear Sir,

RE: NOTICE OF PASSING OF HIS EXCELLENCY DR. CHINWOKE MBADINUJU (ODERA)

I am writing to acknowledge receipt of your letter dated 28th April 2023 on the above subject matter. I am deeply saddened to hear about the passing of His Excellency Dr. Chinwoke Mbadinuju (Odera of Uli), the former Governor of Anambra State. He was a strong fighter for democracy who joined hands with compatriots across the country to form the national vanguard of democracy that forced the military back to the barracks and established Nigeria's 3rd Republic. For his services and sacrifices to democracy, he was rewarded by the good people of Anambra state with the opportunity to lead them as Executive Governor between 1999-2003.

Let me take this opportunity to extend the deepest condolences of my family to you his son, your entire family, friends, and associates, even as you arrange to lay your beloved patriarch unto the bosom of the Lord. We beseech the Almighty to grant his soul eternal rest and afford you and the grieving family the courage and fortitude to bear this profound loss.

Thank you.

Atiku Abubakar, GCON
Waziri Adamawa
Vice President of Nigeria (1999-2007)
2023 PDP Presidential Candidate

ALL PROGRESSIVES CONGRESS

25th May, 2023

The Mbadinuju Family
Odera House
Onitsha/Owerri Road
Uli, Ihiala LGA
Anambra state.

CONDOLENCE MESSAGE

We are saddened to hear the news of the death of your beloved father **Dr. Chinwoke Mbadinuju** who died at the age of 77.

Dr. Mbadinuju was an illustrious Nigerian, whose contributions to Anambra state in particular and our great country Nigeria generally, are worthy and deserving of high commendation.

May God grant you and the rest of the bereaved family the fortitude to bear his loss, even as you look on to the Christian hope of resurrection and eternal reunion with your predeceased loved ones.

On behalf of the National Working Committee (NWC) members and the All Progressives Congress (APC) family worldwide, please accept our heartfelt condolences and may the soul of your beloved departed rest in peace.

Yours faithfully,
For: **All Progressives Congress (APC)**

Prof. A. A. Adediwura
Director, Administration

ANAMBRA STATE LIAISON OFFICE
ABUJA
RECEIVED
DATE 30/05/2023
SIGN
TIME 3:49pm

No. 40, Blantyre Street, Wuse 2, Abuja Nigeria.

ALL PROGRESSIVES GRAND ALLIANCE (APGA)

Motto: *Be Your Brother & Sister's Keeper*

ANAMBRA SOUTH SENATORIAL ZONE

Secretariat: APGA Regional Headquarters
Enugu-Onitsha Expressway Awka
Anambra State

Our Ref:..... *Your Ref:*..... *Date:* 05/09/2023

Dear Hon. Cheta.

CONDOLENCE LETTER

With total submission to the will of the Almighty God, I write on behalf of the All Progressives Grand Alliance(APGA), Anambra South Senatorial Zone to commiserate with the Mbadinuju family of Uli in Ihiala LGA on the demise of the first Executive Governor of Anambra State; His Excellency Dr Clement Chinwoke Mbadinuju(Odera). An astute and a visionary leader.

His ascendency to the number one position in Anambra State at about the most challenging times in the history of our dear State, brought to bear an uncommon leadership disposition which helped to shape the Anambra that we enjoy today.

We join the family at this difficult time in mourning the loss of a true icon.

His Excellency Odera will be highly missed but his contributions to security, peace and economic stability of Anambra State will forever live with us.

May your family find solace in the popular slogan of His Excellency" It shall be well with you"

Please accept my deepest condolences and may his soul rest in the peace of the Lord.

With heartfelt sympathies,

Chief(Hon) Ewuzie Surplus Ikem(Akaeze-Okija)
APGA State Vice Chairman
Anambra South.

Telegraphic Address:
Compol Awka
Telephone No.:
07039194332, 08080912140
E-mail Address:
statecommawka@yahoo.com

THE COMMISSIONER OF POLICE
THE NIGERIA POLICE FORCE
ANAMBRA STATE COMMAND
AWKA

Our Ref: CB: 5431/ANS/DFA/VOL.1/101 **Your Ref:** ..... **Date:** 3rd May, 2023

Mr. Cheta Mbadinuju, Esq.
Chinwoke Mbadinuju Foundation,
Road 1, Udoka Housing Estate,
Awka, Anambra State.

CONDOLENCE MESSAGE

On behalf of the Officers and men of Anambra State Police Command, I write to express our deepest condolences to your family and the people of Anambra State, on the demise of your beloved Father, **His Excellency, Dr. Chinwoke Clement, Mbadiniju (Odera of Uli)**, former Governor of Anambra State.

2. Odera, as he was fondly called, was an astute political leader and statesman who made remarkable contributions to the democratic journey of Anambra State and the Federal Republic of Nigeria. His role in the establishment of Anambra State Vigilante Services in year 2000, affirmed his uncommon commitment to the security of lives and property.

3. In this period of grief, I urge your family, as Christians, to take solace in the hope of reunion with the departed faithfuls on resurrection day.

CP ECHENG E. ECHENG
COMMISSIONER OF POLICE
ANAMBRA STATE COMMAND,
AWKA

CHURCH OF NIGERIA
(ANGLICAN COMMUNION)
ECCLESIASTICAL PROVINCE OF THE NIGER
DIOCESE OF AWKA

THE MOST REVD ALEXANDER CHIBUZO IBEZIM
B.Sc., PDGE, M.Ed, Dip. Th, FNIM, M.DIV, D.MIN, PhD

ARCHBISHOP'S PALACE
Emmaus House Complex, Arthur Eze Avenue Awka, Anambra State.
E-mail: bishopalexibezim1@yahoo.com
Tel: +2348038652776

4th August, 2023

Cheta Chinwoke Mbadinuju, Esq
Chinwoke Mbadinuju Foundation
Road 1, Udoka Housing Estate
Awka, Anambra State

CONDOLENCE LETTER

We write with grief on hearing the sad news of the demise of His Excellency, Dr. Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju, the former Executive Governor of Anambra State (1999-2003) who passed on at the age of 77.

The tenure of Chinwoke Mbadinuju as governor championed communal office prayers in the government house which spread across all the offices and establishments in the State. His administration demonstrated dedication and commitment to public service. His visionary leadership left indelible mark on the State. His legacy will continue to inspire and influence future generations.

The death of the Patriarch is a huge loss to all of us. We join the good people of our dear State to mourn with you at this time of grief. May you find strength and grace to bear your loss as we encourage you to mourn as those with the hope of eternal life which is the fate of everyone who died in Christ Jesus.

On behalf of my family, the Diocese of Awka and the Province of the Niger, we send our sincere condolences and deepest sympathies.

With heartfelt prayers,

The Most Revd Alexander C. Ibezim, PhD
Archbishop, Ecclesiastical Province of the Niger & Bishop, Diocese of Awka

GRACE OF GOD MISSION INT'L
His Glory Cathedral

BISHOP DR. P.C. NWACHUKWU
PRESIDING BISHOP

May 2, 2023

TRIBUTE

The News of His Excellency, Barrister Dr. Clement Chinwoke Mbadunuju's departure came to me like one hit by unseen hands. Though my principle is never to cry for my enemies, however, death is our last enemy that we shall conquer one day. By the help of the Holy Ghost I was able to overcome my tears and sorrow, knowing that absent from the body is present with our Lord Jesus Christ. 2 Cor. 5:8

My joy is that in 1984 I led you to Christ during the burial of your younger brother Deacon Kenneth Mbadunuju. From then on you took your love for Christ very seriously and took the gospel to every nook and cranny of Igbo land and beyond, until the arrow of the wicked hit you and you staggered a little, but thank God you did not deny your faith until death.

Clement, though you're gone but you are still speaking!

Rest assured your son - Barrister Dr. Chetachi who took after you will stand on your shoulders and look beyond your unfinished work. I promise to continue to pray for him and your family until they fulfill destiny.

Good Nite!!!

Bishop Dr. Paul C. Nwachukwu Snr.
Presiding Bishop

Int'l Headquarters: Trans-Nkisi G.R.A, P.O. Box 1939, Onitsha, Anambra State.
E-mail: graceofgodmissionint'l@gmail.com
Website: www.graceofgodmission.com
Phone: +234 8166260468, +234 7060841763, +234 8033210517.

JOSHUA HAMASHIAK MINISTRY

The Mbadinuju Family
Odera House
Onitsha/Owerri Road
Uli, Ihiala L.G.A.
Anambra State.

CONDOLENCE ON THE DEATH OF
HIS EXCELLENCY DR. C.C. MBADINUJU (ODERA)

We write on behalf of Joshua Hamashiak Ministry to express our deep sense of shared loss to the family of His Excellency Dr. C. C. Mbadinuju- Odera on the death of their husband, father, brother and uncle.

The news of his passing into glory came to us suddenly. He was until his demise a full-fledged member of our ministry which he joined since 1987 and served as the Secretary General as well as the Chief Missioner. In addition, he published several books, based on the messages of the Messenger of our ministry which include; Continuing steadfastly in apostolic doctrines, The voice of one crying; Beyond Pentecostal ministry; Visitation of God in this thy day; Spiritual Worship; The present truth; amongst others.

It is worthy of note that these books were and are still distributed freely. Indeed, Odera devoted his life to the service of God and humanity. He impacted so many lives through his prayer ministry in Anambra State, when he was the Governor of the State and also through his book publications on the way and Truth of God's salvation.

We are not unmindful of the fact that the path to the service of God is replete with obstacles and persecutions, but this is a cross every child of God is destined to carry. We are pained of this loss but we thank God for a life of fulfillment which he lived. We take solace in the fact that he believed the message of his generation.

May God give you the fortitude to bear this loss and comfort you in the name of Joshua.

Accept our condolences.

Signed:

Pastor Olisa Modebe
Secretary
For: Joshua Hamashiak Ministry

22 Oguta Road, Onitsha, Anambra State, Nigeria. Tel: 08034032497 Website: www.hamashiak. org Email: info@hamashiak.org

..... *AMBASSADOR OF* *EXCELLENCE* *_takes_* *_a profound* *Bow_

By Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Thom Obiatuegwu.

It is an indisputable truism, that man is a being unto death...Death is an inevitable reality and a call all must answer (both) high and low. Needless to say, that His Excellency Clement Chinwoke Mbadinuju is a household name whose personality and Accolades vibrates proudly in our clime, hence his death is a colossal loss and a big blow to us...

He is a renowned lawyer of international repute, sound scholar with rare Academic abilities...In speaking, the alluring cadence's that govern erudition, stands him out as a man of the letter...

I admire in profundity (one of) his famous quotes
*_Recordatus Sum_ _tui_* *_partem est potest_* *_ludere_* ..... *_Play your_* *_part and_ _be_* *_remembered_* .

...He will be greatly missed and remembered by so many people he imparted positively,(among whom) I'm a proud beneficiary....A man with a good heart who is never timorous in the face of horrendous challenges in life. If you have the opportunity of encountering him, you will wish to re-encounter him because of his carriage and maturity.

His Excellency Odera's leadership was unique, exemplified during his tenure as the Governor of Anambra State...what many who came close to him learnt from his leadership style, has continue to inspire their leadership capacity. He has leadership configured in his DNA, what a man!
May your good works go with you in the life beyond.

By simple definition and analogy... HE IS AN AMBASSADOR OF EXCELLENCE... Anyone who knows the implication of capital letters will always understand the message.

Re-echoing the words of Archbishop Fulton Sheen ...When God takes someone from us, is always for a purpose... we submit to the superior will of God and solicits He grant you a place of rest in His Bosom.

I therefore, beseech God in my fervent prayers, to extend His Gracious Consolation to the family you left behind...

May He forgive any sin you may have committed out of human frailty, pave way for you and grant you hitch free admittance into Heaven.

Thoughts and prayers

Henrietta & Bryant Orjiako

A TRIBUTE TO H.E. DR. CHINWOKE CLEMENT MBADINUJU (ODERA OF ULI)

I received the news of the demise of H.E. Dr. C.C. Mbadinuju with trepidation. More so, because I had visited him while he was unwell, but he was still physically strong and showed no sign that death was coming soon after. Or, perhaps I was in denial, given my proximate relationship with him and his family. By this loss, Ndi Anambra and Nigeria have lost one of their finest and very eloquent politicians with legendary attainments.

Overall, he was an exceedingly brilliant man who was ahead of his peers from childhood and attained various enviable heights in society. He, indeed, was an embodiment of numerous attributes, for which posterity will forever be kind to him. Some of these qualities and achievements need special mention.

A MAN OF GOD

Odera was by and large a pastor, when it comes to the service of God and man. He was an eloquent preacher and very altruistic in evangelism. He served God through music, where he used his voice and instruments in praises and worship. He also gave generously of his talent in writing and had many Christian books to his credit. As a Governor in Anambra State, he started work in the Government house with prayers on a daily basis. In all he had the fear of God.

25A Lugard Avenue, Ikoyi, Lagos
Tel: +234 80330 30091 +234 1269 0449
Email: horjiako@yahoo.com / abcorjiako@aol.com

Henrietta & Bryant Orjiako

A COMMITTED FAMILY MAN

Late Dr. Mbadinuju, left no one in doubt about his commitment and love for his family. He left no stone unturned to give his children the best education, given his sound educational background. His wife, a former first Lady of Anambra State, experienced outstanding care from Odera, who took pride in always referring to his wife as the most beautiful lady he knew. He was a clear leader amongst his siblings and a bread winner to them all.

AN ERUDITE SCHOLAR, ACADEMIC AND AUTHOR

His Excellency distinguished himself in academics. He was always ahead of his classmates in high school. He attended some of the best ivy league universities, including New York State University and Cornell University, graduating in Cum Laude grades. He took multiple courses simultaneously to become a Political Scientist, an International Attorney, and a journalist, amongst others. He lectured in his Alma Mater and rose to the position of Associate Professor and Chair of the department.

He was indeed an erudite scholar and academic. As a renowned journalist, he was the founding editor of Times International and later became the General Manager and Chief Executive Officer of Anambra State Star Newspapers. It was always a delight to read his editorials in Times International in the late 70s.

He was a serial writer who had to his credit, authorship of many books including Christian books. One of his books, "How I Governed Anambra State- Stewardship & Accountability", gave a good account of his achievements as Governor, as well as point out areas where he faced challenges.

25A Lugard Avenue, Ikoyi, Lagos
Tel: +234 80330 30091 +234 1269 0449
Email: horjiako@yahoo.com / abcorjiako@aol.com

Very importantly it exposed the facts about certain claims by false/fake political godfathers.

A POLITICIAN WITHOUT BITTERNESS IN THE FACE OF CHALLENGES

By Virtue of his sound qualification as a political scientist and a lawyer, Late Odera was fast to learn that practical politics was different from theory. He was obviously experienced, given his services under Governor Jim Nwobodo of old Anambra State and subsequent tutelage under the famous Vice President Alex Ekwueme, in the Second Republic,

When he then became Governor of Anambra State in May 1999, intra party opposition started from day one. At the time Late Odera took over the helm of affairs in Anambra State, armed robbery was at its highest level, road infrastructure was in severe state of disrepair, accrued monthly revenue was very paltry. Consequently, his administration faced severe headwinds.

Despite these, Dr. Mbadinuju was committed to achieving remarkable socio-economic changes, but the intractable crises between him and some political class and interest groups forced him into some unholy alliances and compromises which stood in the way of progress. Notwithstanding, he had a unique way of embracing foes and friends. He was a politician without bitterness, and he respected the political class enormously. The rest is history.

In spite of the challenges he faced, Dr. Mbadinuju will be remembered for his lasting legacies, such as the upgrading of the Anambra State Polytechnic Uli,

25A Lugard Avenue, Ikoyi, Lagos
Tel: +234 80330 30091 +234 1269 0449
Email: horjiako@yahoo.com / abcorjiako@aol.com

to Anambra State University of Science and Technology (ANATECH ULI) - now Chukwuemeka Odimegwu Ojukwu University with campuses in three senatorial zones of the state.

He equally confronted the armed robbery scourge, by establishing the Anambra State Troopers; dismantled roadblocks in the State, to save Ndi Anambra the attendant harassments on the roads.

Although certain unorthodox practices crept in at some point, but his administration successfully curtailed armed robbery in the State at the time.

AT HOME WITH TRADITION

In Uli, he contributed his bit in the town through legal advisory services to the Igwe-in-Council. He was rewarded with the traditional title of Chukwudera (Odera, for short). He was at home with his people and was known for his great sense of humor. He was a man of simplicity and boundless humility.

CONDOLENCES

We pay Odera a special homage, as he passes on to Glory. We condole with his family, especially his wife, Mrs. Nnenne Mbadinuja and his children. Ndi Uli have lost an illustrious son, Ndi Anambra lost a former Governor and Nigeria has lost one of her Statesmen of Service.

May God grant his family strength at this time, as we pray for the peaceful repose of his soul.

25A Lugard Avenue, Ikoyi, Lagos
Tel: +234 80330 30091 +234 1269 0449
Email: horjiako@yahoo.com / abcorjiako@aol.com

Henrietta & Bryant Orjiako

ODERA! MAY GOD RECEIVE YOUR SOUL.

GO IN PEACE.

ADIEU.

Henn/ABC Orjiako

25A Lugard Avenue, Ikoyi, Lagos

Tel: +234 80330 30091 +234 1269 0449

Email: horjiako@yahoo.com / abcorjiako@aol.com

SENATOR MRS. UCHE EKWUNIFE Ph.D (IYOM)

(ADAUGO-IGBO, ANYANWU-NRI KINGDOM)

CHAIRMAN, SENATE COMMITTEE ON SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

7th June 2023

Barr Chetachi Mbadinuju & Family,

A HUMBLE AND GREAT LEADER GOES HOME!

I received with rude shock the news of the death of the former Governor of Anambra state, His Excellency Dr Chinwoke Mbadinuju.

Dr Mbadinuju was a great, compassionate and kind personality, apostle of peace and developmental politics whose enormous contributions and achievements towards the political landscape and socioeconomic development of the state will forever be remembered.

Odera as he was fondly called by admirers and associates demonstrated capacity, brilliance and unlimited emotional intelligence and his administration impacted greatly to the people of the state through high-impact projects across the state.

I will remember Dr Mbadinuju as a very humble, cerebral and good-natured man with deep love for God and the welfare of the people.
Love him or hate him, Dr Mbadinuju believed in human capital development and served the state to the best of his ability even with the very limited resources available then and he earned the deserved credit of tackling infrastructural deficit and intense insecurity that confronted the state during his administration.

Although death is inevitable, the death of Dr Mbadinuju is a painful and colossal loss to the state and our country. I can attest that he was a distinguished Nigerian and devoted Christian who lived a fulfilled life of service to humanity.

On behalf of my family and the good people of Anambra Central Senatorial District, I commiserate with the family, Uli community and the Government and people of Anambra state on the irreplaceable loss.

May the gentle soul of His Excellency Dr Chinwoke rest in peace.

Sen Uche Ekwunife (Iyom) PhD, CON
Chairman Senate Committee on Science & Technology

CENTRAL BANK OF NIGERIA
Central Business District,
P.M.B. 0187, Abuja
Tel: 09-46235055,35017
Web: www.cbn.gov.ng

DEPUTY GOVERNOR, FINANCIAL SYSTEM STABILITY
CENTRAL BANK OF NIGERIA

REF: GVD/DGF/GEN/LTR/003/104 **20 July 2023**

Cheta Chinwoke Mbadinuju, Esq
Chinwoke Mbadinuju Foundation
Road 1 Udoko Estate
Awka, Anambra State

My dear Brother,

RE: NOTICE OF THE PASSING OF HIS EXCELLENCY, DR. CHINWOKE MBADINUJU (ODEARA)

I received with great sadness news of the passing of your beloved father, **His Excellency, Dr. Chinwoke Mbadinuju (Odera)** at the age of 77 years.

My heartfelt condolences to you and the entire Mbadinuju family on this great loss of an elder statesman, a journalist, lawyer, professor of politics, and the former Governor of Anambra State.

Notwithstanding the immeasurable grief, we are thankful to God for the impactful life your father led and his significant contributions to his community, Anambra State, and broader Nigerian economy. May his rich legacy and fondly shared memories bring you all comfort at this difficult time.

Once again, please accept my deepest condolences.

Yours sincerely,

Mrs. Aishah N. Ahmad, CFA
Deputy Governor, FSS

HIS EXCELLENCY
CHIEF WILLIE M. OBIANO
BSC. MBA. FCA. KCSG

330 Rayford Rd. Number 272.
Spring, Texas, 77386, USA
+346-497-8031 (WhatsApp)
ObianoW@gmail.com

Tribute to Dr Chinwoke Mbadinuju (1945-2023)

By Willie Obiano

I am saddened to learn of the passage, on April 11, 2023, of the first Anambra State governor in Fourth Republic, Dr Chinwoke Mbadinuju, in Abuja.

Mbadinuju's reign as Anambra governor from 1999 to 2003 was a challenging period. He did his best to grapple with insecurity, perpetrated mostly by ruthless, unconscionable robbers, who were armed to the teeth. He curbed the menace, though his method was unorthodox.

He faced severe challenges not just from contractors and the political class, but also from his own party men and women, who demanded Irrevocable Standing Payment Orders every month from the state's share of the monthly federal allocation for jobs done for the government, regardless of the terms or performance of the contracts. He also faced politicians, who fancied to be called godfathers of the state.

Mbadinuju, who was born on June 14, 1945, must be remembered for, at least, two outstanding things, which defined Anambra people: the determination to succeed despite all odds and the love of education, which saw him establish the state university, now known as Chukwuemeka Odumegwu Ojukwu University, with campuses in Uli, Ihiala Local Government Area, and Igbariam in Anambra East LGA.

He had pulled himself up by the bootstraps through an excellent academic record. He was always ahead of the class in primary school, and despite not having the benefit of a secondary education, he passed the General Certificate of Education papers in flying colours at the Ordinary and Advanced levels in just one sitting each.

An accomplished singer and organist, he studied Music as a private student at a leading British institution and passed with distinction.

Mbadinuju was a brilliant student at the State University of New York, where he studied Political Science on a scholarship, ending up with a doctorate from Cornell University in New York, an Ivy League institution.

He quit his job as an Associate Professor to read Law at the University of Southampton in England.

On his return to Nigeria, he joined journalism and rose rapidly through the ranks. Apart from being the Times International founding editor in Lagos, he served in Anambra as the general manager of the state-owned Star Printing and Publishing Company. He become the Director of Information and later a presidential aide in 1982.

A keen sportsman, Mbadinuju left an outstanding record in track and field events. His record as an athlete at Bishop Lasbery Teachers College, Irete, near Owerri, Imo State, remains unbroken. He was among the top 11 football student players in the United States during his undergraduate days and represented the US in different competitions.

Anambra people acknowledge Mbadinuju as the governor, ended, within a couple of months in office, the almost intractable Aguleri-Umuleri boundary dispute, which cost many lives, houses and other huge assets for years.

A humble and easily approachable man, Mbadinuju had a short memory of hate. He forgave and forgot almost immediately he had a misunderstanding with anyone. An intensely religious person, he wrote 10 books on Christian spirituality.

May the good Lord forgive the sins of Dr Clement Chinwoke Mbadinuju and welcome his soul into paradise.

Chief Willie Obiano
Ebubedike Aguleri.

SENATOR. EMMANUEL NNAMDI UBA MFR.
NO 14 Vaal Street, Off Rhine Street, Maitama- Abuja
andyuba10@gmail.com +2348131900006

7th November, 2023.

THE MBADINUJU FAMILY
Umuaku Ndikpo Village of Uli.
Ihiala LGA, Anambra State.

ATTENTION: CHETA C. MBADINUJU, ESQ

CONDOLENCE MESSAGE

I, on behalf of my family wish to express my heart-felt condolences to you on the death of His Excellency, **Late Dr Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju (Odera).**

We are celebrating the Life of **Late Dr Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju (Odera)** as loving and caring person, Who lived a Christian Life in his numerous services to God and to humanity.

For the foregone reasons, we do not sorrow like those without hope but we review in the sweet memories of the exemplary life, which **Late Dr Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju (Odera)** lived, while he was with us. More importantly, we are confident that he has gone to rest with our Creator, after such a rewarding sojourn on earth.

I pray God to continue to comfort and uphold the family that he left behind and of course, comfort all, who is affected by this irreplaceable loss.

God bless you!

Your's Faithfully

Senator Emmanuel Andy Uba, MFR

Ikedi G. Ohakim

"ODERAA... A LEGEND LIVES ON"
A TRIBUTE TO HIS EXCELLENCY, DR CHINWOKE MBADINUJU (*ODERAA*)

Several months have passed and we are yet to overcome the grief which the death of this great leader has brought on us. I am tempted to say that it seems like only yesterday that he passed away. Quite frankly, it is not simply that we miss his political presence but the fact that he was, after all, a **Father**, an **Organizer**, a **Coalition Builder**, a **Motivator**, a **Journalist** and a **Moral Leader** whose unique combination of courage, conviction, experience, resilience and sagacity are unmatched in our society. He was a trailblazer.

The death of H.E. Dr. Chinwoke Mbadinju is a national tragedy whose direct victims are people of Anambra State. We should all be consoled in the knowledge that "**There are Heroes and they are Legends, Heroes get remembered but Legends never die...**" *Boney Kapoor*. Oderaa, as he was fondly called has transited but as a Legend, his spirit still lives.

H.E. Dr. Chinwoke Mbadinuju was born on 14th June, 1945 in his hometown Uli, Ihiala L.G.A. of Anambra State. His academic career saw him through to obtain a Doctorate Degree in Government after which he became an Associate Professor of Politics and African Studies at the **State University of New York** prior to his political sojourn.

ODERAA served as Personal Aide to the Governor of Old Enugu State, **H.E. Dr. Jim Nwobodo** as well as Former **President Shehu Shagari**, between 1979 to 1983. He became the Governor of Anambra State from May 29th, 1999 to May 29th, 2003 on the Platform of the **Peoples' Democratic Party** during which he signed into law the bill that created **Anambra Vigilante Service** and establishing Anambra University, Uli.

For all those who are affected by the death of this political colossus, please be reminded that Jesus died and rose again and God will bring with Jesus, those who have fallen asleep in him. I implore you all to cling to the knowledge that there is life after death as the dead in Christ will rise first, on the resurrection morning ***(1 Thessalonians 4:14-16)***.

ODERAA led a pious life worthy of emulation and as a legend, his spirit still lives amongst us which confirms the scripture in ***Philippians 1:21, "to live is Christ and to die is gain"***.

May his ever gentle soul rest in the bosom of God Almighty, Amen.

H.E Dr. Ikedi Ohakim

Burma Retreat, Okohia, Isiala Mbano, Imo State - Nigeria | M: ikedi@ikediohakim.com | W: www.ikediohakim.com

MAMA ANAMBRA

DAME VIRGY ETIABA FOUNDATION

Proverbs 19:17 - He that hath pity upon the poor lendeth unto the Lord, and that which he hath given will He pay him again.

5th November 2023

H.E Gov Dr. Chinwoke Mbadinuju Family
Uli, Ihiala, Anambra State

Attention: Cheta Mbadinuju

H.E Dr. CC Mbadinuju 1945 -2023
My Tribute

It is with much grief that I write to commiserate with your esteemed family on the death of your highly distinguished patriarch, **His Excellency Dr. Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju (Odera)**

Your late father was the first Governor of Anambra State at the inception of this current democratic dispensation, and a greatly accomplished son of the entire South East geo-political zone of Nigeria. He will undoubtedly be highly missed.

I join numerous friends, well wishers, your family, the entire Uli community, Ndi Anambra and indeed well meaning Nigerians in recalling the fact that he did his best in his lifetime, for the emancipation of our people.

It is my fervent prayer that our Good Lord grants him eternal rest in one of His many mansions in heaven.

Amen.

Sincerely

Dame (Dr) **Virgy Etiaba** CON, FELUN
Fmr. Governor Anambra State

DAME VIRGY ETIABA CENTRE, INYABA, UMUDIM, NNEWI, ANAMBRA STATE
1 EZILLO STREET, INDEPENDENCE LAYOUT, ENUGU, ENUGU STATE
5 C&I LEASING DRIVE, LEKKI PHASE 1, LAGOS, LAGOS STATE
65 EVO ROAD, G.R.A PHASE 2, P.H, RIVERS STATE
14 AGADEZ CRESCENT, WUSE 2, ABUJA FCT

His Excellency
SENATOR (OBONG) CHRIS EKPENYONG Ph.D, FNSE, FNIM
Akwa Ibom North-west Senatorial District
Vice Chairman, Senate Committee On Water Resources

9th June, 2023

His Excellency, Prof. Charles Soludo
Executive Governor of Anambra State
Government House, Awka
Anambra State

Your Excellency,

LETTER OF CONDOLENCE

On behalf of my family and the good people of Akwa Ibom Northwest Senatorial District, I write to condole with Your Excellency, the Mbadinuju Family, the Government of Anambra State and indeed all Ndi Anambra over the demise of **His Excellency Chief Chinwoke Mbadinuju, "Odera",** former Governor of Anambra State.

We are sincerely humbled and saddened by the news of the death of this erudite statesman who served as Governor of Anambra State between 1999 and 2003 and we share in the grief of Ndi Anambra for this irreplaceable loss.

However, we are sincerely grateful to God for the gift of the illustrious life of "Odera" as we also join to celebrate the beautiful legacies and contributions he bequeathed through an exemplary life that exemplified the epic values of diligent service, patriotism, creativity, industry and selflessness as a private citizen, Governor of Anambra State and as a Nigerian Statesman.

We therefore pray that the good Lord will grant Your Excellency, the Mbadinuju Family, all Ndi Anambra and all those he left behind the grace and inner strength to get through this sad and difficult time.

Please accept our deepest and sincere condolences.

Yours Sincerely

Senator Christopher Ekpenyong *Ph.D, FNSE, FNIM, FNIEEE*

National Assembly
Suite 1.01 New Senate Building, Three Arms Zone P.M.B 141, Garki, Abuja, FCT
Tel: +234(0)803 382 8815 | E-mail: christopher.ekpenyong@nass.gov.ng

Anyim Pius Anyim LLB, LLM

May 17, 2023

Cheta Mbadinuju
Chinwoke Mbadinuju Foundation
Road 1, Udoka Estate
Awka, Anambra State

CONDOLENCE LETTER

On behalf of my family, I wish to sincerely extend our heartfelt condolences to you and your entire family over the death of your beloved father, the former Executive Governor of Anambra State, **His Excellency, Dr. Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju (Odera of Uli)** who triumphantly joined his creator at the age of 77 years.

His Excellency was a father not only to his family but to the entire people of Anambra State while he lived. He was an accomplished elder stateman and a distinguished governor who rendered selfless service to his people and indeed the country at large.

As the family prepare for his final rite of passage, I send my sincere condolences to you and all those left to mourn him as I connect with you in prayers for the peaceful repose of his soul.

Please accept my deepest condolences.

Anyim, Pius Anyim, GCON

SENATOR DR. ORJI UZOR KALU (MON)

CHIEF WHIP OF THE SENATE

NATIONAL ASSEMBLY,
FEDERAL REPUBLIC OF NIGERIA

2 June, 2023

Cheta Chinwoke Mbadinuju, Esq.
Chinwoke Mbadinuju Foundation
Road 1, Udoka Estate
Awka, Anambra State.

My dear Cheta,

LETTER OF CONDOLENCE

The sad news of the transition of your beloved father and patriarch, **His Excellency, Dr. Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju (Odera of Uli)** got to us as a rude shock.

Odera as a former Governor of Anambra State left enduring legacies in the state and made generational impact on your family as a loving father, committed religious and community leader whose absence will now be greatly missed by all that he touched their lives one way or the other.

As a former colleague, I personally testify of his candor and frankness that reflected in his dealings and everything he stood for especially his commitment to the service of humanity.

On behalf of my family and the people of Abia North Senatorial District, I must sincerely convey to you and members of your family, our condolences.

I pray God to grant a repose to his gentle soul and fortitude for you to bear the irreplaceable loss.

Once more, accept our condolences.

Senator Dr. Orji Uzor Kalu
Chief Whip of The Senate
Federal Republic of Nigeria.

National Assembly Complex, No 4.23, Three Arms Zone, P.M.B. 141 Garki, Abuja.

SEN. ROCHAS E. A. OKOROCHA GCSI, OON, LLD, LLM
Executive Governor of Imo State, Nigeria 2011-2019
Senator Federal Republic of Nigeria 2019- 2023
President Rochas Foundation

6th November 2023

To: the family of
Dr Mbadinuju
Executive governor
Anambra state
(1998-2001)

My dear Chef

SINCERE CONDOLENCE

I write to express my sincere sympathy on the death of your lovely father, I can only imagine the great sense of loss and grief which the family now share.
His Exellency, Dr Clement C.C Mbadinuju, the former governor of Anambra state was a man of the people, fondly called Odera.

He was a peacemaker, known for selfless service to the people without counting cost of returns in discharge of duties as a public servant. A man of principle, who treasured honor rather than wealth and stood firmly for whatever he believed in.

Odera's life was a testament to pure love, good leadership and statesmanship. He will be remembered for the impact he had on those around him.
His presence in our lives was truly was truly a blessing to us.

I pray the Lord grant the entire family the fortitude to bear the irreplaceable loss

Owelle Rochas

SEN. E. A. ROCHAS OKOROCHA GCSI, OONPRESIDENT,
ROCHAS FOUNDATION

Owelle Ndigbo, Dan Jekan Sokoto, Maga Alheri Hausa, Jagaban Lafia, Aminin Kano
Address: Unity House, Area 11 Garki, Abuja. Email: senrochasokorochas@gmail.com

RT. Honorable
Chuma Nzeribe
Christie Lodge, Umudike, Ihiala
Ichuma_nzeribe@yahoo.co.ukI

02 November 2023

AN ODE TO MY MASTER:
Gov. Chinwoke Mbadinuju (ODERA)

ODERA!...as we affectionately called **Gov Chinwoke Mbadinuju** was an Associate Professor of Politics & African Studies at the State University of New York, USA before returning to Nigeria. He was a very kind man, with a heart of gold and ready to forgive and forget all transgressions against him. He bears no grudges and showed real love to virtually all who had come across him.

2. **Gov Odera** built men, and virtually all key structures of governance and public institutions you see today in Anambra State even in the face of meager federal and state resources. Many political actors across the state were first appointed into public service by Gov. Odera. Against the backdrop of **₦Billion** as FAAC Allocations to states today, Gov ODERA managed to succeed with an average ₦600-Million monthly allocation. While public sector salaries averaged ₦400-Million monthly, Gov ODERA devised other means to fund government through tax compliance measures for IGR growth, and he still delivered on many infrastructural projects. Yet, he remained largely unsung, and under-appreciated!

3. Let us peruse some of the physical developments Gov ODERA built with lean state resources & FAAC Allocations:

- **Established the Anambra State University**
- **Alex Ekwueme Square**
- **Dora Akunyili Women Development Center**
- **Government House**
- **Anambra Vigilante Service (AVS) Law 2020**
  (To protect lives & property and make the state conducive for business)
- **New Government House Complex (by Alex Ekwueme Square)**
  (Currently being completed by Gov Soludo administration)
- **Anambra State House of Assembly Building**
- **Anambra State Judiciary HQ**
- **Honorable Commissioners Quarters**
- **Ngozika Housing Estate**
- **Iyiagu Housing Estate**
- **Anambra Broadcasting Service (ABS)**
- **Procured 2-Nos. Oil Blocks - OPL 915 & 916**
- **Orient Refinery & Oil services Ltd**
- **Greater Onitsha Water scheme**

4. Early in Gov Mbadinuju tenure as Governor he invited the authentic Igbo hero and native son **Dim Odumegwu-Ojukwu** *(Ikemba Nnewi)* to declare open the newly built Government House. Then President Obasanjo raised objections but a resolute Gov. ODERA stood his ground postulating to him that we must celebrate our heroes, and that **Ikemba Nnewi** approximates all that an Igbo man wants to be. May I profoundly thank **Gov Chukwuma Soludo** for marvelously working to complete this edifice, **new Government House,** started by Gov ODERA, but abandoned by succeeding state administrations.

5. Unknown to many of us today, **Gov ODERA** made many trips to persuade then President Obasanjo and painstaking made presentations to NNPC leadership to secure the award of **TWO Oil Prospecting Licenses 915 & 916** to Anambra State for a paltry sum. He also established the ***Orient Refinery & Gas Co*** to midwife making Anambra State an oil-producing state which she is today. One day, citizens of Anambra State shall rise up to demand accountability for these Oil Blocks with about **10-50 Trillion cubic feet of Recoverable Gas** and **over 30-Billion associated Crude Oil reserves** under our feet. My office then was tasked with this responsibility!

6. As we mourn Gov ODERA's transition I salute this unsung hero who, for the only time in our history, won for Anambra State the **National Gold medal Award on Security & Crime Control,** and sustained a flawless state of total security across our lands. Under Gov ODERA Anambra State had no reported cases of violent crimes for **3-Years,** and was acclaimed as the only such state across Nigeria in **Year 2000–2002**. Gov ODERA never bothered to celebrate this marvelous and audacious feat and returned prosperity to our communities.

7. **Gov ODERA** fought for the restoration of peace in many varying communities at war with themselves. Gov ODERA stopped the bloodletting in **Aguleri, Umuoba-Anam vs. Umuleri** war and the unending **Nkpor vs. Ogidi** communal crisis. His resoluteness and determination helped restore security in a State bedeviled with communal clashes, violent crimes and high-level criminality.

8. Against the backdrop of opposition by the then federal Government, Gov ODERA signed into Law the laudable **Anambra Vigilante Service (AVS) Act 2020** paving the way for other state Governors to exercise authority on security matters in their domains. The **AVS Act 2000**, for the first time, empowered a sitting Governor, (who neither appoints the Commissioner of Police nor DSS Director in his state) to directly intervene in security matters even with an overbearing federal government. It largely re-defined the strategy for fighting crime through community vigilante, intelligence gathering and collaborative efforts with law enforcement agencies. He was a pathfinder!
What a legacy!

Rest thee well in the Lord, Gov ODERA!
We mourn, and celebrate you!
God be with you in heaven!
ADIEU! ADIEU! MY LEADER!

Chuma Nzeribe
EzealaDike Uzoakwa, IHIALA
02 November 2023

ANAMBRA STATE LOCAL GOVERNMENT SYSTEM

IHIALA LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREA

Ihiala Local Government Secretariat Complex, Ihiala, Anambra State, Nigeria

Condolence Message

With gratitude to the Almighty God for a life well spent, I, Engr. Anayochukwu Charles Orjiako, on behalf of my family and the entire people of Ihiala Local Government Area; condole with the **Mbadinuju Family** of Uli in Ihiala Local Government Area of Anambra State, on the passing on to eternal glory of their Brother, Uncle and Father

H. E. Late Dr.

CHINWOKE CLEMENT MBADINUJU

(ODERA)

1945 - 2023

May God grant those he left behind the fortitude to bear the irreplaceable loss as we pray that the soul of the departed continue to rest peacefully in the God's bosom. Amen.

Signed:

Engr. Anayochukwu Charles Orjiako

TC Chairman, Ihiala Local Government Council, Ihiala, Anambra State

A TRIBUTE TO DR. CHINWOKE MBADINUJU (ODERA) THE SECOND ELECTED EXECUTIVE GOVERNOR OF ANAMBRA STATE

We received with sadness the news of demise of our dear brother and colleague, **Dr. Chinwoke Mbadinuju**, the Second Executive Governor of Anambra State, whom we fondly call **ODERA**. We grief over this huge loss at the critical stage in the political evolution of Nigeria

1.0 TENURE & INCEPTION & CHALLENGES OF HIS ADMINISTRATION

By providence and God's design, **Gov Chinwoke Mbadinuju (ODERA)** was elected and sworn into office as the Second Executive Governor of Anambra State on 29th May 1999 after his resounding victory at the 1999 governorship election in Anambra State. He contested and won the election under the platform of **Peoples Democratic Party**, PDP, and thus, walked into the annals of history as Ihiala Local Government first son with this rare privilege of ascending the highly exalted office of Governor of Anambra State. Some school of thought opine that most of the crop of governors that emerged in 1999, at the dawn of our nascent democracy in Nigeria, did not explore fully, the enormous, inherent powers invested in their offices because of the overhang of the rot and infrastructure deficit inherited from the prolonged military rule. They further posit that some of this set of governors contended with residual power blocs that hitherto exerted enormous regional influence in governance under the military rule, so much so, that they intended to literally retain and exercise such

control and power with the elected governors. Unfortunately, **Governor Chinwoke Mbadinuju** was among early breed of state chief executives.

Most people who have had dealings with **Gov Chinwoke Mbadinuju** are all in agreement that he was a great, humble and sincere man, and with a heart of gold for every human being and that accounted for his large following and overriding votes he garnered in the 1999 general elections. However, and regrettably, his administration was suffocated and literally hijacked by those powerful power blocs that did not allow his administration a breeder space from inception to the end. The activities of these elements culminated in lots of distraction for him for an administration that dedicated itself to the noble ideals of good governance and devotion to weekly public Monday prayer sessions with civil servants.

2.0 IMPACTFUL LEADERSHIP

In spite of the daunting task of governing an active population like Anambra State and the challenge of the opposition and insatiable greed of the elite **Gov Chinwoke Mbadinuju** took on the business of governance with passion for sustenance. He stood out among his peers for providing better welfare package for the public and civil service, and stridently fought for the restoration of security and peace in Anambra State. His resoluteness saw to his determination to restore security in a State then bedeviled with violent crime and criminality. In spite of opposition to the then federal government he saw to the resolute enactment of the **Anambra Vigilante Service (AVS) Law 2000** paving the way for other state government to enact similar legislation to protect her people. This Law largely sought a re-definition of the strategy

for fighting crime through community vigilante, intelligence gathering and collaborative efforts with law enforcement agencies. Let us hereunder throw light on few areas:

i) **Civil & Public Service**

In the first 2-Years of his administration, **Gov Chinwoke Mbadinuju** undoubtedly extended salutary attention to civil servants through the deliberate policy of payment of their salaries on the 26th day of every month. Prior to this spectacular development, no Governor *(Military or Civilian),* saw it elegant

to give this definition to the payment of monthly salaries of these patriotic citizens who toiled day and night to ensure an efficient administration of the State.

ii) **Restoration of Anambra State Security**

Before **Gov Chinwoke Mbadinuju** took office armed robbers and criminal gangs reigned supreme in the State laying siege at strategic junctions used by traders and businessmen including convoys of vehicles from all over the northern states and Cameroun, to do business in Onitsha Main Market & Nnewi Auto Markets, the largest markets in West Africa. **Gov. ODERA** summoned the political will and raised an ubiquitous security team to put down the criminal gangs and launch into operation newly enacted **AVS Law 2000, against opposition by the federal authorities who saw security as their exclusive domain**! The dreaded **'BAKASSI BOYS'** good works gave impetus to the narrative of Governors being chief security officers of states as mandated by the 1999 Constitution to protect lives and property in their states. ***We salute ODERA's courage & Vision!***

Businesses flourished across Anambra State and communities declared Mass Returns to launch many development projects. The Government of Anambra State won Gold Medal Award **(National Honour on Security)** among 36 states of the federation. ***Anambra State was adjudged the safest State in Nigeria, for not recording any violent crime in Years 2000 & 2001.*** These were the **Golden era of security'** in Anambra State!

iii) **Provision of enabling environment for Trade & Commerce**

Following on the heels of suppressing the armed robbers in the State by the **Bakassi Boys,** normalcy returned to commerce and business environment across our dear State as traders and businessmen from all parts of northern states and Cameroun, once more commenced trading and business activities in the

famous Onitsha Main Market and Nnewi Auto Markets. ***The KPI (Key Performance Indicator) for the Government from this was evidenced in increased Internally Generated Revenue (IGR) from business activities in the State.***

iv) **Establishment of Anambra State University**

Within 2-Years of inauguration, **Gov Chinwoke Mbadinuju (ODERA)** administration established the very first government-owned **Anambra State University** with main Campus at **ULI,** Ihiala LGA and 2nd Campus at **IGBOARIM**. This remains a laudable achievement against the back-drop of obsessive quest for trading, instead of education, by Anambra youths and the prevailing drop in male school

enrollment in Anambra State. The **Anambra State University** system is today a successful story in eternal tribute to **Gov Chinwoke Mbadinuju** (ODERA)

3.0 Turbulence & Distractions in Gov. Mbadinuju Administration

In under 2-Years of **Gov Chinwoke Mbadinuju** (ODERA) administration, turbulence and opposition orchestrated by the called godfathers and opponents of the state deepened, widened and largely weighed down his administration and creating expectation gaps on delivery of social mandates and perception among the stakeholders and peoples of the state. The prolonged industrial actions by workers led to closure of schools for 8-Months and militated against the stellar performance of the initial 2-Years of his administration. Unfortunately, that scorecard did not guarantee his quest for a expected re-election as Governor, and thus sadly, **Governor ODERA** could only serve a single 4-term tenure as Governors.

4.0 Admonition to Her Excellency (Wife & children) and Relatives

As **Ihiala L.G.A Political Class** mourns this rare gem, an intellectual par excellence and political colossus, we thank God for this choicest gift to our Ihiala LGA, through **Gov Chinwoke Mbadinuju** (ODERA) to midwife the second elected civil administration in Anambra State. We also hope that history will be kind to him for his good intentions and deeds which expectedly will atone for any misdeeds and provoke recompense for final repose of his gentle soul in Heaven.

We promise to always stand by you and support you for the grace of **Gov. Chinwoke Mbadinuju** (ODERA) sterling service to our dear state. We hereby urge and encourage you to bear reflections and be consoled in the words from the **Holy Bible** *(Book of life)* in

Psalm 90 vs. 5b -10 and we quote,

> *"We are like weeds that sprout in the morning that grow and burst into bloom, then dry up and die in the evening. We are destroyed by your anger; we are terrified by your fury. You place our sins before you, our secret sins where you can see them. Our life is cut short by your anger; it fades away like a whisper. Seventy years is all we have – eighty years, if we are strong; yet all they bring us is trouble and sorrow life is soon over, and we are gone".*

In few words, our darling wife and sister and siblings, may we say, '*Take heart dear*'!

ADIEU Dr. Chinwoke Mbadinuju (ODERA)
ADIEU Second Executive Governor of Anambra State!
ADIEU His Excellency Governor ODERA!!

HON. (ICHIE) OHAJIANYA SIMEON
(Okeosisi Uli)
Co-ordinator, Ihiala L.G.A Political Class
For & on behalf of Ihiala LGA Political Class

A TRIBUTE TO MY PRINCIPAL/ BOSS,
H.E CHINWOKE C. MBADINUJU (ODERA)

His Excellency Chinwoke C. Mbadinuju, Odera was a politician, lawyer, teacher, political scientist, journalist, evangelist, preacher of the Word, pianist, erudite scholar, servant-leader, father, mentor, and a great principal/boss, who was never bossy. Knowing Odera was loving him.

As the Governor of Anambra State, he was dedicated, passionate and committed to the aspirations of the people of ANS. The inception of his administration in Anambra State was inundated with myriads of security and socio-economic challenges, among others. They were quite urgently pressing, and he tackled them headlong, resulting in a total overhaul of the State's security architecture. Armed robberies, banditry, internecine war in Aguleri - Umuleri - Umuoba Anam, raping of women in the presence of their husbands and children, unsafe motorways, etc were prevalent in virtually, all nooks and crannies of the state.

As the Chief Security Officer of ANS, he provided robust leadership in dealing with the humungous complex security scare, which stared in the faces of all residents and enterprises in the state and its borders. Amidst a context which was clogged with inherited situational challenges, he remained dauntless as he steered ANS to the award of First Position in Security and Safety in Nigeria, in the first Security Summit chaired by the President, during the embryonic period of his administration. Anambra Troopers and other special security outfits were set up to deal with these peculiar challenges.

In the case of fratricidal war in Aguleri/Umuleri/Umuoba Anam, H.E Late Dr. C.C Mbadinuju, embarked on a courageous quasi suicide mission to stop the carnage in an area filled with land mines and explosives, with his 19thC Bible. Though successful, I thanked God we came out unhurt.

In an undulating political cum socio-economic environment, Odera's Christian/spiritual approach to life paid off in his leadership and governance style. His Excellency did not only profess Christianity, but he also practiced it. Amongst his contemporaries, he was an epitome of humility, albeit an erudite scholar of different progressive shades. He knew God was and is always interested in the affairs of a humble man; so, he feared HIM a lot. Thus, he benefited from Him, immensely.

Odera's understanding of life, unassuming stance, peculiar leadership qualities, etc made him play Politics without Bitterness. He was amenable to unfettered access to the Government House and his administration, but not without inherent security concerns, as my colleagues and I were kept on our toes, all the way. To him, whatever resonated with the welfare and security of the people would always be prime and pursued with vigor.

Your Excellency, Odera, imagine what could have happened to your name and legacy, if the threats and campaigns to dissuade you from handing over to your predecessor on the official date of 29th May had succeeded.
I thank God, He used your ADC and Dr Ardo Umar to ensure, you did hand over, officially. You left Anambra State, better than Your Excellency met it.

It was a privilege for me to be part of your life in government, having worked with Your Excellency for 4 eventful years, in thick and thin, as your ADC (Aide-De-Camp), in total loyalty and commitment, that even made me defer my start of family.

Your prayers and kind words to my children, wife and I, in one of your penultimate moments before departure, would be consoling to us. The Biblical Joseph, you called me, lately, lent me some...
Please, as rest well in the bosom of the Lord, kindly ensure Your Excellency's family keeps strong. Adieu, sir.

DCP Sylvester Uzoefuna junior
Deputy Commissioner of Police
Fmr. ADC - H.E Late Dr. C.C Mbadinuju (Odera)

Tribute to my brother - Dr. Chinwoke aka ODERA

You are my brother, but I saw you as my father because I grew up knowing you as one since my dad passed when I was just 5 years old. Being the last born of the family, you showed me the pathway to stardom and greatness. You taught me never to accept NO for an answer and always to strive to be the best I could ever be. You are my hero and I will forever love you.

Odera! As you were fondly called was a noble man and a shining light to most people that came across him. He touched lives in no little way, an illustrious son and prolific scholar. I thank God for using you to bless and comfort the less privileged, you governed Anambra state with the fear of God. You were born great and you fulfilled your God given assignment. You came, you saw and you conquered. There awaits you the crown of glory.

Sleep on brother, father, and mentor, till we meet to part no more.

LOVELINE NWACHUKU (nee Mbadinuju).

A Tribute To My Late Uncle Chinwoke

He was a cultured, appreciative, and gentle man.

He finished a remarkable course in this world while reaching the peak of his potential, and now has returned to his maker in peace. Uncle Chinwoke will forever have a home in my heart. Particularly for the great honour he gave to my late father, Stephen Adibe. I vividly remember Uncle Chinwoke at my father's funeral, being present while also the sitting Governor of Anambra State in the year 2000.

I remember the speech he gave at the funeral and how touching it was to all that were present at the funeral. I can also recall the compassion and humbleness he portrayed when he consoled my late mother, Lucy Adibe.

He was a tender soul at a tragic time in my life, and I will never forget that.

We even boarded the same flight with Uncle Chinwoke going back to the UK from Nigeria
(I, my husband and children) , while the flight was still grounded, Uncle sent for us from economy while he was sitting in first class. He held all my children and welcomed us with good conversation. Uncle Chinwoke Rest In Peace and Meet Your Maker In Peace In Jesus Name.

From
Mrs Adaorah Amaechi-Stephen Adibe.

A TRIBUTE TO HIS EXCELLENCY
DR CHIMARAOKE C MBADINUJU, FORMER EXECUTIVE GOVERNOR OF ANAMBRA STATE

As we continue to mourn the loss of our illustrious son, His Excellency Dr Clement Chimaraoke Mbadinuju, the Former Executive Governor of Anambra State, I hereby convey my heartfelt sympathy to his beloved spouse and children, the Uli Community, and to the entire people of Anambra State. He was a purpose driven individual, a legal luminary and a renowned change agent that strived to provide better quality of life for the people he served.

As a man of great faith and trust in God, he encouraged Monday Morning Prayers in all the markets in Anambra State, and effectively used the Sate Vigilante to significantly contain armed robbery that was then paralyzing economic and social activities in the entire State. Governor Mbadinuju, also effectively cleared years of arrears of salaries and gratuity owed to the civil servants and public officials. Furthermore, with the support of many people of goodwill in Anambra State, especially Dr A B C Orjiako, Governor Mbadinuju was able to elevate the Anambra State Polytechnic, Uli to the accredited Anambra State University of Science and Technology.

Dr Clem, Oderaa, we love you. You will continue to live in our hearts and in our memories. May the Lord receive you with open arms into His kingdom and grant solace to your family, the Uli Community and to Anambra State.

Yours in Jesus Christ,
Rev Msgr Dr Felix C Ojimba

CONDOLENCE MESSAGES TO OUR BROTHER,
HIS EXCELLENCY DR. C C MBADINUJU, WHO TRANSLATED TO THE GLORY OF GOD.

His Excellency! Odera, as you are popularly called, my beloved brother. You can never be associated with death, you will forever be loved, cherished, and terribly missed. Brother, you are a movement, an entity, nobody can forget in a hurry. You served God from your foundation with our parents. You were so full of intelligence. At home in Nigerian politics when he governed Anambra State, he told them that "It shall be well with them" and really it was well with them. He governed with a prophetic prayer and declaration, It is well. The 11th of April 2023 will forever remain sad, black, and dark day for the Mbadinuju family. You have fought the good fight of faith. Brother, we can never feel at home in this world. You will forever remain alive in our hearts, till we meet again.

We your sisters – Miss, Ann, Patience and Loveline love you more.
Tribute by Mrs Uwumangbe Ann Ojiugo (Nee MBADINUJU)

You are my brother, but I saw you as my father because I grew up knowing you as one since my dad passed when I was only 5years old.

Being the last child of the family, you showed me the pathway to stardom and greatness. You taught me never to accept NO and to strive to be the best I could be! You are my hero, and I will forever love you! Odera, as you were fondly called was a noble man and a shining light to everyone that came across him. He touched lives in no little way, an illustrious son and prolific scholar! I thank God for using you to bless and comfort the less privileged, you governed ANAMBRA state with the fear of God! You were born great, and you fulfilled your God given assignment! You Came, You Saw, and You Conquered! There awaits you the crown of glory!

Sleep on brother, father, and mentor, till we meet to part no more.

Tribute by Mrs Loveline Nwachukwu (nee MBADINUJU)

With heavy hearts, yet eternally grateful to God for a wonderful life well-lived, the nephews of Dr. Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju, bid our beloved uncle farewell. Odera was more than an uncle, he was an unconditional friend, an astute advisor, a reliable confidant, and a father to us all. We miss the unmistakable sound of his voice, his passion for life, and his love for family and humanity.

The legacy Odera has bestowed on us is an inspiration for future generations. His trailblazing blueprint is characterized by his constant good deeds for his family, community, country, and all humanity. We celebrate a life well-lived and the blessing that Odera was to all of us. We are forever thankful.

Odera's unwavering faith in God is an indelible testament of his spiritual character. Odera believed in God, trusted in God, and loved to worship his Lord and Savior. We recall our desire to sleep-in during holidays being shattered early in the morning by Odera's daily call-to-prayer bells. Oh, how we all dreaded hearing the ringing of the bell! We cannot forget those early morning devotions at the Upper House! Odera followed Proverbs 22:6, and he trained us in the way of the Lord; and now that we are older, we do not depart from the love of God. Thank you, Odera!

Odera's invaluable impact is evidenced by his positive influence on our lives. We are all fortunate to have met him, lived with him, and followed in his footsteps. As we grieve with pain in our hearts, we know that it is well. Odera lived as the righteous man in Psalm 112. Blessed is Odera, who feared the Lord and greatly delighted in his commandments. We, his offspring, will be mighty in the land; Odera's generations will be blessed! It is well with Odera, who dealt generously with all of us, and conducted his affairs with justice. For the righteous will never be moved; Odera will be remembered forever.

We miss you Odera. Rest in the bosom of our Lord. It is well.

With Love,
Dr. Idahosa A. Osaretin, on behalf of all nephews.

My lovely big brother-

Your demise came to me as a shock, oh death if only I have the power to stop you!
Death remains a painful thing, my beloved brother whom I was with just recently is no more. Odera was such a brother that doesn't like to see me cry for anything, immediately he will attend to it, he always calls me baby, he loved his siblings so much. When he comes back for holidays everyone is always happy. I know he is gone but it feels like a dream, I miss him constantly. Such a pain he was taken from us, I wish he could have stayed longer but God knows the best.
Rest on my beloved brother, my heart hurt so much!

Tribute by Mrs Patience

TRIBUTE TO HIS EXCELLENCY
DR. CLEMENT CHINWOKE MBADINUJU (ODERA).
1945-2023.

It is extremely difficult for me to be writing a Tribute to my closest and number one Brother-in-law ODERA (I call him "NO ERASER" to emphasize that when God destines, No One can change it.)

My very close brotherly relationship with ODERA commenced in 1972 when he came home to Nigeria on holidays as my Guest with my beloved younger Sister NNEBUOGO (Nnenne) after they got married in the United States of America. We bonded and related more as blood brothers than as brothers-in-law. ODERA returned finally to Nigeria in 1976 with his young family of his wife, Daughter IJEOMA and Son CHETACHI after his Doctoral and Law Studies in the USA and the UK.

On return to Nigeria, Odera's young family integrated fully and seamlessly with my equally young family of Wife, Daughters ADAOBI, ONYINYECHI and Son OBINNA. Our Families blended seamlessly into one loving unit. We remained closer than most blood brothers and shared the Joys and Sorrows in our respective extended families. ODERA at this time joined the DAILY TIMES Group as Editor and also as a Lecturer at their School of Journalism.

ODERA'S incursion into Politics commenced when he joined the Government of His Excellency, Chief Jim Nwobodo and consequenty left Lagos to move to the State Capital, Enugu. We reunited when the family returned to Lagos to join the Federal Government of Nigeria as a Special Assistant to His Excellency, the Vice President, Chief Alex Ekwueme. Unfortunately, this democratically elected civilian Government was truncated by the Military Coup of Major General Muhammadu BUHARI on the 31st December, 1983.

ODERA again returned to the South East in 1984 and established his private Law Practice in Onitsha. From there he launched his political career culminating in his successful Election as the 2nd Executive Governor of ANAMBRA STATE in 1999 and he served in this position till the expiration of his term in 2003.

Meanwhile, the Children of the family continued with pursuing their Education and Professional Courses in various Institutions both in Nigeria and abroad. We continued our cordial and brotherly relationship and cooperation until the 11th April, 2023 when ODERA was called home to be with his Maker in Heaven.

It now remains for us to pray for the repose of ODERA'S SOUL in the Bosom of our Lord in Heaven and to condole all of us he left behind to mourn him, particularly his Wife my beloved Sister NNEBUOGO (Nnenne), his Children my dear Nieces and Nephews - DR IJEOMA. CHETACHI, NNANNA, UCHECHUKWU and CHIMAOBI. May God continue to strengthen and bless you all.

ADIEU DR. CLEMENT CHINWOKE MBADINUJU (ODERA).

UZOMA NNAEMEKA OKEZIE.
(AKOBUDIKE)
Brother-in-law.
IHIALA. 2023.

RAPIDLINK RESOURCES LIMITED

29th October 2023.

The family of Late Dr. Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju (Odera of Uli),

Attn: Cheta Mbadinuju Esq,
Chinwoke Mbadinuju Foundation
Road 1 Udoka Estate,
Awka, Anambra State.

CONDELENCES

We would like to express our sincere condolences on the transition to eternal glory of your dearly beloved Father, Husband, father in-law, grand-father, brother, uncle and an elder statesman, His Excellency, Late Dr. Chinowke Clement Mbadinuju (Odera of Uli), former Governor of Anambra State, on April 11, 2023, at the age of 77.

On behalf of the staff and Management of Rapidlink Resources Limited, please accept our sincere condolences to the grieving family.

No doubt, his demise will create a huge vacuum in the family, however, you should be comforted that your beloved Father, Husband, father in-law, grand-father, brother, uncle, and an elder statesman lived a fulfilled life and left legacies in Anambra State, in particular and Nigeria in general.

May the memories of your dearly beloved Father, Husband, father in-law, grand-father, brother, uncle, and an elder statesman sustain and strengthen you as you mourn his demise.

Please accept our condolences. May his Gentle Soul Rest in Perfect Peace (Amen)

Yours faithfully
For: **RAPIDLINK RESOURCES LIMITED**

Bassel Mourad, *phf*
CEO

OFFICE OF THE HONOURABLE MINISTER
FEDERAL MINISTRY OF SPECIAL DUTIES AND INTER-GOVERNMENTTAL AFFAIRS
Federal Secretariat Complex Phase 1, Shehu Shagari Way, Abuja - Nigeria

The Mbadinuju Family ***16th May 2023***
Odera House,
Onitsha/Owerri Road
Uli, Ihiala LGA Anambra State.

CONDOLENCE LETTER

I received with shock the news of the death of **HE. DR Chinwoke Clement Mbadiunuju (Odera of Uli)** who died of a brief illness at the National Hospital Abuja.

2. He was kind and compassionate to all his friends, family and those who knew him. I remember vividly his commitment and contributions to the Governors forum while we were colleagues as Governors in 1999. His death has no doubt created a vacuum that is difficult to fill, and no words are quite enough to soothe the pains his death will cause you.

3. While you mourn his irreparable passage, do take solace in the fact that he lived an accomplished life in service to his family and the country as a Governor, Philanthropist and an Elder Statesman amongst other responsibilities. These are accomplishments worthy of emulation.

4. On behalf of my family, Political associates, Management and staff of the Federal Ministry of Special Duties and Intergovernmental Affairs, I offer my heartfelt condolences and also pray for the peaceful repose of his gentle soul. May God bless and comfort your entire family at this time.

Sen. George Akume, fnim
Honourable Minister of Special Duties and
Inter-Governmental Affairs

GOVERNMENT OF ANAMBRA STATE

Rt. Hon. Uche Victor Okafor

SPEAKER

Anambra State House of Assembly, Awka

*Our Ref:*_____ *Your Ref:*_____ *Date* 25th May, 2023

Cheta Chinwoke Mbadinuju, Esq
Road I, Udoka Estate,
Awka,
Anambra State.

CONDOLENCE MESSAGE

I write on behalf of my family and the Anambra State House of Assembly to commiserate with you and the entire Mbadinuju Family on the demise of your father, His Excellency, Dr. Chinwoke Mbadinuju (Odera).

Indeed, the late Dr. Chinwoke Mbadinuju was an accomplished Politician, Journalist, Lawyer and Public Servant. He was Personal Assistant to former Vice President of the Federal Republic of Nigeria, late Dr. Alex Ekwueme and subsequently, Governor of Anambra State between 1999 and 2003. He left a lot of good legacies in the field of politics.

The late former Governor of Anambra State was a good husband, father, philanthropist and above all a devout Christian. He demonstrated his Cnristian faith by introducing the famous "Monday Morning Prayer" at the Government House when he was the Governor. He died a Pastor. His demise is really a great loss to Nigeria in general and Anambra State in particular.

I console you "Cheta" and all the family members with the fact that your late father, His Excellency, Dr. Chinwoke Mbadinuju (Odera), former Governor of Anambra State lived a life worthy of emulation. I urge you all to sustain the eventful memories of his life and times. May his soul rest in peace, Amen.

Please, accept my condolences.

Rt. Hon. Uche Okafor, Ph.D
Speaker,
Anambra State House of Assembly, Awka.

Government of Anambra State Of Nigeria
ANAMBRA STATE HOUSE OF ASSEMBLY
Office Of The Member Representing Ihiala 1 Contituency
HON. (BARR) JUDE CHIMEZIE NGOBILI
Chief Whip
Chairman, House Committee on Internally Generated Revenue
Mobile: 08033194776, 08125863221
E-mail: jngobili@yahoo.com
Office:
House of Assembly Complex
P.M.B. 5053, Awka
Anambra State, Nigeria.

05/09/2023

The Family of Mbadinuju,

Uli Ihiala L.G.A.

CONDOLENCE

On behalf of the patriotic and good people of Ihialal 1 Constituency, I hereby offer my sincere condolences to the entire family of **Mbadinuju,** on the demise of their brother, husband, father and grand-father, **Late Dr Chinwoke Mbadinuju,** the former governor of Anambra State.

As governor, Late Dr Chinweoke Mbadinuju had a clear understanding of the challenges facing Anambra State, and he painstakingly designed policies that prioritized the security of Ndi Anambra while providing a level playing field for all Anambra citizens.

I want you to know that I share in your grief, hence I pray Almighty God to give him eternal rest, and to grant the entire family the strength and fortitude to bear this irremediable loss.

Yours Sincerely,

Hon Barr. Jude C.Ngobili

Member Representing Ihiala 1 Constituency

And Chief Whip, ANSHA.

AMB. FRANK NCHITA OGBUEWU

No. 19 Onitsha Street, P.O. Box 474 Abakaliki, Ebonyi State
Email: onwaebonyi@yahoo.co.uk

Ref: _____ **Date:** 30/10/2023

Cheta C. Mbadinuju Esq,
Umuakpu Ndiakpo Uli,
Ihiala Local Government,
Anambra State.

CONDOLENCE MESSAGE

I received with hearty sympathy, the sad news of the demise of your dear father, a venerated statesman, and former Governor of Anambra State, **Late His Excellency, Dr Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju (Odera)**, who transited to the great beyond at the age of 77.

Dr. Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju was a man of vision and gentility. During his tenure as the Governor of Anambra State, he recorded a monumental achievements and enduring legacies, which are still impactful to the people.

His exceptional love for security and education shall continue to speak volume in the history of Anambra State. Posterity shall continue to remember the fact that he signed into law, the bill that created Anambra Vigilante Services and the establishment of Anambra State University, Uli.

At this moment of grief, let me also extend my heartfelt commiserations to the Governor of Anambra State, His Excellency, Professor Charles Chukwuma Soludo CFR, the people, and the government of Anambra state. Although, we have lost a Leader, who distinguished himself to the service of humanity, but I am grateful to God that his legacies on this planet shall never die.

On behalf of my dear family, I pray that God will grant you, the entire family, and all his loved ones, and indeed, the good people of Umuakpu Ndiakpo village, Uli, in Ihiala Local Government Area of Anambra State, the fortitude to bear the loss, and may his soul rest in perfect peace.

Amb. Frank Nchita Ogbuewu
Former Minister of Culture and Tourism

RT. HON. ONYEBUCHI AUGUSTINE OFFOR

Former Minority Leader, Anambra State House of Assembly

(2015-2023)

Cheta Mbadinuju Esq.,
Odera House,
Uli.

RE: NOTIFICATION OF DEMISE AND BURIAL OF HIS EXCELLENCY, DR. CHINWOKE MBADINUJU

May I offer my heartfelt condolences and sympathies to **Cheta** and **Nna Mbadinuju** and the entire Mbadinuju family in Uli, Ihiala Local Government Area, Anambra State on the transition to eternal glory of their beloved Father, **Late Dr. Chinweoke Mbadinuju,** the former Governor of Anambra State.

His death is a colossal loss not only to the family but to Ndi Anambra and Nation atlarge. Odera as he was fondly called is a consummate Administrator, a Scholar, Legal Luminary and Politician who served Ndi Anambra diligently.

Odera will be greatly missed by friends and numerous well wishers across the country even as we pray to the Almighty God to receive his gentle soul in His bosom and give his family the fortitude to bear the irreparable loss.

As you prepare to give him befitting farewell celebration he richly deserves on Friday 24th November 2023, I pray for God's direction and protection.

On behalf of my Family and Associates, kindly accept my sincere condolences.

30/9/23

Rt. Hon. Onyebuchi Offor

TEL: 08037121777, 08097283989 E-MAIL: onyebuchi_offor@yahoo.com

Government of Anambra State of Nigeria
ANAMBRA STATE HOUSE OF ASSEMBLY
FORMER MEMBER REPRESENTING IHIALA 1 CONSTITUENCY (2015-2023)
HON. (BARR) CHIDI LIVINUS UDEMADU

MOBILE: 08037055542

Contact: 44, Esther Obiakor Road, Agu Awka, Anambra State.

2nd Oct., 2023

LETTRE OF CONDOLENCE

On behalf of my family, I wish to extend our heartfelt condolence to the family of Mbadinuju and the good people of Uli over the death of their father, husband, brother, son and Political icon, His Excellency Late Dr. Chinwoke Mbadinuju (Former Executive Governor of Anambra State). I am deeply saddened to hear about the death of former Governor Dr. Chinwoke Mbadinuju. Please accept my heartfelt condolences and know that my thoughts and prayers are with the family of Mbadinuju and the People of Uli during this difficult time.

Dr. Chinwoke Mbadinuju's contributions as the former governor of Anambra State were truly remarkable. His dedication, leadership and vision have left a lasting impact on the state and its people. He will be remembered for his unwavering commitment to public service and his tireless efforts to improve the lives of the people of Anambra State.

I understand that no words can alleviate the pain of losing a loved one, particularly someone as esteemed as Dr. Chinwoke Mbadinuju. However, I hope the family finds solace in the knowledge that his legacy will live on, and his accomplishments will continue to inspire and guide future generations.

During this time of mourning, my wish for the family is to find the strength to bear this irreplaceable lost and may cherish memories of Dr Chinwoke Mbadinuju bring comfort to the family and also, serve as a reminder of the extraordinary person he was.

Please accept my deepest sympathies once again. May his soul rest in eternal peace.

With heartfelt condolences,

Hon. (Barr) Chidi L. Udemadu
Former Honourable Member, Representing Ihiala 1 State Constituency
Anambra State House of Assembly

ULI PROGRESSIVE UNION OF (NIG.) (UPU) ULI

(A CULTURAL ORGANIZATION /TOWN UNION)

Reg. No AN/MLG/TU/007
Motto: Unity, Peace and Progress

National Secretariat
Bank House
Kilometer 45, Onitsha -Owerri Road
P.M.B.4,
Uli, Anambra State.

9th June, 2023

The Mbadinuju Family
Ndikpo- Umuaku, Uli

Sir,

LETTER OF CONDOLENCE, RE: DEATH OF HE (Dr.) C. C MBADINUJU (ODERA)

The President General, **Engr. T.C Obiagazie, ksm**, the Executive Council and the entire members of the Uli Progressive Union, hereby commiserate with you over the death of the Patriarch of the Mbadinuju Family, His Excellency, Dr. C. C Mbadinuju (Odera)

Odera (as we fondly called him) during his life time here on earth was a true Uli patriot to the core. His patriotism towards the development and progress of Uli town and its people greatly endeared him to Ndi Uli. A Lawyer. A Pastor. An Academic. A Politician. A community leader and an amiable father.

As the first Executive Governor of Anambra State, of the present democratic dispensation from the Anambra South Senatorial Zone, Odera despite all the challenges of his administration had the progress and development of Uli in the inner most part of his heart. The then Anambra State University (now Chukwuemeka Odumegwu Ojukwu University) Uli Campus, the Uli Ring Road, the numerous water boreholes complete with their overhead tanks and other numerous developmental strides were a microcosm of the legacies he left behind.

We shall all miss him dearly. It is not how long, but well and positively impactful one lives that matters. Odera during his life time positively impacted on other people's lives. Death is an inevitable end, which shall only come when it will come. We have no doubt in our minds that His Excellency, Dr C.C Mbadinuju, Odera will surely be remembered by the good works he has done.

May the perpetual light shine upon him, may his soul and the souls of the faithful departed, through the mercy of God rest in perfect peace.

Please accept our heartfelt sympathies.

Engr. Tobias C. Obiagazie, ksm.
President Genera

UMUAKU GENERAL ASSEMBLY

Motto: Strength in Brotherhood

It was like the death of Julius' Caesar in 44 BC, when we heard the ugly news of unexpected demise of His Excellency, Dr. Barr. Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju, Former Executive Governor Of Anambra State {1999 - 2003}, who has not remained to reap completely, the fruit of his toil and moil.

It is so sad! Anambra State has lost another democrat, Ulians have lost a brother, a consistent fighter and outspoken voice for the voiceless; one of the very few that reached beyond the frontiers of unnatural political division. Oderaa Our brother, you reflected the true passion and vigour that heralded political arrangements in Anambra State, which steadily transmogrified into activism for return to democracy at the height of military interregnum and had remained steadfast in the call for good and inclusive governance.

Good things they say, last not! Could it be likened to the saying that good persons don't live long? You led an exemplary life of unassailable probity and unimpeachable integrity. You were a down-to-earth leader who did his best to develop Anambra State, but the Political Siroccos that surrounded your Government did not allow you to continue your second tenure bid. You made people to see politics as service to humanity. Your glorious dismissal still left a big lacuna into the hub of the entire Anambra State and Uli Kingdom in particular.

However, you were a man of reputable echelon, munificence, tolerance, and unquenchable sagacity; contrarily, you abhorred malevolence, victimization, sadism, unsolicited avarice, and most regrettably, you suffered betrayals from the people you trusted the most! You made remarkable traces of lasting tracks, on the sands of time which would remain green in our cerebrum and will hardly be flung into the bush. Your antecedents as a voice for the voiceless has been diligently followed by many who admired your charisma and empathy.

Apparently, the weapons of war perish Alas and Alack! A great void has been obliterated in Anambra State. What a pill of anguish, that made a lion to gasp, gape and pine away in a heart-throbbing pain. Nevertheless, Death is inevitable and a ubiquitous, as you bowed out of this theatrical stage when the ovation is inexorably high, we salute your guts for succeeding and for making a mark from a near-no-prior foundation. Our prayer is that, God in His Infinite mercies, will fill the vacuum your departure has created in the family of Mbadinuju, Uli and the entire Anambra State in general.

Finally, we are consoled about your demise, because we know quite vividly that you lived a life worthy of emulation! Therefore, on behalf of Umuaku Leadership Forum and Umuaku General Assembly at large, we kindly seized this rare opportunity to extend our unalloyed condolence to all of us, especially the Chief mourners of Late Dr. Barr. CC Mbadinuju, for the Almighty God in His Infinite Mercy to grant us the Fortitude To Bear This Irreparable Los.

Sir, as we bid you goodbye, may the light of God brighten your path to eternal rest in His Kingdom Amen.

Written By Comr. DonCross® Ekwughalu For And On Behalf Of Umuaku Leadership Forum And Umuaku General Assembly @ Extension.

Ogbuehi Mbanabaraugo Forum's Coordinator.

080-353-44135
umuaku.general.assembly@gmail.com
Uli Centre Umuaku Uli Ihiala LGA Anambra State
www.umuaku.general.assembly.org

ANAMBRA STATE OF NIGERIA
NDIOJUNUKA UMUOMA ULI COMMUNITY
PALACE OF HIS OGBUEHI ONOWU DYNASTY
OGBUEHI EZECHIMAHUBERE FRANK IGWE
(OGBUEHI EZIKE ONOWU-ULI)

ONOWU FRANK IGWE PALACE
NO. 3 ONOWU FRANK IGWE'S RD.
Empire of Peace (Holly Wood Lodge)
By Eke Umuoma/St.Jude's Parish Umuoma,
P.O. Box 173, Uli, Ihiala L.G.A. Anambra State.

08033818353
07033534803

OFFICE
No. 40 Ashik Jama Street,
Jabi Abuja

Our Ref _____ Your Ref _____ Date 5/9/2023

MY DEAREST BARR. CHETA CHINWOKE MBADINUJU, THE LARGER FAMILY OF MBADINUJU AND NDIKPO CLAN UMUAKU ULI

A condolence massage on the death of your father Dr. CC Mbadinuju Odera a worthy son of Uli and the former Executive Governor of Anambra State (1999-2003).

I painfully write to condole you and the entire family of Mbadinuju and Uli Community in general this is because we the Uli people, Ihiala LGA and Anambra have lost a man with large heart a mentor and a genius extraordinary. The Governor who build Anambra State when people ran away because of insecurity. The Governor who saved life and properties at Umuneri and Aguneri communal crises. The man who appointed people to manage Government institution in different political parties without minding of their oppositions. The Governor who prays every Monday to teach people of a new week with God. My role model ODERA – ODEGO. The Governor with the most HUMILITY in Governance and worship God, in short you are my Role Model.

My dearest Cheta and others, losing your father, my mentor and worthy son of Uli Community at 77 (June 14 1945- April 11, 2023 will not make you to loose Hope in God. It will even make you strong, YES STRONG. This is because lion begot lion. Your father at 77 years made a mark in Nigeria, as a Governor, in the State Anambra, as a Special Adviser to Vice President Dr. Alex Ekwueme in the Government of the federal Republic of Nigeria, National light Newspapers print media, Uli Traditional Ruling Council and Government of Uli Progressive Union NEC ETC OUR ODERA IS EVERY where.

THE ODERA OF OUR TIME

(1) The Governor that was able to tackle the Umuleri and Aguleri crises which absolutely defiled the military, yet was able to bring it to a permanent end till date.
(2) A Governor that was able to face the onslaught of the Federal Might and stood his ground.
(3) A Governor that drew the New face of Anambra State, whom am I referring to? I am talking of our own late brother and leader Dr. Barr. CC Mbadinuju – ODERA, the man that came, saw and conquered.

May the good Lord grant your external rest Amen.

Yours in Community Service

ONOWU FRANK IGWE
FMR Executive Director Tracas Anambra State
Traditional Crowned Ogbuehi Ezike Onowu-Uli

5/9/2023

ADAMU USMAN MOHAMMED

HOME ADDRESS
NO. 95/96 Egbura Street
Along Blooming Chicken Road
Karu Site – FCT Abuja
Tel: 08065697985
Email:Viewusman360@gmail.com

OFFICE ADDRESS
No 1. Goba Close, Off Monrovia Street
Opp. Park 'N' Shop Wuse 2, Abuja
Tel:08179488690
Email: Viewusman1982@gmail.com

The Mbadinuju Family
Odera House
Onitsha/Owerri Road
Anambra State, Nigeria.

04 May, 2023

LETTER OF TRIBUTE/CONDOLENCE TO THE FAMILY OF LATE, DR CHINWOKE CLEMENT MBADINUJU

Let me begin therefore, by thanking the Almighty God for the prodigious life of His Excellency **Dr Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju**, which He gracefully spent on earth.

I have no doubt that the entire family of the late great icon, feel stronger today, because **Dr. Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju** has lived a fulfilled life and has completed His assignment on earth.

That we are, **Dr Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju**'s compatriots and have lived during his time, is a cause for a great celebration and enormous pride. We do not call him the father of our rainbow nation merely for political relevance, but, we do so because he laid a firm democratic foundation that gave birth to the most prosperous and industrialized Anambra State today.

His Excellency, the former Governor of Anambra State between 1999 to 2003 was a courageous and charismatic leader who fought to achieve the dreams of Anambra State, even when those dreams come at a huge price. He was a fearless freedom fighter, and his commitment to building peace, stability and security in Anambra State are important legacy for the nation.

In this moment of innermost grief, we pray for the family of His Excellency **Dr Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju** that peace and calm prevail as we mourn the faithful departed who has gone to rest in the LORD. We shall continue to pray that the Almighty GOD rest his soul in eternal peace, Amen.

Yours faithful

4/5/2023.

USMAN A. MOHAMMED

Chief Patrick T. Chidolue

Plot 374E Adetokunbo Ademola Crescent Wuse II, Abuja.
Tel: 09-2900100, 09-2900101, 0803 787 3805

May 15, 2023.

Cheta Mbadinuju, Esq
Chinwoke Mbadinuju Foundation,
Road 1, Udoka Estate,
Awka,
Anambra State.

Dear Barr. Cheta,

TRIBUTE/CONDOLENCE MESSAGE ON THE PASSAGE OF DR. CHINWOKE CLEMENT MBADINUJU (ODERA OF ULI)

I, on behalf of my family, do heartily condole with you and the entire Mbadinuju family of Uli, Anambra State on the death of your father, Chief Dr. Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju.

As Christians, our faith has made us to believe that death is a necessary end that will surely come when it will come not minding age, strength or status, but it is most painful when it is the death of someone so dear and cherished.

Your father was a patriot, a selfless leader and a peacemaker who governed Anambra State with sincerity and passion for the people. Although he is no longer with us today, but his strides in public life continue to testify for him and keep his memory alive.

I, therefore share in your grief, but rejoice in the fulfilled life your father led and thus invite your attention to the word of God in Ecclesiastics 3:1 – 2 which says "To everything there is a season, and a time to every purpose under the heaven: a time to be born, and a time to die; a time to plant, and a time to pluck up that which is planted" Obviously, it's been a most trying time for you and your family but you should take solace in the fact that your father had a full life circle of challenges but he enjoyed his time here on earth and now he has passed on giving you the right to mourn him but you must mourn like believers and thank God for sparing his life to this ripe age.

On this note and on behalf of my family, please accept and extend our condolence to the entire family of Mbadinuju as we pray God Almighty to grant him eternal rest and to you all the fortitude to bear the loss.

Yours Sincerely,

CHIEF PATRICK T. CHIDOLUE

(Justice & Equity Chambers)
PROF. PAUL DAVID C. OBIANASO LAW CENTRE, Oghalegbu Okija,
Adjacent Oghalegbu Primary School, Ihiala Local Government Area, Anambra State
Email: obianasocriminologyschl@gmail.com Tel.: 08033126890, 09090604992

TRIBUTE FOR HIS EXCELLENCY, LATE PROFESSOR (DR/BARR) C.C. MBADINUJU (ODERA), IHIALA LGA POLITICAL ICON

For all mortals, death is a necessary end which will come when it will come. However, some deaths are more remarkable than others. For Odera, as he was fondly called, his death can be likened to the passage of a sage and Political icon, indeed, a 'Destiny Fulfilled'

He was my very close friend and brother and only his dear wife knew how close we were, especially while he was in Office as Governor of Anambra State. There are many distinguished achievements recorded by Odera as Governor of Anambra State which shall still benefit many future generations of Ndi Anambra.

Peace and Security are part of the life long legacies he left in Anambra. If Odera deploying his Political sagacity and Leadership acumen didn't stop the fratricidal war of Otuocha ~ Aguleri axis of Anambra State, that war had the capacity of spreading beyond what the State could have managed.

Vigilante Security and Community Policing in Anambra got a master stroke Political Leadership from Odera and Armed robbers who had almost taken over the entire State were flushed out and Anambra State won Awards as the safest State in Nigeria, under Odera's Leadership as Governor of Anambra State.
The best road in Okija today (which runs from the Onitsha Express road by St Anthony's Catholic Church) was approved by Odera as the Executive Governor of Anambra State. Time and space will fail me to list all the Legacy Projects of Odera in Anambra State.

It was in recognition of the feat of ending the war that was raging in Otuocha and Aguleri axis that the Centre for Criminal Justice Reform & Citizen Awareness (Incorporating The Criminology Institute of Nigeria) conferred a Merit Award on Odera at the Nigeria Institute of International Affairs (NIIA), Lagos. As the Director General of the Centre, my humble self thus became the first Anambra indigene to host Odera in a Public event in Lagos State, after he was elected Governor of Anambra State.

Though Odera was a victim of evil highwire Political conspiracies that led to his being denied ticket for a second term, nevertheless, those who knew him well know that he was a man with an incredibly good heart.

For instance, let me place on record that, His Excellency (Odera) was neither part of the plot nor did he approve of the dastardly killing of late Barr Barnabas Igwe and his wife Barr Amaka Igwe. Those who committed those crimes had their motives and plans made without the knowledge or approval of Odera.

The loss of Odera is a big loss to Uli, Ihiala Local Govt, Anambra State and Nigeria at Large. There are so many Political heavy weights in Anambra State today, many millionaires and even Billionaires who won't be what they are today, but for the opportunities and help given to them by His Excellency, Professor, Dr., Barr, Clement Chinwoke Mbadinuju, PhD., former Executive Governor of Anambra State.

On behalf of my humble self and family, Ndi Okija home and Abroad, we heartily condole with Her Excellency, Chief Mrs. Nenne Mbadinuju, the amiable and peace loving wife of Odera, who impacted greatly on Odera and womenfolk in Anambra, while her husband was in Office.

We commend the Administration of Professor C.C. Soludo (Odenigbo Solution), for opting to give Odera a deserving State burial.

Odera, fare thee well.

PAUL DAVID CHUKWUDI OBIANASO OKALU-EZE-IKOKWU, PhD.
(Professor of Modern Forensic Criminology, Intelligence, Security & Counter Terrorism Studies,
Attorney-at-Law, DG, ~Criminology institute of Nigeria)

Sir Chinedu Nelson Orjiako KSJI

TRIBUTE TO H.E, DR CHINWOKE MBADINUJU (ODERA NDI IGBO)

Dr. Mbadinuju served the country and the people of Anambra State with dedication, making very important contributions to the development of institutions and communities.

Ndi Uli, Ihiala LGA, Anambra state and Nigeria at large will definitely miss him.

The roles Your excellency, late Dr. Mbadinuju played in unifying the people politically and socially during your time as executive governor of Anambra State is worth reckoning and emulating.

ODERA as he was fondly called was the opposite of today's governors in Nigeria who are spiritually anemic, intellectually impoverished, and morally depleted. Rather, ODERA was first among equals, a visionary, and a builder. His mind was not a sponge absorbing the ideas of others.

ODERA was a quiet leader who didn't have to raise his voice to win a point. He was a leader who always remembered those who elected him to represent them. A leader who could forgive the sins of the past and look to the future. A leader who defended his ideas and his ideals with deep passion.

Your massive manpower development and empowerment have been a cornerstone foundation that raised many present day businessmen, politicians and generational millionaires in our LGA directly and indirectly. Talk of your personality and legendary massive man-marches and captivating mobilization of people at political functions, you're naturally gifted ex temporal oratory and magical command of crowd. These, we all developed from.

Your purposeful exhuberant-like big masquerade rallies created in no small measure, high sense of political awareness that projected Ihiala LGA to the forefront of Anambra politics in a mono-party style.

It is a truism that all men shall die, whether big or small, rich or poor, young or old. It is also eternal that every soul must one day, go back to its maker but alas. The finality of death is a hard reality to deal with. Notwithstanding, it is a puzzle that only God understands. He giveth and taketh.

It is so painful losing an honest and upright colossus like Dr Chinwoke Mbadinuju, Ordera Igbo, to the cold hands of death.

Death has waged war in the house of the mighty! Death! You truly do not respect greatness!

We shall miss all these. You have played your part on earth and may God grant you eternal rest in paradise. Amen.

Sir Chinedu Nelson Orjiako KSJI
Ogbuehi Ezike Ikpemaraeziokwu n'Uli

+234 817 100 0224 chineduorjiako1@gmail.com

FRIENDS CHAMBERS

ORJI NWAFOR - ORIZU & ASSOCIATES

(Solicitors & Notaries Public)

REPLY TO
ABUJA OFFICE:
9, Timbuktu Street,
Wuse Zone 6, Abuja
Tel: 09031112550, 08033140212

Website:www.orjinwafororizu.com
Email:orjiorizu@yahoo.com,
orjiorizu@orjinwafororizu.com

NNEWI OFFICE:
13 Igwe Orizu Road,
Nnewi,
Anambra State
Tel: 09092682917

"ODERA – ODEGO" A MISUNDERSTOOD HERO

Yes, Dr. Chinwoke C. Mbadinuju, my very good friend represented different person to different persons. That is the attribute of a hero. Those who loved him (like me) loved him very much and those who do not understand him "hated his administration". I said "hated his administration" as Governor of Anambra State. This is because those who were close to Chinwoke as I was are aware that he was a lovable good fellow, full of intellect and original ideas that no one should hate.

Like Shakespeare's Mark Anthony, I will state that I have come to bury Chinwoke and not to praise him.

There lies Chinwoke Clement known to us as "ODERA". He is speechless but I can speak for him. I spoke for him in his life time in Courts, in Newspapers and Television and with the Police. I know the details of his travails and I have come to the conclusion that my friend Odera was a misunderstood hero.

If I am wrong, are some of you not ready to refuse to agree that Odera had no connection with the death of the Igwes. This is despite Odera's book explaining the details. This is unfair, Odera went through about 4 different Police investigation, about 4 Court cases, thorough investigation by the Nigerian Bar Association and in all those Odera was found blameless and clean. He must be a magician to pass through over 7 different Judges in Abuja and Anambra State and was discharged. I was there all through.

Odera had the Nigerian Bar Association, Onitsha former officials to contained with. They were adamant, unbending to progressive ideas and bare facts. They politicized the murder of Igwe and his wife as if Chinwoke had a hand in it. My pity for Chinwoke was when he cut short his trip to USA to come home because of the murder of his friend Igwe and wife. He met a shocking reception and propaganda connecting him with Igwe's murder. He was disappointed and disillusioned. He never the less mourned his friend Igwe.

It is not in doubt that an innocent Governor who is tagged a murderer, will not be comfortable. Mbadinuju waived his immunity as a Governor and authorized the Nigerian Police to investigate him. They did and found nothing. Take this from me.

SOLICITORS: Prince Orji Nwafor - Orizu (Principal Partner)
Nnenna Nwafor - Orizu (Miss.) (Partner), Stephen N. Anichebe (Head of Chambers, Abuja), Esther Abbey - Ollo (Mrs) (Head Litigation), Sir, Norbert Onyejiaka (Head of Chambers, Nnewi), Ugochukwu Ifeakandu, Ogechi Igwe (Mrs), Chiugo Oledinma (Miss), S.I. Ogbonna, Oge Orji-Orizu (Mrs), Daniel A. Onyilo Esq. ADMIN SEC: Rita Nchedo Ugwu (Mrs)

Chinwoke Mbadinuju is incapable of planning the killing of any human being. He is not given to this. Indeed, a good number of Mbadinuju haters are not even aware that Late Igwe is not from Anambra State. He is from Imo state practicing law in Onitsha. What will be the reason for killing him? Is it to prevent him from the Governorship of Anambra State or what?

Chinwoke and myself were called to the Nigerian Bar the same day about 45 years ago and we were together in Lagos during the Shagari days as Presidential Aides. His wife Nnenne and my wife Oge were school mates at Oba Girls Secondary School. We played Tennis most evening at No. 17A Ikoyi Crescent with Dr. Alex Ekwueme (Vice President) in his official residence. As Governor of Anambra State, I did all I could to make Odera's Government successful. I did this at no cost or profit to myself. I did not have a plot of land anywhere in Anambra State or have a hand in any contract.

Odera went to Abuja from his elite background with sound education having attended Ivy League University and being a graduate of Political Science, International Relation and Law and met a raw deal. The Anambra State Odera met was that of untold violence between towns, extreme armed robbery e.t.c. He applied his talent and sagacity and left an Anambra State with National Honour of being the best crime free State in Nigeria. This his success in fighting crime irked his political party supporters and they vowed that he will not be allowed a second tenure which he won. Odera walked away and had no regrets because he believed that it was better to leave office than being forced to stay in a war zone of armed robbers without a solution. He believed that, Anambra State without security was not worth his time as its Governor.

Odera left the Governorship and both of us shared our legal practice at Agadez in Wuse II, Abuja. I did not see the wealth some said you had as you carried yourself in your humble manner, eating very good food and care provided by Nnenne your love, caring for your children and deepening yourself in your Jesu-Christ belief. You were a good friend and I personally miss your company. Like the Great Ceaser of Rome, You came, You saw and You conquered.

ADIEU.

Pono.

Prince Orji Nwafor-Orizu
(NTANTANMA)

CASTLE OF TRIUMPHS

Umuebukee, Umuaku, Uli, Ihiala LGA, Anambra State.

The Mbadinuju Family,
Ndikpo, Umuaku,
Uli, Ihiala LGA

Letter of Condolence on the Death of Dr. Clement Chinwoke Mbadinuju (Odera)

Please accept our heartfelt condolences over the death of Dr. Clement Chinwoke Mbadinuju (Dede Clement). Our hearts and thoughts go out to you and the entire Mbadinuju family of Ndikpo, Umuaku Uli for we know what it means to lose a dear one, particularly a father who struggled through life to later become the second democratically elected Governor of our dear state, Anambra.

The Ohuoha family and Mbadinuju family have had a very strong relationship. The ties we share as a family have come a long way both in our years of growing up and even more now in our adult lives. We remember vividly the role our father, late Ichie SBC Ohuoha (Osuohia Uli) played in the education of Dede Clement and his subsequent admission, on return from the United States of America, into the prestigious Uli Council of Chiefs wherein he was conferred with the chieftaincy title of Odera. We cannot also forget in a hurry the role Dede Clement played when my younger brother, Arthur Ohuoha died in the United States in February 1982, and Dede Clement used the instrumentality of his office then as Special Assistant to the former Vice President of Nigeria, late Chief Dr. Alex Ekwueme to ensure that Arthur's corpse was brought back home from Lagos to Enugu airport with a commercial aircraft.

His death, to us therefore, is a grievous blow. Very regrettable and unfortunate.
We urge you however to be consoled by the very eventful Christian life he lived and his many accomplishments as former Governor of Anambra State. As a lawyer of repute, Dede Clement helped to resolve very many knotty legal issues and as a Governor, he touched many lives and wrote his name and that of Uli town in particular on the sands of time. The state burial he received today underscores the fact that he was a great man who would not be easily forgotten in the history of politics in Nigeria and our dear State, Anambra.

May God give you and the entire family the strength of mind and spirit to bear this huge loss and may the soul of Dede Clement rest in God's bosom, Amen.

Signed:
Dr. Donald Chideha Ohuoha
Ogbuehi Eze Ihejirika of Uli
For: Late Ichie SBC Ohuoha family

0803-703-5265
castleoftriumphs@gmail.com

ICHIE (SIR) IFEANYI OMEOKACHIE MFR, KSJI.

OKOKWU N'UKPO
IKENGA DUNUKOFIA
ANAMBRA STATE, NIGERIA

Ref: _____ Date: 18th Oct, 2023

TRIBUTE TO ODERA: CONSUMATE POLITICIAN AND ADMINISTRATOR

The news of the death of the former governor of Anambra State late **Dr Chikwoke Clement Mbadinujo (Odera)** came to me as a very rude shock. It happened at a time his fatherly advice, guidance, and direction was most needed for reposition and development of our dear State Anambra. Odera, as he was fondly called by his numerous admirers was a consumate politician, world class administrator, erudite lawyer, committed and loving family man and peaceful and fine gentleman of all time of our era. The regrettable thing is that the cold hand of death sneaked in and snatched him from us, his numerous admirers at a time we were enjoying his wisdom and wide knowledge of politics of life. What many people did not know was that Odera was kind hearted and soft minded man deep down his stomach.

My personal interaction with Odera dates back to 1999 till the end of his era in 2003 as the of Anambra State, when I was special Assistant at the Presidency under Chief Obasanjo regime. Throughout my interaction with Odera, I found him an amazingly interesting and intelligent man of special humor each time I visited him at the Anambra Governor's Lodge, Abuja. In fact, Anambra State has lost one of her great icons and precious gems of inestimable value. Death has done us a deadly blow of irreparable loss beyond comprehension of which only God can fathom. To the Mbadinuju family, particularly Cheta and his siblings, please take solace in God's grace and providence for God giveth and taketh as he pleases for Odera has ran a great race and kept the faith. He was equally very and deeply religious in every disposition and dimension. May his amiable and gentle soul repose and rest with the Saints and Angels in Heaven. Amen.

Okokwu

Amb (Ichie) Ifeanyi Omeokachie, MFR
Ichie Okokwu N'Ukpo

NNAEMEKA OKEREKE, PMP®

Zeniten Company Limited | 4 Anike Apena Street, Ikeja | Telephone: +2348033328178, | Email: nnaemeka.okereke@zeniten.com

To: Chetachi Mbadinuju Esq,
Clemesis Associates
Wuye, Abuja FCT

A TRIBUTE- ODERA LIVES ON

Dr. Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju (Odera) was an exemplary leader and a pace setter in his time, A Leader who did what requires a great courage and tenacity in protecting the common interests of his people even when things were not favourable to keep up with, he became a rock and held on to his principles and grounds to maintain orderliness in which we all enjoy today. This makes him most worthy of emulation for generations to come, his name and achievements lives on to stand the test of time.

It is indeed a celebration of a life well lived and despite the goodness and abundance we have put into life when it our time we have no option but to answer our call. He would be greatly missed and to my great brother Chetachi and family I wish you the strength and pray the Almighty in His infinite mercies grant you the fortitude in these times.

May the good Lord grant his soul eternal rest.

Nnaemeka Okereke, PMP®

THE NEW ERA SPECIALIST CLINICS

By Bishop's Court, GRA Auchi, Edo State.
Tel: 08058401644, 08034223475

Our Ref: NEC/PF/23-056 Your Ref: _____ Date: 20th October, 2023

CHETA. MBADINUJU Esq.
ODERA HOUSE,
ULI.

My dear brother,

SPECIAL CONDOLENCE MESSAGE/TRIBUTE
ODERA TAKES A BOW!

- "Life is nature's version of a masquerade; it wears a mask behind which stands the hidden truth".
- "Life is like a flash of lightning in a pitch-dark night showing a split second a bright light that encourages a forward movement and then vanishes."
- "To everything there is a season, and a time to every purpose under the heaven. A time to be born and a time to die; a time to plant; and a time to pluck up that which is planted. A time to weep and a time to laugh; a time to mourn and a time to dance" (Eccl. 3:1-2:4).

We received the sad news about ODERA'S exit with utmost heaviness of heart. It came like a thunderbolt; a harrowing nightmare! But alas; it was wakeful life. We swooned and gasped.

This left us mouth agape with an avalanche of questions bordering on the 'whys' and 'whys-not' of ODERA's passing away at this time. But we found nothing but mere conjectural answers! How indeed are the MIGHTY fallen! Life indeed is a conundrum.

Weeping and loud lamentations as in Rama of old. But in EVERYTHING we give thanks to God Almighty (I Thess. 5:18).

Time and space shall fail me in attempting a running commentary on the person, imposing credentials and antecedents of ODERA. For the sake of brevity, ODERA epitomizes EXCELLENCE both in essence and purpose.

No doubt Cheta, you and family shall miss his material succour, wise counsel, plethora of virtues and all the other human elements that were so well mixed in him.

We shall however take solace in the words of a 17th century English poet and satirist; Samuel Butler who wrote: "to die is to be forgotten..... he who is not forgotten is not dead".

It is my fervent prayer that God of all consolation comforts you and family at this moment of grief.

We shall "not mourn the dead like the heathens who do not have any hope..... they are sleeping in the Lord" (1 Thess. 4:13).

Deo volente, we shall be reunited with ODERA in heavenly Jerusalem where pains, sorrows, torments, sickness and nay death shall be no more.

GOOD NIGHT! His Excellency Dr. Chinwoke Mbadinuju!
SLEEP ON! ODERA; quintessential benefactor Extraordinary and Plenipotentiary!
FAREWELL! Dede CLEM. of good repute!

Once again, my dear brother Cheta and family, please accept my deepest condolences!

IT IS WELL! **REQUIESCAT EN PAX, ODERA.**

20-10-23.

DR. IGBONAZOBI, M. U. (MSFPN)

Chief Dr. George N. Moghalu
Managing Director/CEO
NATIONAL INLAND WATERWAYS AUTHORITY (NIWA)

12th May, 2023

The Mbadinuju Family,
Odera House,
Onitsha/Owerri Road,
Uli, Ihiala LGA,
Anambra State.

My dear Cheta,

RE: LATE DR. CHINWOKE MBADINUJU (ODERA)

It is with a heavy heart but in total submission to the will of Almighty God that I received the sad news of the death of your beloved father, His Excellency, Late Dr. Chinwoke Mbadinuju (Odera).

His exit from this sinful world has indeed created a huge vacuum in his family, Anambra State and indeed the entire Nation.

While we grief over his death as humans that lost a dear one, we should take solace and comfort in the exemplary life he lived and his good works on earth, that will continue to refresh our memory of him.

On behalf of my wife and family, please accept our heartfelt condolences and extend same to the entire family.

Chief (Dr.) George Moghalu
Managing Director/CEO

Kryss
Group Limited

Address: Suncity Hotels Ltd, New Owerri, Imo State
DL: 08033012300, 08090791000,
08080660077, 08104466599
Email: krysokoro2009@yahoo.com, kryssggroup@gmail.com

CONDOLENCE

It's With Great Sadness & Shock That I Received The Sad News Of His Excellency Demise

Dr. Chinwoke C. Mbadinuju, An Elder Statesman & Former Executive Governor Of Anambra State

He's A Good Devoted Man Of God, That Can't Hurt Anybody

I Worked Closely With Him, As Special Adviser On Foreign Mission & PRO ANSG, During, His Tenure In Office & We Had A Very Cordial Working, Relationship.

He Was A Good Devoted Christian & Man Of God. He Will Be Fondly Remembered By All Those Who Knew Him Closely, ODERA-ODEGO.

My Heartfelt, Sincere Condolences, Goes to The Immediate Family, His Beloved Wife, Children, Among, Whom's

CHETA C MBADINUJU ESQ the Heir Apparent, Siblings & Close Associates Over This Great Loss

May His Beautiful & Humorous Kind Soul, Eternally, Find Solace, In The Bosom Of Our Lord, IJN AMEN.

5/06/2023

Hon. Chinenye Kryss Okoro (JP)
OBI OF OKOBI=IKENGA, ULI ANCIENT KINGDOM

GO PLACES
TRAVELS & TOURS

IATA
ACCREDITED AGENT

135 ADETOKUNBO ADEMOLA CRESC,
WUSE 2, ABUJA, NIGERIA.
PHONE: 07032821801; 08033030220
EMAIL: goplacestravel2005@yahoo.com

RC 639154

14th November, 2023.

CONDOLENCE MESSAGE

The entire Management and Staff of Goplaces Travel & Tours Ltd, condole with Barr. Chetachi Mbadinuju and his family on the passing of his Father, His Excellency, Dr. Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju (Odera).

Our hearty prayers are with them at this time; we pray for the soul of the deceased, that God in His infinite mercy will grant him eternal rest in His bossom, and grant the entire Mbadinuju family the fortitude to bear this irreparable loss, Amen.

Signed:

CHIEF FESTUS UGWOEGBU

(Ugomba I of Akah land)

MD/CEO

TRACAS NIGERIA LIMITED
• KM 41/42 ONITSHA-ENUGU EXPRESSWAY P.M.B. 5032 TEL: 048-550370, AWKA ANAMBRA STATE

5/9/2023

TO BARR. CHETA AND THE ENTIRE FAMILY OF DR CC MBADINUJU

A TRIBUTE MADE FOR AND ON BEHALF OF FORMER MEMBERS OF THE BOARD OF DIRECTORS 1999 – 2003 TRACAS ANAMBRA STATE ON THE DEATH OF OUR FORMER GOVERNOR DR. CC MBADINUJU

What a death and what a life our most respected Governor of the South East Nigeria. The Governor with large heart. The Governor who appointed the Board (set 1999-2003) and allowed us to test our capacity and we did well to his Admiration.

The man who sanitized Anambra State to highest level of sanity in the Area of security network.

THE ODERA OF THE PEOPLE

(1) The Governor that was able to tackle the Umuleri and Aguleri Crises which absolutely defied the military yet was able to bring it to a permanent end till date.

(2). A Governor that was able to face the onslaught of the Federal might and stood his ground.

(3) A Governor that withstood those cables in Civil Service that held Anambra State down for decades.

(4) A Governor that drew the new face of Anambra State, whom am I referring to? I am talking of our own leader and respected Governor His Excellency Dr. CC Mbadinuju (Odera) the man that came, saw and conquered. We the former board members shall continued to partner with the members of your family. May the good Lord grant you rest in perfect peace Amen.

Signed for and on behalf of Board of Directors 1999-2003 TRACAS.

Onowu Frank Igwe Onowu-Uli
EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR (Former)

5/9/2023

V-tals
Integrated Business Nig Ltd RC 502416
140A Welheral Road, Owerri, Imo State Nigeria.
Tel: 08064758349, 08035082319. E-mail: vitals.nigltd@yahoo.com

1629

15TH June 2023

MBADINUJU FAMILY
CHINWOKE MBADINUJU
FOUNDATION
ODERA HOUSE ONITSHA/OWERRI
ROAD IHIALA LGA
ANAMBRA STATE

CONDOLENCE

It is with a deep sense of loss, but with Gratitude to Almighty God, that I received the news of the demise of your beloved father. **THE PATRIARCH OF MBADINUJU DYNASTY, DR MBADINJU (ODERA – ODEGO)** the former governor of Anambra State aged 77 (seventy – Seven)

Indeed the exit of such a caring, inspiring, loving and God fearing father leaves much pain in the hearts of his family, but in this instance, let the immediate family draw consolation by reflecting on Odera's good life and unparalleled devotion to God almighty.

My sincere condolences to the immediate family of the bereaved, his wife **Mrs Nnenne Mbadinuju**, his children among whom is Cheta Mbadinju ESQ The heir apparent, friends and relation.

He indeed lived Good Christian life graciously enjoyed the grace of longevity and a family worthy of Emulation.

May his beautiful and generous humorous kind soul, eternally find solace in the bosom of the lord in Jesus name Amen

15/6/23

ASIL-MEGA CONST LTD

Address:
No. 5 Umuchima Uli
Anaka Local Government Area
Anambra State

Phone No:
08099380049

Email:
orjiako@yahoo.com

Your Ref. Date

TRIBUTE TO A DEPARTED ICON
HEAVEN GAINS A CLEMENT

Odera, although your demise came as a rude shock, we however keep solace in the fact that you spent an exemplary life while on earth!

With gratitude to God, I, **Ichie Ifeanyi Orjiako** of Uli, on behalf of my entire family, commiserate with the Mbadinuju Family for the transition to eternal glory of their son, brother, uncle, father and grandfather; **Late Dr. Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju.**

We are thankful to God for your life of service to God and humanity with a staunch belief that Heaven has truly gained another Clement in the person of Odera.

May your soul continue to rest peacefully as we beseech the Almighty God for a lasting fortitude to bear this irreparable loss of your being in our midst.

Farewell.

Ichie Ifeanyi Orjiako

HON. ELDER GODWIN ONYEJEKWULUM BSc. Hons, FNISM, FCAI, (JP).

(Ebubechukwu)

Chairman: G.O.D. BROTHERS GROUP

OFFICE:
21 Godwin-Kris Road,
Umuezeokalum Umudim
P.O. Box 614 Nnewi,
Anambra State, Nigeria.

Tel: 08037165620, 07014291404, 08033666323
E-mail: godbroz2000@yahoo.com

RESIDENCE:
33 Huluco Drive, Obiofia
Nnewichi Nnewi,
Nnewi North L.G.A

Our Ref:..... Your Ref:..... Date:.....

TRIBUTE TO DR. C. C. MBADINUJU, "ODERA"

It is with great shock that I received the sad news of the passing away of His Excellency, Dr. C. C. Mbadinuju Odera the former Governor of Anambra State on 11th April, 2023.

The Late Dr. C. C. Mbadinuju was my legal counsel and a close associate from the 1980s. He was an unassuming, humble, Jovial and easy going person who put smiles on the faces of everyone who comes across him. The Late Dr. C. C. Mbadinuju was a legal luminary, a political scientist and a practicing Christian.
Having his office then at Oguta Road, Onitsha before his elevation to the office of the Executive Governor of Anambra State, he authored many books on the merits of being a Christian. He was well lettered, an Associate Professor of Political Science and African Studies at New York University, USA, later a personal Assistant to Chief Jim Nwobodo, former Governor of Anambra State.
He also served as an adviser to the former Vice President Dr. Alex Ekwueme. As the patriarch of the family, he will be missed by his wife children, family and relations.

However, "To everything, there is a season... "a time to be born and a time to die" Ecc 3:1, so we as mortals cannot query God Almighty. "As it is appointed unto men once to die, after this the judgment" Heb 9:27 "For God so loved the world that He gave his only begotten son that whosoever believeth in him should not perish but have everlasting life" John 3:16. "So teach us to number our days that we may apply our hearts unto wisdom". Psalm 90:12.

As we reminisce and mediate on his legacies and pour encomiums, we should all deeply reflect on our relationship with God in this life in order to gain eternal life as we truly and faithfully walk with God. The import of tributes is to impact lessons to the living and not for the dead as there is no repentance in the grave.
On behalf of my humble self and family, I deeply condole his wife her Excellency Mrs Nnenne Mbadinuju, children, the family and relations.

Adieu H.E Dr. C. C. Mbadiuju
Adieu "Odera"

SGD. HON ELDER GODWIN ONYEJEKWULUM

Air Vice Marshal *WALTER A OGUJIOFOR* (Rtd)

DSS psc fwc Msc MBA

Reference:

Cheta Mbadinuju Esq,
Chinwoke Mbadinuju Foundation (CMF)
Road 1, Udoka Estate, Awka.
Anambra State.

October 10, 2023

CONDOLENCE MESSAGE

We received with grief and deep sense of loss, the sad news of the death of your beloved father, Dr Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju, at the age of 78 years. Please accept our heartfelt condolences.

It is true that when we reach the climax of our physical being and distress, what seems like transition, otherwise termed 'death' occur. Death is therefore, never an end but a beginning of the sojourn into the real purpose of life.

Odera lived a very fulfilled and accomplished life by the high standard of his achievements as the Governor of Anambra State and by bringing forth, people like you into the society with such a towering standard of educational and social standing. He will always be remembered as a devout Christian who loved and served God and humanity with dedication and humility. We will miss him especially for his commitments to family, human capital development and the development of Anambra State.

We jointly pray that the Almighty God will accord him a perfect eternal rest and grant all members of his family, the fortitude to bear his physical absence.

WALTER OGUJIOFOR

Air Vice Marshal rtd.

Plot 1288, No 4 Brinin Kebbi Close, FCDA sites Estate, Garki 2, Abuja Nigeria.

TRIBUTE TO MY OWN EXCELLENCY

The news of your death came to me as a shock and reality check. It laid hear before me that every good thing comes to an end.

Working with you thought me different sides to life and that humility is indeed a great virtue as a governor you preferred peace that show of power.

You have left a great legacy in the lives of many people.

We cannot question God why it has to you or now because he knows the best.

I believe that you are in the best place and enjoying the life after.

Adieu! Your Excellency
Adieu!! Chinwoke Mbadinuju
Adieu!!! Odera

Rest on Peace until we meet to part no more

Hon. (Mrs.) Chinenye Okongwu.

GOVERNMENT OF ANAMBRA STATE OF NIGERIA

POST PRIMARY SCHOOLS SERVICE COMMISSION HEADQUARTERS
AWKA

Website: www.ansppsschqtrs.com
e-mail: ppsschqtrs@gmail.com

Your Ref: _____

Our Ref: _____

OFFICE OF THE CHAIRMAN

P.M.B. 5035
AWKA

Date: 19/8/2023

The Entire Mbadinuju Family,
Uli,
Ihiala Local Government Area,
Anambra State.

CONDOLENCE MESSAGE

The Chairman, Board Members, Secretary, Staff and Students of Post Primary Schools Service Commission received the news of the home-going of the Former Executive Governor of Anambra State (1999 – 2003), His Excellency, Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju (Odera) with shock and deep sense of loss.

We write to sympathize with the entire Family on this sad news. The PPSSC Headquarters, Awka, sincerely identifies with you at this trying moment as we appreciate our former Governor remarkable contributions towards the growth of education in Anambra state. Odera worked tirelessly for the growth and development of Anambra State during his tenure as Executive Governor of Anambra State.

As Christians, we know that nothing happens if God did not allow it. We also know that God loves us more than we can comprehend and that in all things, we find solace in His glory as He alone knows the best and He alone can explain His actions. We console the wife and children for this irreplaceable loss.

Please be consoled by the remarkable life he lived. We pray for peaceful repose of his soul and for the grace and courage for all to cope with this great loss.

May the comfort of the Holy Spirit be with the family as you accord our dear former Governor a befitting Christian burial.

May his soul rest in peace, Amen.

Once more, accept our sincere condolences and highest regards.

Prof. Nkechi Ikediugwu
Chairman
PPSSC Awka

Chief M.E.A. Nwakalor Fcc
Omelora 1 of Nteje, Oyi L.G.A., Anambra State

1st June, 2023.

CONDOLENCE MESSAGE

The very sad news of the demise of **His Excellency Chinweoke Mbadinuju** came to me as a rude shock. I write on behalf of the Asigwe Nwakalor family to condole with the entire Mbadinuju family over this loss. It is not within the powers of man to defer death. There are two very important dates in the life of every living being – the date of birth and the date of death.

I urge the family not to mourn rather to celebrate the good life that Odera lived. It is the Lord that giveth and he has taken away. We must not question His authority, knowing that we are all strangers here on earth.

It is my prayer that the Almighty God will grant his soul eternal rest and give the family the fortitude to bear the irreparable loss.

Signed.

Chief (Sir) M.E.A. Nwakalor
Omelora Nteje

Head Office:
22, Dibor Street, Okota, Isolo, Lagos.
Tel:7731496-7

Mobile 08033037597
Email:nwakalormike@yahoo.com

Abuja Office:
15, Freetown Street, Wuse II, Abuja
Tel:08077776884

NKWADO-ODIMMA ULI FORUM
(ULI GA-ABURIRI OKA-IBE)

Ihiala Local Government Council,
Anambra State.
Motto: Justice, Unity, Transparency & Development

RC:59165

Email: nkwadoodimmauli2020@gmail.com

Our Ref:..... Your Ref:..... Date: 09/10/2023

EULOGY OF A LEGEND

The ugly news of unexpected demise of His Excellency, Dr. Barr. Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju, Former Executive Governor Of Anambra State {1999 - 2003}, came to us like a physical blow, reminding us once again that we are only in this world on a transit. Sir, your transition to the new abode left a void in us that would be impossible to fill.

It is so sad! Anambra State has lost another democrat, Ulians have lost a brother, a consistent fighter and outspoken voice for the voiceless; one of the very few that reached beyond the frontiers of unnatural political division. Oderaa Our brother, you reflected the true passion and vigour that heralded political arrangements in Anambra State, which steadily transmogrified into activism for return to democracy at the height of military interregnum and had remained steadfast in the call for good and inclusive governance.

Good things they say, last not! Could it be likened to the saying that good persons don't live long? You led an exemplary life of unassailable probity and unimpeachable integrity. You were a down-to-earth leader who did his best to develop Anambra State, but the Political Siroccos that surrounded your Government did not allow you to continue your second tenure bid. You made people to see politics as service to humanity. Your glorious dismissal still left a big lacuna into the hub of the entire Anambra State and Uli Kingdom in particular.

However, you were a man of reputable echelon, munificence, tolerance, and unquenchable sagacity; contrarily, you abhorred malevolence, victimization, sadism, unsolicited avarice, and most regrettably, you suffered betrayals from the people you trusted the most! You made remarkable traces of lasting tracks, on the sands of time which would remain green in our cerebrum and will hardly be flung into the bush. Your antecedents as a voice for the voiceless has been diligently followed by many who admired your charisma and empathy.

Apparently, the weapons of war perish Alas and Alack! A great void has been obliterated in Anambra State. What a pill of anguish, that made a lion to gasp, gape and pine away in a heart-throbbing pain. Nevertheless, Death is inevitable and a ubiquitous, as you bowed out of this theatrical stage when the ovation is inexorably high, we salute your guts for succeeding and for making a mark from a near-no-prior foundation. Our prayer is that, God in His Infinite mercies, will fill the vacuum your departure has created in the family of Mbadinuju, Uli and the entire Anambra State in general.

Finally, we are consoled about your demise, because we know quite vividly that you lived a life worthy of emulation! Therefore, on behalf of Nkwado-Odimma Uli Executive Council, we kindly seized this rare opportunity to extend our unalloyed condolence to all of us, especially the Chief mourners of Late Dr. Barr. CC Mbadinuju, for the Almighty God in His Infinite Mercy to grant us the Fortitude To Bear This Irreparable Loss.

Sir, as we bid you goodbye, may the light of God brighten your path to eternal rest in His Kingdom Amen.

Comr. DonCross® Ekwughalu
Secretary General

Nwabunwanne Akunne Ikenwokwu
Coordinator
08035505529

For And On Behalf Of The Entire Nkwado-Odimma Uli Forum, Especially The Executive Council.

PATRICK H. IWARA ESQ.

No 1 Ogar Afufu Close, State Housing Estate
08033140330

The Mbadinuju Family
Odera House, Uli Ihiala L.G.A
Anambra State

My Dear In-laws,

CONDOLENCE MESSAGE

With a deep feeling of loss and pain, all members of my family commiserate with you all for the exit of your father an Icon, a Journalist, a Politician, a leader and a patriot, His Excellency Chinweoke Mbadinuju.

God brought our families together through the marriage of our children and this has created an eternal bond.

For the short period we interacted with Odera, by virtue of his character, it seems we had known each other for ages. He was an amiable gentleman with a very high sense of humor, a patient listener, a deep thinker, and a prayerful man who appreciated even very little things, yet a great man.

ODERA, I feel very privileged in our short interaction to have shared experiences of life, listening to "Your Story" as you called it. I give thanks to the Almighty God, who you served and held dear, to have given you the life, the strength and the opportunity after your ordeal, to be able to tell your story and to document it. This is because stories don't mean anything if there is no one to tell them to. But you have told it to us and we have heard and kept it – we are glad we did.

You have run a good race and succeeded where many other great men failed. You have lived a good life, raised a good family, made good friends and even bad ones, which is natural; but one thing is certain, you were a pillar, a Statesman, a father filled with love, and you gave it. We will miss you.

You have finished your assignment on earth and your creator who sent you on this mission has called you to join Him in His kingdom where there is neither the sun nor the moon and no nights, because He is the light.

He will receive you in heaven and we pray he judges you with mercy.

Adieu Odera, Adieu great man

Patrick H. Iwara Esq & Family.

IIGL IGAB INDUSTRIAL CO. LTD.
Iron and Steel Stockist

Corporate Office:
41 Uga Str. Shop 17, Fegge.
P.O. Box 10763, Onitsha
Tel: 0803-0959354, 0805-9814088
0806-7862656, 0803-3132751

Our Ref: _____ *Your Ref:* _____ *Date:* _____

CONDOLENCE MESSAGE

The management and staff of IGAB IND. COMPANY LIMITED commiserate with my friend Bar. Chetanna and the entire family of Chief Bar. C.C Mbadinuju of Uli in Ihiala LGA of Anambra State, following the death of their dear husband, father, grand father, late Chief Bar. C. C Madinuju (Odera) and the former executive governor of Anambra State of Nigeria.

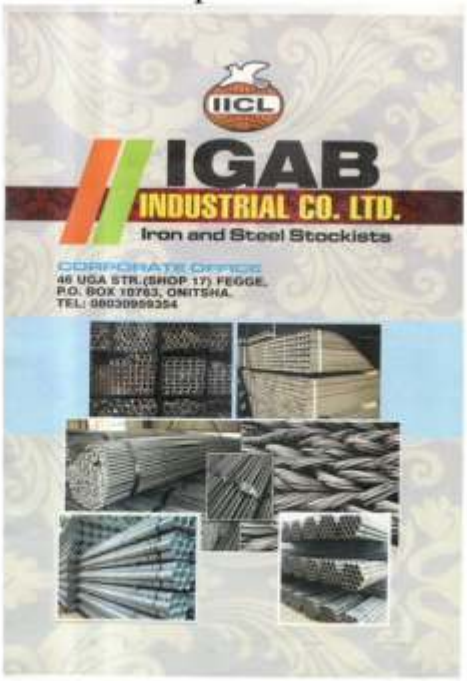
It was during your regime that the entire Anambra State saw a fortified security and equally introduced prayer day in all the markets in the State. In fact, you were a mentor and epitome of a good leader.

May your soul rest in peace, Amen.

Signed:

Chief Ignatius Agbalizu (Beluodachi)

Management.



ASSOC. PROF. ROSE NWANKWO

Head of Department Public Administration, Paul University, Awka

rosenwankwo@gmail.com

CONDOLENCE MESSAGE

I was saddened to hear about the death of our beloved legend and former Executive Governor of Anambra State Dr. Chinwoke Mbadinuju (Odera) I truly extend my sympathy to his family.

I was privileged indeed favoured to have worked under him, first as the Executive Chairman, State Primary Education Board Anambra State (SPEB) and also as a special adviser to the governor on Higher Education.

Today we remember the life of Dr. Chinwoke Mbadinuju (Odera), he was such a model and responsible person. He never shifted the blame for his short comings on others, rather he acknowledged them and deed the needful to make up for them.

During his time as the governor of Anambra State, there was no dull moment whenever he was around. He always made the environment lively and exciting. He was an embodiment of selfless and humility and always cheerful and in good spirit.

Odera was a source of hope and inspiration for the oppressed and downtrodden during this time and was willing to and did stand up to help defend the right of poor, innocent people who couldn't fight for themselves.

Although I wished for you to still be with us, your maker has decided that it is now time you rest from your labours on this earth. You have been a blessing to several lives. History will always remember Odera for the key role he played as the governor of Anambra State (1999-2003) for this, he will be greatly missed.

Adieu Odera
We love you but God loves you most.
May your soul rest in the bosom of the Lord, Amen

THE TRADITIONAL HEAD OF IHITE COMMUNITY ULI
OLUOHA AUGUSTINE CHINENYENWA MBANUDE
DARA EZEDINAOBI I (IHITE) ULI

PALACE:
The Royal Palace of Oluoha Ihite,
Umudaro Ubahudara Uli,
Ihiala Local Government Area,
Anambra State, Nigeria

OFFICE:
52 Market Road Aba,
Abia State, Nigeria
Tel: 08039491382
E-mail: daraezedinaobi@yahoo.com

Our Ref: ..... *Your Ref:* ..... *Date:* .....

TRIBUTE TO THE LATE FORMER GOVERNOR DR. C.C. MBADINUJU

On behalf of Oluoha A.C. Mbahude, the traditional head of Ihite Uli, Ihite chiefs, and the entire good people of Ihite community Ull, we gather here today to pay our heartfelt tribute to a remarkable son of our land.

During his tenure as governor, Dr. C.C Mabdinuju demonstrated unwavering commitment to the development and progress of our dear state. His visionary leadership was characterized by a genuine concern for the welfare of the people, as we initiated numerous projects and policies aimed at improving the lives of our citizens.

Beyond his achievements as a leader, Dr. C.C. Mbadinuju was a man of great character and intercity. As we bid farewell to our beloved son, we mourn his loss, but we also celebrate his life and the remarkable legacy he leaves behind. Dr. C.C. Mbadinuju dedication to public service, his unwavering commitment to the welfare of the people, and his exemplary leadership serve as a shining example for all to emulate.

As we lay him to rest, let us honour his memory by upholding the values he cherished. Let us strive to build a community and a state that he would be proud of a place where compassion, progress, and justice reign supreme. May his soul find eternal rest, and may his legacy guide and inspire us.

Rest in peace, dear Dr. C.C. Mbandinuju

OLUOHA A.C. MBANUDE
OLUOHA OF IHITE

Oluoha A.C. Mbanude
Dara Ezedinaobi I Ihite Uli

GOVERNMENT OF ANAMBRA STATE OF NIGERIA

Telegram: The Chairman

Telephone:

Your Ref:

Our Ref:
(All replies to be addressed to the Chairman)

Local Government Service Commission,
P.M.B. 5044,
Awka

Date October 5, 2023

TRIBUTE IN HONOUR OF DR. C. C. MBADINUJU, FORMER GOVERNOR OF ANAMBRA STATE.

The Chairman, Board Members and Management of Anambra State Local Government Service Commission, received the terrible news of your demise with shock and disbelief. Although death they say is a necessary and ultimate end which awaits all mortals, we bemoan your passing which came at a time when we need your fatherly guidance in our political journey as an Elder Statesman. Indeed, the good people of Anambra State and Uli Kingdom have lost a Rare Gem.

ODERAH, your passing left a wide chasm in our political consciousness, but though we grieve, we give thanks to God Almighty for your fulfilled life which impacted both the big and small in Anambra State. A consummate politician and academic, your remarkable transition from a humble beginning into a political GURU of our time, bears eloquent testimony that you are truly a man of destiny. Your political philosophy of compromise and live and let live is adjudged to be worthy of emulation by the political gladiators of today, and your firm belief in the dictate of providence over ones destiny has etched your name in gold and won the tacit approval of political Sages and Philosophers alike.

ODERAH, we reflect with nostalgia your Era as Governor of Anambra State which witnessed the assimilation of thousands of youths in several Ministries in the State after a decade-long obnoxious ban on employment, how we yearn for the return of yester-years.

As we mourn with your family, friends and Acquaintances, we found solace that the PEACE and TRANQUILITY you so much cherished during your lifetime shall enlighten your part and guide you to the Bosom of the Lord.

ADIEU ODERAH
ADIEU, Embodiment of Peace.

Vin Ifeanyi Ezeaka (Esq.),
Chairman,
Anambra State Local Government Service Commission,
Government House,
Awka.

ODY CHUKWUBE
P.O Box 43, Ihiala
Email:odychukwube@yahoo.com

ODERA AND HIS UNCOMMON SPIRITUALITY

By Ody Chukwube

Odera's instructions were swift, dangerous and mind blowing that midafternoon.

"CPS (Chief Press Secretary), come along with me to the forests of Umuleri, Aguleri and Umuoba Anam , I want to---. "No, Sir" I interjected, as both cold and hot sweat struggled for space on my pitiful face, devastated by a mission which was, in my thinking, an obvious attempt at self- destruction.

"But, Sir, this is extremely dangerous. Let us reach out to the security people for advice", I insisted. Quoting Psalm 46:10, "be still, and know that I am God", Odera yelled at me even as he flipped through his Bible. "This is a trip we must undertake. The Commissioner of Police, the Director of SSS and the Army Commander at Onitsha, have warned against going to the forest, but they are not God". I made another futile attempt to convince him, but he became furious and with a tone of finality, he declared "We must put an end to this mindless carnage in that area. It doesn't matter if we pay the supreme price. God's message is clear on this. That is is why I asked you to be still and listen to the voice of God."

,, I was shocked by his effrontery, his near suicidal courage and faith. Nonetheless, I rushed to his young ADC, who was also helpless, if not hapless, given the circumstances. I called the ever calm and stable First Lady, Mrs Nnenne Mbadinuju, to save us from a possible annihilation, but she was unable to sway him out of what I thought was going to be an ill-fated journey.

The forests of Aguleri, Umuleri and Umuoba Anam communities were like the present-day Sambisa Forest, elaborately mined, with warriors that were heavy on drugs and armed to the teeth. It appeared foolhardy to undertake a trip to that area with a few poorly armed policemen and men of the security services attached to the office of the governor.

"When they hear the word of God, they will drop their guns", the new governor stressed as he sang divine praises. The journey to the Anambra "Sambisa Forest" was short but tortuous.

At the battle field, a staccato of gun shots from the militants who shot into the air, oblivious of our mission, welcomed us. Odera with his weather-beaten Bible, picked up the microphone and began to preach. "Jesus loves you, drop your guns and embrace peace . This war is needless and useless. Stop killing yourselves".

We went round different areas of the forest, preaching peace and reconciliation. We were vulnerable, and all, except Odera got enveloped in fear and trepidation.

On our way back, in an ironic twist or in a spirit- inspired action, some of the war-weary militants sneaked out of the bunkers and other hidden places and hailed, either with gun salute or voice approval, "Oderaaaaaaaaa"!

This marked the beginning of an end to the fratricidal war which had ravaged the area for over a century.

Quoting again from the scriptures, Psalm118, 'This is God's doing and it is marvelous in our eyes. CPS, is this not a miracle? Always be strong, prayerful and most importantly, be strong in faith ", was Odera's advice during our post mortem of the trip to the devil inhabited forests where stench from decomposing bodies almost destroyed our nostrils. Most significantly, that axis of the state, to this day, has remained the most peaceful.

This visit, which was a few months into his administration, defined Odera, his undying faith in and love for God.

Odera believed that governance must have a spiritual foundation. He instituted a prayer regimen in Anambra which has remained a shining legacy. Every Monday, Odera, as Governor, mounted the pulpit and preached the Word to Anambra people in a live broadcast. All the offices and markets joined in prayers and gradually it became a positive habit which has remained to this day. Of all his achievements, Odera considered this his best . 'More than anything else, always celebrate my determination to link our people to the truth through the Gospel. I will die, happy that I tried to establish a leadership anchored on Christ, our saviour "

Odera was a true believer, in and out of government. In his book, "God's Kind of Leader, published more than a decade before he became Governor, Odera correctly predicted or putting it differently, gave prophesy of his time in government. He canvassed that a leader must strive to be responsible and righteous. And above all, be Christ-like in his disposition and character.

He suffered tribulations. He was betrayed and was maligned, but like our Saviour, he prayed for his enemies and adversaries. "My love for God and humanity is unquantifiable. I love everybody, including those who made attempts to tarnish my image".

Those who thought that Odera was politically annihilated, unwittingly opened a new life for him. He devoted his last days to writing Christian books and at the last count, had

about 22 books on the shelf. His book, The Spiritual Foundation of Good Governance, extensively chronicled his messages on the pulpit as a Governor.

For Odera, his was a miracle in governance. He was always positive, even in the face of humongous difficulties.

Odera was apparently the only Governor in the history of Nigeria whose office was bombed. At different times, hoodlums also attempted to force their way into Government House to attack him. If that was to frustrate him, they failed as he sang praises as a response

Odera received national accolades for a successful war against crime. Using an unconventional approach, he eradicated armed robbery and violent crimes in the state. While many considered this a result of strategic thinking, Odera felt it was a spiritual response to prayers of Ndi Anambra.

His numerous other accomplishments in government came out of an uncommon commitment to prayers and strong belief in God. With lean funds, Odera was able to establish a university, the present day Chukwuemeka Odumegwu University with campuses at Igbariam and Uli.

The financial status of the state was poor and with a miserable monthly allocation from Abuja, Odera did well in varying degrees. In some months, what was left after salary payment in Anambra state was less than N50million. How he managed to build roads was considered by many, including his opponents, as miraculous.

Prayers, Odera told me in our last encounter, led to the completion of legacy projects like the Ekwueme Square, the ABS complex, the Judiciary Complex, Ngozika Estate, and the Women Development Center now named Professor Dora Akunyili Women Developnent Centre. He did not start the permanent site of the Government House, but he did most of the structural work.

That Anambra State is now an oil-producing state is a result of his foresight. He did not only raise national consciousness to the existence of oil in the state, but set up an oil exploration and production company. Orient Petroleum was his brainchild. Again, Odera said in one of his books that God was instrumental to the milestones recorded by his administration.

Thank you Odera. You asked me to leave out controversy and talk about God, while writing about you. I have tried to do that. You know it is not my area of specialisation, but do tolerate my inadequacy.

You were exemplary in leadership, though misunderstood by some but appreciated by many. You were not a saint, neither were you a villain but you demonstrated love, commitment, responsible and responsive leadership.

Your humility was disarming. Good people appreciated it and the bad, took advantage of it.

May Perpetual Light shine upon your good soul. Good night Odera.

Vybz

Vybz Lifestyle Lounge,
135 Ademola Adetokunbo
Crescent,
Wuse II - Abuja
27th September, 2023.

The Mbadinuju Family,
Odera House,
Uli, Ihiala LGA,
Anambra State.

CONDOLENCE MESSAGE

The management and Staff of Vybz Lifestyle Lounge writes to commiserate and convey our heartfelt condolences to the family over the glorious home call of our hero, husband, father, uncle and the former governor of Anambra State, Sir Chinwoke Mbadinuju.

As the Holy book reminds us, there is time for everything under the sun. As humans, we grieve greatly at the exit of our loved ones, but, let's be reminded and consoled that, the heart can only count for a while, the feet can only walk for miles, cloths won't forever be in style, but the legacies of our hero and father will remain and endure with history forever.

Now as always, we identify and grieve with the family as we continue to pray to God to grant his soul, a merciful judgement and for us that he left behind, the fortitude to bear this irreparable lost.

Let us be consoled with the hope of resurrection when we shall meet to part no more at the feet of our saviour Jesus Christ.

May the soul of our father and the souls of all the faithful departed through the mercy of God rest in peace. (Amen).

Yours Faithfully,

For: Vybz Lifestyle Lounge.

Chief (Sir) Emma Ossy Igbonwelundu Ksji

(Ichie Nnanyelugo N'Uli)

Umuokobi Umuoma
Uli
Ihiala LGA **08037151007**
Anambra State. **ossyigbos@yahoo.com**

TRIBUTE TO ODERA THE PEOPLES' GOVERNOR

My first contact with Dr. Clement Chinwoke Mbadinuju (Odera) was during the NPN days in 1982, while he was serving as Special Assistant (Political) to the Country's Vice President Dr. Alex Ekwueme, during the presidency of Alhaji Shehu Shagari.

I had just finished the NYSC and looking for a job and I came to his office at Ribadu Road Ikoyi where he shared the same expansive office with the Late Dr. Anene Uzuakpunwa.

Instantaneously, Odera reached out for his complimentary card and introduced me to three prominent Igbo Political office holders at the time viz: Dr. Gabriel Akwaeze (MD Nigerian Bank for Commerce and Industry Limited), Engr. Paulinus Amadike (Minister of Youths and Sports) and Dr. Ihechukwu Madubike (Minister of Education). Even though fate pushed me to the Commercial Banking Sector, I was nonetheless awed by the swift and brotherly response he showed me at that meeting. He remained in the background politically after the coup that chartered that administration in December 1983.

Fast forward to 1997, Odera threw his hat into the Political ring for the Gubernatorial Election in Anambra State.

I became the Chairman Finance Committee of his Odera Campaign Organisation. Down to earth as Odera was, he consented to being on a weekly stipend out of the campaign funds to enable us plan and manage the finances of the campaign at its teething stage. Odera himself extoled this bold programme exhibited by my humble self which enabled us to go far into the project in a memoir he published many years after his gubernatorial sojourn (see Chinwoke Mbadinuju: Journey Into The Past Godibel Publishing Ltd. PP25&26). We eventually claimed a resounding victory in January 1999.

Faced with lean state resources, several arrays of infrastructural decay all over the state and above all a vitroic institutional opposition fuel by fat purse of opposition money bags, Odera still trudged on for a four year term. I had severally referred to him as A HIGHLY MISUNDERSTOOD MAN. All who knew him very well knows that he was a light hearted man who desired the good of everyone and who could not hurt a fly. The little we had as a state, Odera made sure it went round as much as possible.

We are all gathered today to commit his mortal remains to mother earth....the way of all mortals. He has done his best as a human and let history and posterity remain his greatest judge.

May God grant the soul of Dr. Clement Chinwoke Mbadinuju and the souls of all the faithful departed eternal rest, Amen.

Adieu Odera Odego!!
Farewell till we meet again to part no more.

...Ossy Igbonwelundu

VICTOR OSITADINMA EZENWA

(NNANYELUGO)

THE PASSING OF ODERA

I was frozen by shock and anguish when Odera's portrait popped up on one of the social media platforms, announcing most sadly, his loss by death.

His Excellency, Dr. Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju, most commonly known as Odera, served as the Governor of Anambra State, between 1999 to 2003, during which time I had the rare privilege of serving as the Secretary to the Government of Anambra State.

Odera was very well educated, having obtained a doctorate degree in his field of study.

A lawyer by training which afforded him the opportunity to occupy the apex of the leadership structure of some media houses such as Daily Star and Daily times where he displayed his rich technocratic skills. He also served as the Special Adviser to the former Vice President of the Federal Republic of Nigeria, Dr. Alex Ekwueme.

On my own part, serving Odera for those four years, was a learning process, which is why I agree completely with the dictum, which states that the more you learn, the more you realize how much there is to learn.

It was always customary for him to direct me in writing to convene a meeting of the State Executive Council or the State Security Council, indeed any other meeting for that matter.

On this particular day, he sent a written note to me through his Aide - de - camp, instructing me to convene an emergency State Executive Council meeting. When I read through, I noticed that the word emergency did not bear the letter'r'. After about two hours when the Governor walked in for the meeting and the usual rituals (prayers and National anthem) were done. Thereafter, he beckoned at me to come closer and said to me in his usual, native Uli dialect and drawl that whoever that has a Ph.d, has accomplished a lot academically, to which both of us laughed uproariously, to the consternation of the other EXCO members. He said in a hushed tone that it struck him

NO. 6 AGBALANZE STREET, ABAGANA, NJIKOKA LGA. 08035905305

immediately the messenger left that the word was devoid of an 'r'. He then said I should pardon him for that omission.

To me, it was thoroughness mingled with humour.

His Excellency, Dr. Mbadinuju was a very humble man, who shunned the frills of protocol and offialdom. I still recall when one of the Governors of the South East State visited the Anambra State Governor at Governors lodge, Awka.

As Odera was reading his address of welcome, guests were still making their way into the hall and he would in his characteristic mannerism pause and welcome the people into the place by calling out their names himself.

At a point, one of the protocol officers that accompanied the visiting Governor approached me and demanded to know what indeed was going on as in their own state, nobody walks in once the Governor is seated, as the doors will be shut.

Well, my response to him was that it was an accurate portrayal of simplicity and ordinariness and that is Odera for you, who does his things differently and exemplarity.

Like every other human being, he was also susceptible to human frailties. It was exceedingly easy to read his mood and quite expectedly, people exploited it as it was difficult for him to refuse the numerous requests that were streaming in.

However, I pray that history will be kind to him.

A quintessential leader and a gallant Christian gentleman of immense amplitude, who worshipped his God in an edifying manner.

Odera has come and gone and definitely not with the wind as he left behind an adorable wife, Her Excellency, Mrs. Nnenne Mbadinuju and a fine brood of children who are expected to keep the flag flying Our consolation is that death itself is not the last sleep but the final awakening.

What he requires from us now are, fervent prayers and a memorable farewell until we meet again at Our Saviours feet in eternity.

Odera, my Oga, who had a sobriquet, 01, for me, because of the plate number of my official cars bore – SSG 01 and SSG 01A.

Rest in peace.

Victor Osita Ezenwa
Nnanyelugo.

A TRRIBUTE TO MY BROTHER, BOSS AND MENTOR. DR. CC MBADINUJU (ODERA)

For the unpleasant time, I wonder to myself again, so my Boss/My Brother, Odera Ndigbo has gone, it has been said, a good brother's heart is a good classroom, I thank God for all that my Boss (Odera) has thought me through the years he is a portrait of godly brother/boss and I am proud to be his lovely brother. Odera stood for peace and always played a role of reconciler. Let me go back to his days, as an executive governor of Anambra State, in 1999, under the assistance of Dr. ABC Orjiakor(Onwa)Uli, immediately he was sworn in as governor, some Anambra big shorts started fighting him. He introduced Monday morning prayers and being a devoted and prayerful Christian, God made him to overcome all his detractors and he moved on and that made him always quote K.O Mbadiwe saying, the march had started, (if any tree fall on my way, I will uproot it) He initiated a slogan, in Anambra State (it shall be well with Anambra State) with his faith in God, he defeated all his detractors and moved on, and ruled Anambra State for four years before he was prevented from going for a second term, which Anambra people later regretted more especially the political elites and workers.

As a peaceful governor, when the people from above stopped him from going for a second term, most of his colleague governors advised to go to court and reclaim his mandate which was given to him three times, still he refused to accept their advices to go to court saying he would not take his ogas to court. His Excellency Odera should be remembered in AnambraState for peace, massive development in all sectors. Which if I count, this paper will be filled up, but I cannot fail to mention Security, Education , Peace etc for example, during the conflict between Aguleri and Umuleri, he wedded in and maintained peace for them, that peace is still there till date. As a peaceful governor/man, he was touched when he heard the number of people that were killed, he decided to go there despite the war that was going, on when he made up his mind and announced that he would go to make the peace at Aguleri/Umuleri fight, politicians raised an uproar and advising him not to go, even some of them approached his wife and some of us his closed aids to stop him from going. we met himas they advised and asked him not to go but he refused saying if Aguleri/Umuleri fight would cost his life for peace sake, he would thank his God Almighty.He insisted and went there and made peace for them till date.

Evenbefore he became governor, there was Ezeship Tussle in our town Uli, in IhialaL.G.A. he made peace for the two factions and there was peace till date in UliEzeship.

How many can I mention? Odera loved peace very well. He fought insecurity to stand still in Anambra State and was givenan award as the Best Security Governor in Nigeria by the Federal Government.

He also loved sports like, Lown Tennis and table Tennis, including Football, even after his administration, he forgave those who fought him and stopped him from going for a second term as governor.

Death, you are very wicked to have taken away our beloved brother and my mentor/boss away from us when we still need his fatherly advice. Odego, when I remember the nick nameyou usually call me when you were alive, (Offe) instead of Japhet. I began to wonder the type of world we are into when I remember that I will not see you on earth again, except in heaven, I began to cry "death why ?" well, I remember in Ecclesiastes Chapter 3:1-14 which says (there is time for everything, time to be born, time to die etc) I have to endure and believe what the bible said.

Odera, the memory of your good life will never go out of our mind. Your memory will never be cleaned off in our heart. Well, in everything, bible said we give thanks to God, Uli people, our villagers Ndikpo, our LocalGovernment/Anambra and Federalas a whole will never forget your good legacy and works.

All of us including your lovely wife, children more especially Agunnia as you usually call him, are here mourning your Exit but you are still with us in spirit. Farewell, Odego, Farewell Odego, Farewell Odera. Till we meet in heaven.

Hon. JaphetChuksNgobili
Your Boy and brother
08028383000

A TRIBUTE BY Mr. I.C.I EZEKWERRE FAMILY.

Odera, the history of your life cannot be complete without a mention of the special father and son relationship between you and our late father, Mr. I.C.I Ezekwerre, the missionary educationist and foremost school Headmaster from Uli.

Mr. I.C.I Ezekwerre was your baptismal godfather and to him you remained his cherished godson and one of his most successful sons. He was especially proud of your exploits in the vineyard of Christ and prominently displayed in our family library the Christian books you wrote and gave to him. Later as Governor, you started and encouraged regular praise and worship assemblies in Government House, Government Offices, in Onitsha Main Market and other markets in the State. By these acts you vindicated your godfather in his promise made at your baptism to see that you follow in life the path of righteousness in Christ.

Your godfather Mr. I.C.I Ezekwerre in partnership with Mbadinuju family as well as the Church gave support and saw to it that no mountain was too high to climb to ensure that you attained your desired level of education overseas. You did not disappoint and did excel academically to the glory of God.

For our father, education is the best and greatest gift one could bequeath a child to unlock their God-given potentials. His greatest desire therefore, was to see that, if possible, every child in Uli is educated. You fulfilled that prominent desire to a very large extent by establishing a University in Uli.

You thus became that illustrious son who blazed the trail and brought university education to the doorsteps of every home in Uli, made university education more accessible to Ndi- Anambra, Ndi- Igbo and beyond.

You did not stop there; you became a beacon of hope and sanity in governance as a pen in the hands of God for re-writing destinies in Anambra State. Little wonder your administration was besieged by those who sought to besmirch noble intentions. In all those travails you remained dignified.

As our father continues to rest peacefully in the bosom of the Almighty God, we are certain that he remains very proud of these particular achievements of yours.

For doing the spiritual and educational legacy of Mr. I.C.I. Ezekwerre proud, we say on behalf of our father and ourselves:

Deeme, oke nwa putara ihe,
Deeme, oke nwa gbara ezigbo mbo!
Gaa n'udo, Dr Clement Chinwoke Mbadinuju, former Executive Governor of Anambra State.
Gaa ije gi nke oma, Odera.
And may the Almighty God recieve you in the bossom of our Lord Jesus Christ whom you loved.

Dr. SyJohnson C. Ezekwere,
On behalf of Mr. I.C.I. Ezekwerre Family, Umudiaku, Umuaku, Uli.

TRIBUTE TO A GREAT MAN OF THE GREAT GOD.
DR. CHIWEOKE C. MBADINUJU (ODERA).

My first contact with Dr. Mbadinuju was at the Funeral of his late younger brother, Ken Mbadinuju, in their Ancestral home at Uli in Anambra State in 1983. I was there in my capacity as the Field Representative of the Onitsha chapter of the Full Gospel Businessmen's Fellowship International (FGBMFI), which started in 1975 in Nigeria. To which Ken stoutly belonged. Incidentally I was also there as the Field Representative of the then Midwestern and Eastern Regional blocks of the Ful gospel which eventually metamorphosed into what are known today as the South-South and South-Eastern Regional blocks of the FGBMFI. Dr. Mbadinuju gave his life to the Lord Jesus Christ on that fateful day at the Funeral Service. After that day, we became very good friends and co-laborers in the Vineyard of our Lord and Savior, Jesus Christ. He was a man one could rely upon without any regrets whatsoever. He grew rapidly in the knowledge of the Word of God.

He did great exploits for the Lord and the FGBMFI and God strategically positioned him politically for this purpose. He was the Adviser to the late Dr. Alex Ifeanyi Chukwu Ekwueme who was the Vice President of the Federal Republic of Nigeria, under the late President Shehu Shagari's regime. In the first republic He eventually became the President of Onitsha chapter of the Full Gospel, which I founded during my tenure along with the other Eastern Regional chapters at Enugu, Onitsha, Owerri, Port Harcourt, Aba and Asaba. He was a working machine for the Lord and his efforts yielded innumerable dividends; as President of Onitsha chapter, he led many Lawyers, Judges, Magistrates, Doctors, Engineers, Nurses and other Professionals to Christ. Governor Mbadinuju and I mounted several Evangelical Billboards along Onitsha-Lagos route, Onitsha-Enugu route, and Onitsha-Owerri route. We continued this passionate Evangelical Love-work with the Lord until 1986/87 when I had a family emergency that took me to the USA permanently. But Governor Mbadinuju later became the Field Representative for Onitsha zone and also the national legal adviser as well as a member of the National Executive Committee (NEC). He continued this drive work that led to the establishment of several other chapters around the Onitsha zone such as GRA, FEGGE, INLAND TOWN, OBOSI, OTUOCHA, OGBARU, OMAGBA, NKPOR, AWADA, ATANI, ODOAKPU and ORAIFITE chapters of which he kept abreast with me in his personal hand-written letters to me. Other co-laborers in this Lord's work with us were Elder Sam Mbata as President of Port Harcourt chapter (who later became the first National President of the FGBMFI in Nigeria), Elder Akhigbe as President of Benin chapter, Bishop Daniel Uwadiae as Director of West African of the ful gospel businessmen's Fellowship International. While I was also a West African field Representative of the FGBMFI.

Governor, Chinwoke. Mbadinuju (Odera)was a Lawyer, an Author of several books, a loyal friend of men and God, an optimistic, dedicated trust-worthy human being. He loved his wife and children so dearly. I know his soul is already resting in Peace. Adieu my very good friend.

Father, in the Name of your precious Son Jesus Christ, keep the Family of your servant and son strong and mighty on this Earth, and give them Long Life and overflowing prosperity to surpass the accomplishments of their Father and mentor, Amen!

By Elder Philip N. Ohamadike.
FIELD REP FOR WEST AFRICA 1979 – 1987.

"The Death Of Every Human Diminishes Me, Because I'm Involved In Humanity"

It was like the death of Julius' Caesar in 44 BC, when I heard the ugly news of unexpected demise of His Excellency, Dr. Barr. Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju, Former Executive Governor Of Anambra State {1999 - 2003}, who has not remained to reap completely, the fruits of his toil and moil.

Good things they say, last not! Could it be likened to the saying that good persons don't live long? Of a truth, without mincing words and without the heinous, callous nature and the whims and caprices of men, Late Oderaa would have cruised into the nonagenarian umbrella and may be possibly clocks over 100 years and may still be alive today! Your glorious dismissal still left a big lacuna into the hub of the entire Anambra State and Uli Kingdom in particular.

However, you were a man of reputable echelon, munificence, tolerance, and unquenchable sagacity; contrarily, you abhorred malevolence, victimization, sadism, unsolicited avarice, and most regrettably, you suffered betrayals from the people you trusted the most! You made remarkable traces of lasting tracks, on the sands of time which would remain green in our medulla oblongata and will hardly be flung into the bush.

You decently transcended into the world beyond unannounced. Your family members, Umuaku, Uli and Anambra State in general are still devastated over your death. The lacuna it created, maybe impossible to fill. The weapons of war perish Alas and Alack! A great vacuum has been obliterated in Anambra State. What a pill of anguish, that made a lion to gasp, gape and pine away in a heart-throbbing pain.

Nevertheless, Death is inevitable and a ubiquitous, as you bowed out of this theatrical stage when the ovation is inexorably high, I salute your guts for succeeding and for making a history from a near-no-prior foundation. My prayer is that, God in His Infinite mercies, will fill the vacuum your departure has created in the family of Mbadinuju, Uli and the entire Anambra State at gargantuan.

Finally, we are consoled about your demise, because I know quite vividly that you lived a life worthy of copy! Therefore, I seized this rare opportunity to extend my unalloyed condolence to all of us, and the Chief mourners of Late Oderaa Mbadinuju's family, especially Chetachi Mbadinuju who has been giving us proper information pertaining the date and activities of this very burial of his dad.

May his lovely, sweet and gentle soul, Find Peace In The Lord, Amen.
Comr. DonCross® Ekwughalu De Crypto-Lord® {MBA}. Hail From Aluora Umuaku Uli.

It is with a heavy heart that we bid farewell to a man whose legacy will forever be etched in the annals of our history. The late Dr. Chinwoke Mbadinuju, Odera, which we all call him, was a father to all who came in contact with him. He always listened and shared his thoughts on issues be it social or political that were brought to his attention. This was displayed during his tenure as the Governor of Anambra State. His unwavering dedication and visionary leadership, throughout his tenure steered the State towards progress and prosperity. He was committed to uplifting the lives of the citizens and promoting unity and development. There is no doubt that he made an enduring impact on our society.

Beyond his political achievements, Odera was a warm and compassionate soul, a father figure who cherished his family dearly. His unwavering love and support for all of his children were evident in the way he carried himself with grace and humility. He leaves behind a remarkable legacy not only as a leader but also as a devoted family man, a role model for generations to come.

Despite that we can no longer be with him physically, we believe that he is always with us and we find solace in the memories shared, the love given, and the profound impact he had on countless lives. We will forever remember him for his unwavering dedication, integrity and belief in the power of unity and progress. May his legacy continue to

inspire us to strive for excellence and to embrace unity in all that we do. May his noble values continue to guide us as we strive to build a better society.
Good night, Ka chi fo Odera na Odera go!

Eternal rest grant unto him oh Lord and let your perpetual light shine upon him.
Adieu Odera, may your soul continue to rest in the blossom of the Lord.

Prince Arthur Igwe and family

The Mbadinuju Family
Odera House
Onitsha/Owerri Road
Uli, thiala LGA Anambra State

CHINEDU G.
UDORA & CO
LEGAL PRACTITIONERS | CORPORATE CONSULTANTS

23rd October 2023.

Chetachi Mbadinuju Esq.
Clemesis Associates,
(Legal Practitioner & Private Equity Consultant),
Plot 345, MB Aliyu Mustapha Boulevard,
Wuye, Abuja.

Dear Colleague,

RE: THE DEATH OF DR. CHINWOKE MBADINUJU, "ODERA", FORMER GOVERNOR OF ANAMBRA STATE (1999-2003).

CONDOLENCE LETTER

I, on behalf of my Family, the Management, and the Staff of Chinedu G. Udora & Co., convey the Firm's condolence and heartbroken message to you, the entire members of the Mbadinuju family and the entire good people of Anambra State having learned about the demise of the leader of your patriarchal family and your Father, **Dr. Chinwoke Mbadinuju, "Odera"**, an Associate Professor of Politics and African Studies at the State University of New York whom God had made the Executive Governor of Anambra State between 1999 to 2003. Please, accept the deepest condolence and know that you and your family are in our thoughts and prayers during this critical time.

The Firm had the privilege of knowing and will always know the late **Dr. Chinwoke Mbadinuju, "Odera"** for his personality, kindness, and infectious smile as he had a remarkable ability to bring joy and comfort to those around him. It is a testament to his character that made such a lasting impact on so many lives particularly when he held sway as the democratically elected executive Governor of Anambra State between 1999 to 2003, examples of which are but not limited to;

a. **passing a law that created the Anambra Vigilante Services, which legally enshrined the Bakassi Boys, a popular feared vigilante group credited with reducing crime in the state which then increased the social well-being of the people of Anambra State during his tenure;**

b. **signing into law the bill that created the Anambra State University, Uli; a University that has provided hundreds of thousands of Graduates who are all doing great in their chosen profession;**

HOUSE 'A', PLOT 354, MB. ALIYU MUSTAPHA BOULEVARD WUYE, ABUJA
CHUDORA@YAHOO.COM
08023402455 | 08034016609

c. **bringing development to rural areas by ensuring that the benefits of government programs reach every nook and cranny of the state.**

During this time of grief, I hope you find solace in the memories you shared with him and the love that surrounds you from your family and friends. The bond you shared with him will forever remain in your heart, and I trust that the cherished memories you spent together will help you find peace and healing in the days to come. Please, note that I, my family, and the entire members of staff of the firm are here for you and your family, and I am just a phone call or message away if you need to talk or require any support. Do not hesitate to reach out if you need a helping hand, a listening ear, or a shoulder to lean on.

May the love and kindness that ***Odera*** embodied be a source of strength and inspiration for you and your family. In time, I hope you find comfort in the knowledge that his spirit will live on through the lasting impact made on everyone who had the privilege of knowing him, including me.

Once again, I on behalf of my family and the firm, offer our sincerest sympathy to your loss as we shall keep sending you all love and support during this challenging time.

Warm regards,

Chinedu G. Udora LLM (Intl. Sports Law, Geneva), FICMC, FIMC
Principal-in-Chambers.

A TRIBUTE TO MY FATHER

ALL IS WELL

Death is nothing at all

I have only slipped away into the next room

I am I and you are you

Whatever we were to each other, that we still are.

Call me by my old familiar name,

Speak to me in the easy way, you always used

Put no difference in your tone

Wear no forced air of solemnity or sorrow.

Laugh as we always laughed,

at the little jokes we enjoyed together.

Play, smile, think of me and pray for me.

Let my name be ever the household word that it always was.

Let it be spoken without effect, without the trace of shadow on it.

Life means all that it ever meant

It is the same as it ever was, there is absolutely unbroken continuity

What is death but a negligible accident?

Why should I be out of mind, because I am out of sight?

I am waiting for you, for an interval, somewhere near

Just around the corner.

All is well

Henry Scott Holland – Poet

ODERA! ODEGO!!

Indeed Daddy, all is well. Posterity and Vindication have spoken and your God is happy. You lived your life wishing well to humanity and He has made it well for you and your generations yet unborn. Odera my father, shepherd, leader, mentor, my sage, inspiration and number 1 fan. What manner of man were you?! The great scholar, teacher, administrator, Lawyer, journalist, State and Presidential Assistant, Evangelist and Christian intellectual, Author and Publisher, Community leader, State Governor, Statesman,… *so ofu onye na ndu a*?! Though all the tributes and eulogies will not return you to us, your family is consoled by the fulfilling, inspiring and justified life you lived while on earth.

We are blessed to be called the sons and daughters of Dr Chinwoke Clement Mbadinuju. Thank you for loving us unconditionally and guiding us to the present truth, Sir. The family you bequeathed to me shall forever celebrate you, Papa. Your God shall be our God; and we shall project your light and live our lives as testament to the "fruits" of the spirit, which you cherished all your life and diligently abided by, despite all the odds.

So you can sleep well my dear father. You ran an exceptional race and fulfilled your destiny. Your impactful life on earth, your books, memoirs, your children and legacies shall continue to speak for you for generations, and I look forward to re-uniting with you Odera, at the fullness of time, "to give you *positive updates on the family and sundries… and to bring you 'good' returns."*

All is well.

Chetachi Chinwoke Mbadinuju, Esq.

Agunnaya nyelu Ugo

Appreciation

Never have we been more aware of how much friends and family mean than at the time of bereavement. Words cannot express how deeply we appreciate everything you have done to help us get through this difficult time. Amidst tears, your comforting words, warm embraces, phone calls and text messages have reminded us that we are not alone in our grief and in this journey of healing.

On behalf of the entire Mbadinuju Family, we extend our heartfelt gratitude for joining us to bid "ODERA" farewell. We know that we all feel the profound sense of loss as he had a special place in our hearts.

We pray that God blesses you and grants you safe return to your destinations. Your enduring love and support will always be remembered.

The Mbadinuju Family.

Destiny Fulfilled

1 Cor 4:1-5 KJV

THANK YOU FOR COMING

CHINWOKE MBADINUJU FOUNDATION

CMBADINUJUFOUNDATION.ORG